# TRUTH

## For 1st Year

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**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—TRIUNE GOD AND HIS ECONOMY**

Message One

# God's Plan

Scripture Reading: Eph. 1:4, 5, 9-11; 3:2, 8-9, 11; Col. 1:25; 1 Cor. 9:17; 1 Pet. 1:1-2; Rom. 8:30; Gen. 1:26a, 27; 2:7; Zech. 12:1

**I. God's Pleasure—His Heart's Desire.**

A. Sonship is God's heart's desire — Eph. 1: 5, 9; Rom. 8:14, 15, 23; Gal. 4:5-7; John 1:12-13.

B. Through resurrection, the only begotten Son of God became the Firstborn among many brothers — John 1:18; 3:16; Rom. 8:29; John. 20:17; Heb. 2:10-12.

**II. God's Purpose—His Plan — Eph. 3:11; 1:9.**

**III. God's Economy—His Administrative Arrangement.**

A. Household administration — Eph. 3:2; 1:10; 3:8-9.

B. His dispensation — Eph. 1:10; 3:2, 9; Col. 1:25; 1 Cor. 9:17; 1 Pet. 4:10.

**IV. God's Selection — Eph. 1:4; 1 Ptr. 1:1-2.**

**V. God's Predestination — Eph. 1:5; Rom. 8:30; Psa. 139:7-10.**

**VI. God's Creation — Gen. 1:26-27.**

A. The Council of the Divine Trinity — Gen. 1:26.

B. The Creation of Man in God's Image, after God's Likeness — Gen. 1:26; Col. 1:15; John 1:14; Gen. 18:4-8; Judges 13:20; 2 Cor. 3:18; Rom. 12:2; Psa. 139:14.

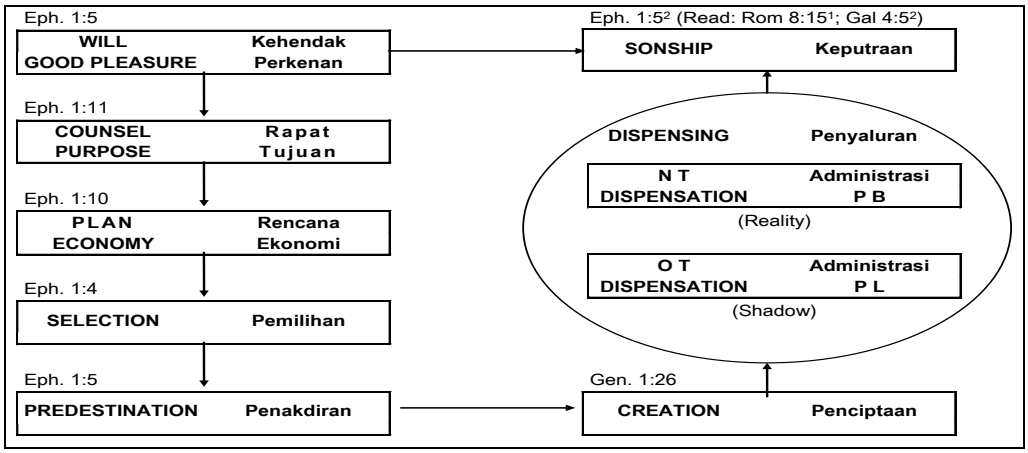
C. For God's Expression — John 3:16; 1 John 5:12.

D. Of Three Parts--that a human being is of three parts: spirit, soul, and body — Prov. 20:27; 1 Thess. 5:23; Gen. 1:11-12, 21, 24-25; 2:7.

E. The Crucial Part—Man's Spirit — Job 32:8; John 4:24; Rom. 8:16; 9:1; 1 Cor. 6:17; John 3:6; 2 Tim. 4:22; Zech. 12:1.

Notes: Numerals I, II, and III are the stage of planning, whereas numerals IV, V, and VI are God's actions to carry out His plan.

**THE SUMMARY OF GOD'S PLAN**




Reference: *Basic Revelation in the Holy Scripture*, chapter 1

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**
**TRUTH CLASS—TRIUNE GOD AND HIS ECONOMY**

Message Two

# The Reasons for and Importance of Carefully Studying and Apprehending the Revelation concerning the Triune God

Scripture Reading : Gen. 1:1-3; Exo. 3:6; Eph. 4:4-6; John 17:20 – 23

**I. The truth concerning the Triune God is the capital truth of the Christian faith. To be Christian in the classic and historical sense of the term, is to believe in the Triune God:**

A. To be a Christian is to believe in the person and work of Christ
B. Our faith in Christ is one that recognizes that Christ is God just as the Father is God. This implies plurality in the Godhead.
C. Hence, to believe in Christ in this way requires our full belief and appreciation of the Divine Trinity.

**II. To properly understand what God has done and is doing, we must see His Triune operation.**

A. This is illustrated in Genesis 1:1-3 where the entire Triune God operates to create:
   1. "In the beginning God created …" (v. 1) implying the entire Godhead: God (Heb *Elohim*) is grammatically plural, while created is grammatically *singular*.
   2. " And the Spirit of God was brooding …" (v. 2), explicitly naming the Third of the Divine Trinity.
B. Every single action of God should be understood to be the operation of the three of the Divine Trinity.
C. Hence, to fully understand what God does, we must pay attention to His triune being and existence.

**III. The Scriptures are constructed with the Triune God as its intrinsic content:**

A. This is illustrated in Genesis 12 - 50, where the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob (cf. Exo. 3:6) operate:
   1. "God's calling to Abraham was the work of God the Father" (LS/ Genesis 517)
   2. "The experience of Isaac … fits the second of the Triune God, God the Son. The Lord Jesus, as the Son of God, came out of the Father (John 16:28), inherited all that the Father is and has (John 16:15), and accomplished all the Father's will (John 6:38). Isaac's life corresponds to His." (LS/ Genesis 518)
   3. "In Jacob we see regeneration, discipline, transformation, and the growth and maturity in life. All of this is the work of the Spirit." (LS/ Genesis 519)
B. Other examples can be found in Luke 15, Ephesians 1: 3 -14, Revelation 21:9 - 22:5.
C. Many other portions of the Scriptures manifest the Triune God as their intrinsic content.

**IV. As believers we are the members of the Body of Christ, which is the organism of the processed and dispensing Triune God and which will consummate in the New Jerusalem as the incorporation of the Triune God with the tripartite man:**

A. The Body of Christ takes the Father as its source, the Son as its element, and the Spirit as its essence (Eph. 4: 4-6).
B. As the organism of the Triune God, the Body of Christ expresses the Son as the embodiment of the Triune God.
C. The Body, as the organism of the Triune God, consummates in the New Jerusalem as an incorporation of the Triune God with the redeemed, transformed, and glorified tripartite man.
D. As the organism of the Triune God, and an incorporation with the Triune God, we should express the mode of existence among the three of the Triune God in our living in the Body (John 17:20-23).

Reference: FTTA Outline, Message 1

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**TRUTH CLASS—TRIUNE GOD AND HIS ECONOMY**

Message Three

# THE PURE REVELATION OF THE TRIUNE GOD ACCORDING THE SCRIPTURE AS THE WORD OF GOD

**I. God being only one:**

A. There is no God but one — 1 Cor. 8:4b.

B. Hear, O Israel, Jehovah is our God; Jehovah is one — Deut. 6:4.

C. I am the Lord, and there is none else, there is no God besides me — Isa. 45:5a; (see—45:6, 21, 22, 44:6, 8; 46:9).

**II. God having the aspect of three—the Father, the Son, and the Spirit:**

A. God speaking as "I" and also as "Us."

1. *"Then I heard the voice of the Lord, saying, Whom shall I send? Who will go for Us? And I said, Here am I; send me"* — Isa. 6:8.
2. *"And God said, Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; and let them have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the birds of heaven and over the cattle and over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps upon the earth"*— Gen. 1:26.

B. The matter of the Father, the Son, and the Spirit.

1. *"Go therefore and disciple all the nations, baptizing them into the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit"* — Matt. 28:19.

**III. The Father, the Son, and the Spirit coexisting simultaneously from eternity to eternity:**

A. The Father, the Son, and the Spirit all being God:

1. The Father being God.
   a. *"Chosen according to the foreknowledge of God the Father.."* — 1 Pet.1:2a.
   b. *"That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory"* — Eph. 1:17a.
2. The Son being God.
   a. *"But of the Son, Your throne, O God, is forever and ever, and the scepter of uprightness is the scepter of Your kingdom"* — Heb. 1:8.
   b. *"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God"* — John. 1:1.
   c. *"The Christ, who is over all, God blessed forever. Amen"* — Rom. 9:5b.
   d. *"Take heed to yourselves and to all the flock, among whom the Holy Spirit has placed you as overseers to shepherd the church of God, which He obtained through His own blood"* — Act. 20:28.
   e. *"Thomas answered and said to Him, My Lord and my God!"* — John. 20:28.
   f. *"Who, existing in the form of God, did not consider being equal with God a treasure to be grasped"* —Phil. 2:6.
3. The Spirit being God.
   a. *"But Peter said, Ananias, why has Satan filled your heart to deceive the Holy Spirit and to put aside for yourself some of the proceeds of the land? While it remained, was it not your own? And when it was sold, was it not under your authority? Why is it that you have contrived this thing in your heart? You have not lied to men but to God"*— Act. 5:3-4.

B. The Father, the Son, and the Spirit all being eternal:

1. *"For a child is born to us,A Son is given to us;And the government Is upon His shoulder; And His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Eternal Father, Prince of Peace"* — Isa.9:6.

2. *"They will perish, but You endure;Indeed all of them will wear out like a garment; Like clothing You will change them,and they will be changed. But You are the same,And Your years are without end"* — Psa. 102:26-27.
3. *"And like a mantle You will roll them up; like a garment they will also be changed; but You are the same, and Your years will not fail."* — Heb. 1:12.
4. *"How much more will the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered Himself without blemish to God, purify our conscience from dead works to serve the living God?"* — Heb. 9:14.

C. The Father, the Son, and the Spirit coexisting simultaneously.
1. *"And I will ask the Father, and He will give you another Comforter, that He may be with you forever, Even the Spirit of reality"* — John 14:16-17a.
2. *"For this cause I bow my knees unto the Father, Of whom every family in the heavens and on earth is named, That He would grant you, according to the riches of His glory, to be strengthened with power through His Spirit into the inner man, That Christ may make His home in your hearts through faith, that you, being rooted and grounded in love"* — Eph. 3:14-17.
3. *"The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all"* — 2 Cor. 13:14.

"Therefore, we do not believe that the Father ceased to exist and was replaced by the Son, then after another period of time the Son was replaced by the Spirit. We believe that the Three—Father, Son, and Spirit—are eternal and co-existent" — *Witness Lee, Truth Lesson Level 1, Vol 1, p 24.*

**IV. The Father, the Son, and the Spirit coinhering and being inseparable:**

"The relationship among the Father, the Son, and the Spirit of the Trinity is not only that they simultaneously coexist, but, even more, that they indwell one another mutually. Coexistence means to exist together at the same time. Coinherence, as applied to the Trinity, means that the Father, the Son, and the Spirit are in one another and thus exist together" — *Witness Lee, Truth Lesson Level 1, Vol 1, p. 24.*

A. John 6:46: *Not that anyone has seen the Father, except Him who is from God, He has seen the Father.*
B. John 5:43 : *I have come in the name of My Father*.
C. John 14:9-10: *Jesus said to him, Have I been so long a time with you, and you have not known Me, Philip? He who has seen Me has seen the Father; how is it that you say, Show us the Father? Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me? The words that I say to you I do not speak from Myself, but the Father who abides in Me does His works*.
D. John 15:26 : *But when the Comforter comes, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of reality, who proceeds from(The second "from" is also "from with" in the sense of the Greek) the Father*.
E. John 14:26: *The Comforter, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in My name.*
F. John 8:29: *He who sent Me is with Me; He has not left Me alone.*
G. Luke 4:1: *Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit....*
H. Mat 3:16-17 : *And having been baptized, Jesus went up immediately from the water, and behold, the heavens were opened to Him, and He saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove and coming upon Him. And behold, a voice out of the heavens, saying, This is My Son, the Beloved, in whom I have found My delight.*

"Not that the voice could be produced without the activity of the Son and the Holy Spirit (The Triad works inseparably); but it was produced to manifest the person of the Father alone, just as the Three produced that human being of the virgin Mary and yet it is the person of the Son alone - The invisible Three producing what is the visible person of the Son alone." *Augustine, The Trinity, Book II, sec. 18 (Introduction, translation, and notes by Edmund Hill, O.P. Brookly, NY: New City Press, 1990) p.110.*

"The Triune God has never been separated. When One moves, the other Two also move with Him. When One is sent, the other Two also come with Him. When the Son comes, He comes in the name of the Father; when He comes, the Father comes. When the Spirit is sent, He is sent in the name of the Son; His being sent is the Son's being sent. Hence, the Son's coming is the Father's coming, and the Spirit's being sent is the Son's being sent. The Three—the Father, Son, and Spirit—are one. They cannot be separated for eternity" — *Witness Lee, Truth Lesson 1, Level 1, p 25-26.*

**V. The Three—the Father, the Son, and the Spirit—being one:**

A. The Son being the Father.

1. Isa. 9:6: *For a child is born to us, A Son is given to us; And the government Is upon His shoulder; And His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Eternal Father, Prince of Peace*.
2. John 14:7-11: *If you had known Me, you would have known My Father also; and henceforth you know Him and have seen Him. Philip said to Him, Lord, show us the Father and it is sufficient for us. Jesus said to him, Have I been so long a time with you, and you have not known Me, Philip? He who has seen Me has seen the Father; how is it that you say, Show us the Father? Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me? The words that I say to you I do not speak from Myself, but the Father who abides in Me does His works. Believe Me that I am in the Father and the Father is in Me; but if not, believe because of the works themselves.*
3. John 10:30: *I and the Father are one*.

B. The Son becoming the life-giving Spirit.

1 Cor. 15:45b: *The first man, Adam, became a living soul; the last Adam became a life-giving Spirit.*

John 14:16-20 : *And I will ask the Father, and He will give you another Comforter, that He may be with you forever, Even the Spirit of reality, whom the world cannot receive, because it does not behold Him or know Him; but you know Him, because He abides with you and shall be in you. I will not leave you as orphans; I am coming to you. Yet a little while and the world beholds Me no longer, but you behold Me; because I live, you also shall live. In that day you will know that I am in My Father, and you in Me, and I in you.*

C. The Lord (the Son) being the Spirit.

2 Cor. 3:17 : *And the Lord is the Spirit; and where the Spirit of the Lord is, there is freedom.*

**VI. The reason for God being triune.**

2 Cor. 13:14 : *The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all*.

Reference: *Truth Lesson Level 1*, Volume 1, Chapter 2

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Message Four

# The Divine Dispensing in the Gospel of John: The Accomplishment, The Believers' Enjoyment; Application of the Divine Dispensing of the Divine Trinity and Its Results

**I. The Divine Trinity—the Father, the Son, and the Spirit:**

A. The Father expressed in the Son—the Son being embodiment of the Father — John 14:8-11.

B. The Son realized as the Spirit—the Spirit being the reality of the Son — John 14: 16-20.

**II. The accomplishment of the divine dispensing of the Divine Trinity:**

D. The Triune God becoming the flesh, dispensing Himself as grace and reality to man — John 1:1, 14, 16.

E. The Triune God dispensing the Son as eternal life to His believers — John 3:16.

F. The Son dying to release the divine life and to dispense it to all the members of His Body — John 12:24.

G. The Son resurrecting to be transfigured as the Spirit to be the ultimate consummation of the Triune God, that the Triune God may be dispensed into the believers — John 20:8-9, 19, 22.

H. The Son being above all, inheriting all, and being sent from God to speak God's word, and dispensing the Spirit without measure — John 3:31-36.

**III. The believer's enjoyment and application of the divine dispensing of the Divine Trinity:**

A. Regenerated to receive God's Spirit of life, begetting into the believers spirit that which is the life of Christ — John 3:3-6.

B. Breathing the pneumatic Christ as breath — John 20:22.

C. Drinking the pneumatic Christ as the living water — John 4:10, 14; 7:37-39.

D. Eating the Christ who is in the living word of life as the spiritual food — John 6:48, 57b-58a, 63.

E. Growing in the bountiful supply of Christ as the true vine—John 15:1, 4-5.

**IV. The results of the believers enjoyment and application of the divine dispensing of the Divine Trinity:**

A. Flowing the rivers of living water — John 7:38-39.

B. Bearing the fruits of life — John 15:2, 16a.

C. Feeding the lambs in the flock — John 21:15; 10:16.

D. Becoming the bride of Christ, which is the Body of Christ as His increase—John. 3:6b, 29-30.

E. Being the organism of the processed Triune God — John. 15:1, 5, 8.

Reference: *The Deeper Study of the Divine Dispensing*, chapter 1-2

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Message Five

# The Divine Dispensing in the Book of Romans (1): The Processed Triune God Consummated to Become the Law of the Spirit of Life; Its Operation and Its Dispensing in the Three Parts of the Believers

**I. The Spirit of life being the compound Spirit:**

A. Being a mingling of the divinity, humanity, human living, death, and resurrection of Christ with the Spirit of God to become the holy ointment — Exo. 30:23-25.

B. The supplying element of this compound Spirit being bountiful and excellent — Phil. 1:19b.

**II. The law of the Spirit of life being the consummated Triune God — Rev. 22:17a.**

A. Becoming the law of life with its natural life-capacities and its spontaneous life-power — Rom. 8:2a.

B. Freeing the believers from the law of sin and of death, solving for them the problem of sin and of death — Rom. 8:2b.

**III. Beginning from the believers spirit:**

A. By God's Spirit dwelling in the believers — Rom. 8:9a.

B. The Spirit of Christ, that is, the pneumatic Christ, making home in the believers spirit — Rom. 8:9b-10a.

C. That the believers, though dead in their bodies because of sin, may have their spirits become life because of righteousness — Rom. 8:10b.

**IV. Continuing in the believers soul:**

A. By the believers setting the mind of their soul on the spirit — Rom. 8:6b

B. That divine dispensing that dwells in the believers' spirit may spread into the believers soul, that their mind may be transformed and their soul renewed — Rom. 12:2b.

**V. Consummated in the believers body:**

A. By the Spirit of the One who raised Christ from the dead dwelling in the believers spirit and soul — Rom. 8:11a.

B. That He who raised Christ from the dead may spread His divine dispensing into the believers body through His indwelling Spirit — Rom. 8:11b.

C. That the believers' mortal body may also receive the supply and saturation of the divine life — Rom. 8:11b.

Reference: *A Deeper Study of the Divine Dispensing*, chapter 3-4

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Message Six

# The Divine Dispensing in the Book of Romans (2): The Results of the Dispensing of the Divine Trinity as the Law of the Spirit of Life in the Believers

**I. The believers being saved in the life of Christ that they may reign in this life — Rom. 5:10, 17b:**

A. The believers having been reconciled to God through the death of His Son being saved in His life — Rom. 5:10b.

1. To be freed from the law of sin and of death — Rom. 8:2.
2. To be saved from the body of this death —Rom. 7:24, cf. Rom. 7:9-13, 21-23.
3. To be saved from the morality of the body — Rom.8:11, 13.
4. To be saved from being common — Rom. 6:19, 22; 12:2a.
5. To be saved from a low manner of living — Rom. 12:9-21.
6. To be saved from division — Rom. 16:17.

B. The believers reigning in the life of Christ — Rom. 5:17b.

1. Subduing all the people, events, and things that oppose God's righteousness, holiness, and glory — Rom. 11:17, 7; 3:23.
2. Subduing God's enemy, Satan — Rom. 16:20.
3. Bringing in God's kingdom — Rom. 14:17.

**II. Every part of the believers being sanctified — Rom. 6:19, 22.**

**III. The believers mind being renewed — Rom. 12:2b.**

**IV. Every part of the believers soul being transformed — Rom. 12:2b.**

**V. The believers being conformed to the image of God's firstborn Son — Rom. 8:29a.**

**VI. The believers being saturated with the divine glory — the redemption of the body — Rom. 8:30b, 23.**

Reference: *A Deeper Study of the Divine Dispensing*, chapter 5-6

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Message Seven

## The Divine Dispensing in the Book of Romans (3): The Goal of the Dispensing of the Divine Trinity in the Believers

**I. To build up the many members into the Body of Christ:**

A. Coordinating together and functioning according to the measure of each one part — Rom. 12:3-8.

B. Living a life of virtues of the highest standard — Rom. 12:9-21.

**II. That the unique Body of Christ may be expressed in the local churches in every place:**

A. All the churches needing:

1. To receive all genuine believers unconditionally according to the new way God and Christ receive them—Rom. 14: 1-3; 15:7.
2. To treat all genuine believers according to Christ—Rom. 15:5.
3. To walk according to love. Rom. 14:15.
4. To live under the light of the judgmentseat of God—Rom. 14:10b.
5. To live a life of the kingdom of God—Rom. 14:17.
6. All the churches and all the saints on the whole earth living in one universal fellowship—Rom. 16:1-27.
7. To turn away from those who cause divisions—Rom .16:17.

B. The results:

1. Crushing Satan under our feet—Rom. 16:20a.
2. Enjoying the grace of Christ and the peace of God—Rom. 16:20.
3. Giving glory to the only wise God—Rom. 16:25-27.

Reference: *A Deeper Study of the Divine Dispensing*, chapter 7

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Message Eight

# The Divine Dispensing in the Book of 1-2 Corinthians (1): The Divine Dispensing of the All-inclusive Christ in Supplying, Sustaining, Feeding, Watering, and Transforming the Believers

**I. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the common portion from God to the believers, supplying to them the riches of God in Christ:**
- A. Being enjoyed by the believers together — 1 Cor. 1:2b.
- B. Being what God has called the believers into — 1 Cor. 1:9.

**II. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the power from God to the believers, supplying and sustaining them in what they are and what they do — 1 Cor. 1:24a.**
- A. Being with a dynamic power.
- B. Strengthening the believers.

**III. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the wisdom from God to the believers, sustaining them in the divine economy and plan — 1 Cor. 1:24b, 30:**
- A. Being with counsel.
- B. Affording the saints the strategies.

**IV. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the righteousness from God to the believers, supplying to them to righteous way of God — 1 Cor. 1:30.**
- A. In procedures and methods.
- B. That the believers may be perfectly righteous and right toward God, toward men, and toward all things.

**V. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the sanctification from God to the believers, supplying to them God's sanctifying nature — 1 Cor. 1:30.**
- A. In position and nature.
- B. That the believers spirit, soul and body may be fully sanctified.

**VI. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the redemption from God to the believers, supplying to them daily the divine glory which manifests God — 1 Cor. 1:30.**
- A. Not only for the believers life and walk today;
- B. But for their future redemption of the body that their whole being may enter God's glory and may express God's glory and radiance forever.

**VII. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the Passover Lamb and the unleavened bread, feeding the believers and supplying them life — 1 Cor. 5:7-8.**
- A. Not only supplying the believers with the power of life for them to run the God-ordained race of following Him;
- B. But also supplying the believers with nourishment of life and increasing God's element of growth within them.

**VIII. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the spiritual rock out of which flows living water, and as the spiritual bread from heaven, nurturing them and supplying them with life — 1Cor. 10:3-4; John 6:57b-58a.**
- A. Not only supplying the believers with the life-power for them to run God's race;
- B. But also supplying the believers with the divine element for the growth of God.

**IX. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the anointing of the compound Spirit, and as the sealing of the seal, saturating and transforming the believers — 2 Cor. 1:21-22:**

A. Not only anointing and sealing God's divine element into the entire being of the believers inwardly and outwardly;

B. But also transforming the believers nature metabolically by God's divine element that they may have a divine transformation in their entire being.

**X. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing within the believers as the inscribing of the ink, who is the life-giving Spirit, and outside the believers as the "Xeroxing" of the Spirit who transforms them (as a mirror), constituting the believers ministers of the New Testament; these believers reflect His glorious image to fulfill the New Testament ministry — 2 Cor. 3:3, 18:**

A. Not only making the believers the constitution of Christ's life within;

B. But making them Christ's glorious expression without.

Reference: *A Deeper Study of the Divine Dispensing*, chapter 8-9

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Message Nine

## The Divine Dispensing in the Book of 1-2 Corinthians (2): The Divine Dispensing of the All-inclusive Christ Becoming the Factor for the Growth and the Building Up of the Church

**I. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the foundation for the building up of the church, uplifting and supplying the believers with the nourishing element for their growth in life — 1 Cor. 3:11, 6-7:**

A. Not only as the foundation for saints to be built up — 1 Cor. 3:12a.

B. But also becoming the divine dispensing which transforms the believers in the divine life into the precious materials for the building up of the church — 1 Cor. 3:12b.

**II. The all-inclusive Christ equipping the believers with the divine dispensing of the Spirit who dispenses the spiritual gifts to the believers, supplying them with the spiritual capacity, for the building up of the Body of Christ — 1 Cor. 12:4, 7-11:**

A. Not only having a part in the Lord's ministry in the building up of His Body through the gifts and functions of the dispensing Spirit — 1 Cor. 12:5;

B. But also having a part in the operation by which God accomplishes His eternal economy through the same gifts and functions — 1 Cor. 12:6.

**III. The divine dispensing of the all-inclusive Christ in the beholding of His glory by the believers who seek after Him and serve Him, enabling them to receive His divine element and be transformed into His image from glory to glory—2 Cor. 3:18:**

A. Constituting them ministers of the New Testament for the building up of the Body of Christ — 2 Cor. 3:6.

B. Enabling them to bear the New Testament ministry which bears Christ's glorious image and which dispenses Him — 2 Cor. 4:1.

**IV. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as the treasure within the believers in their serving and preaching of Him — 2 Cor. 4:7a:**

A. Constituting them ministers of the New Testaments — 2 Cor. 3:6.

B. Enabling them with the excelling power to fulfill their New Testament ministry of the preaching of the gospel for the building up of the church — 2 Cor. 4:7b, 2-4.

**V. The all-inclusive Christ being the divine dispensing as God's sufficient grace to be Christ's power — 2 Cor. 12:9:**

A. Not only as the believers power for laboring more abundantly for God — 1 Cor. 15:10.

B. But also becoming the rich enjoyment and harvest of the believers in their labor for God — 1 Cor. 15:58.

Reference: *A Deeper Study of the Divine Dispensing*, chapter 10

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Message One

## Christ's Redemption

Bible Readings: 1 Pet. 1:19-20, Rev. 13:8

**I. Incarnation—the first step of Christ's Redemption.**

A. The Word Becoming Flesh — John 1:14; Rom 3:20.

B. In the Likeness of the Flesh of Sin — Rom.8:3.

1. He was only in the likeness of the flesh of sin, not the sinful nature, of the flesh — Num. 21:6-9; John 3:14-15.
2. Christ was made sin for us— 2 Cor. 5:21.

C. Sharing in Man's Blood and Flesh — Heb. 2:14; 9:22.

D. Still with the Father — John 16:32.

1. He came in the Father's name — John 5:43.
2. The Father was with Him all the time — John 16:32.
3. He and the Father are one — John 10:30; 17:22.

**II. Crucified—the second step of Christ's Redemption.**

A. Bearing Our Sins — 1 Pet. 2:24; 1 Cor. 15:3; Heb. 9:28; Isa. 53:6; Mark 15:25, 33; Matt. 27:46; Isa. 53:10.

B. He was made sin for us **—** 2 Cor. 5:21.

C. With Our Old Man and the Entire Old Creation — Rom. 6:6; Matt. 27:51; Exo. 26:31; Eze. 1:5, 10; 10:14-15.

D. Abolishing the Law of the Commandments in Ordinances — Eph. 2:15; Col. 2:14,.16; 1 Cor. 12:12; Col 3:10-11.

E. Destroying Satan and Judging the World **—** Heb. 2:14; John 12:31.

F. Releasing the Divine Life — John 12:24; 19:34.

**III. Resurrected—the third step of Christ's Redemption.**

A. Glorified in the Divine Life **—** John 7:39; Luke 24:26.

B. Becoming the Firstborn Son of God with Many Brothers —Acts. 13:33; Rom. 8:29; John 20:17; Heb. 2:11-12; 1 Pet. 1:3.

C. Becoming the Life-giving Spirit —1 Cor. 15:45; 2 Cor. 3:17.

D. Breathing into His Believers **—** John 20:22; 14:16-20.

**IV. Exalted—the fourth step of Christ's Redemption.**

A. He was made Lord and Christ **—** Acts 2:36.

B. He was given to be the Head over all things to the church, which is His Body **—** Eph. 1:22-23.

C. In His ascension Christ poured out the Holy Spirit upon all His believers—This was the genuine baptism of the Spirit that formed the Body of Christ—Acts 2:33; 1 Cor. 12:13.

D. In His resurrection He breathed the Holy Spirit into His disciples; then in His ascension He poured out His Spirit upon His believers. This means that within the believers and upon them there was only the Spirit.

E. Now we are in Him. He is in the heavenlies, and so are we **—** Eph. 2:6.

Reference: *The Basic Revelation in The Holy Scriptures*, chapter 2.

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Message Two

## The Word's Incarnation and The Son's Living on the Earth

**I. The Word Becoming Flesh:**

A. The meaning the Word becoming flesh — John 1:1.
   1. The Word became flesh — John 1:14a.
   2. He was sent by God and with God — John 7:29.
   3. He came with the Father, the Son came from God the Father — John 6:46; 17:8.
   4. By the Spirit — Matt. 1:18, 20.
   5. God Manifest in the Flesh — 1 Tim. 3:16.

B. The fulfillment of the Word became flesh — John 1:14.
   1. Is in the first stage of the God's New Testament Economy mystery, God of eternity came into time, become a man in flesh, brought the infinite God into man, this is the biggest thing and the most mysterious in this universe.
   2. To mingle the divine nature with the human nature, but not issuing the third nature.
   3. Begotten in a virgin is of the Holy Spirit, have God's essence and human essence — Matt. 1:20.
   4. To produce God-man—Immanuel (v. 23), become a prototype of multiplication of God-man in a large number; He is a Man that in God's desire, a Man in God's plan, and a Man who accomplished God's statues.
   5. The decree to arrange the God's New Testament Economy, and everything that God's do in His economy, is the mingling between God and human, and even for the mingling between God and man. God cannot be without man, and man cannot be without God.

C. In Old Testament, many times and very often talk about the Word became flesh:
   1. The descendant of the woman, to destroy the enemy — Gen. 3:15; Heb. 2:14.
   2. The descendant of Abraham, through Him all the nations of the earth shall be blessed — Gen. 22:18; Gal. 3:3-4.
   3. The seed of David to build up the temple of God — 2 Sam. 7:12-14.
   4. Born of a virgin they shall call His name Emmanuel, which is translated, God with us **—** Mat. 1:23; Isa 7:14.
   5. It is God is also Human, and Father also the Son — Isa 9:6.
   6. From Bethlehem, And His goings forth are from ancient times — Mi. 5:2.

D. The Word became flesh to produce a Man who is in the flesh:
   1. According to the flesh, Christ came out of the seed of David that born become the Son of Man — Rm. 1:3.
   2. Typified by the bronze serpent — Num. 21:4-9; John 3:14.
   3. In the likeness of the serpent (flesh of sin), but did not have the poison — Rom.8:3b.
   4. Dealing with the flesh and sin, Satan and world — 2 Cor. 5:21; Heb. 2:14; John 12:31.

**II. The Son's Living on the Earth:**

A. For the creation of heaven and earth God need 6 days only, for God's incarnation it's only need 9 months, but for the human living on earth He need thirty three and half years. How come this Glorious God need such a long time to go through His human living on this earth? Inside it must be have a very great significance.

B. In His human living, the Lord expressing the genuine life of a man. Even though, He did not live according to His natural life. He rejected Himself, live based on His divine nature only. He did not express Himself, but Father. The gospel of John show us about the living of the Son on this earth — Flp.2:7-8:
   1. Is the embodiment of the Triune God, the fullness of the Godhead dwells in Him bodily — Col. 2:9; John 16:15a.
   2. God's Tabernacle and God's Temple — John 1:14a; 2:21.
   3. Coinhering with the Father **—** 14:10a, 11a; 17:21.

4. One with the Father **—** 10:30; 17:22.
5. Having the Father with Him —8:29; 16:32.
6. Living Because of the Father — 6:57a.
7. Anointed By the Father with the Spirit —Matt. 3:16-17; Luke 4:18a.
8. Working with the Father — John. 14:10b; 5:17, 19.
9. Working in the Name of the Father — 10:25.
10. Doing the Father's Will — 5:30; 6:38.
11. Speaking the Father's Word — 14:24; 7:16-17; 12:49-50.
12. Seeking the Father's Glory — 7:18
13. Expressing the Father — 17:4-9.

C. What He did and what He said, not comes out from Himself, but come from the Father who sent Him. Through His human living, He expresses the divine attribute, and carry out His human virtue, to express God in humanity.

D. Lord death in His human nature, to live according the divine nature. Before He went on the cross physically, He has been crucified everyday, for thirty three and half years to express the divine life.

E. This Lord's living is to set up a prototype for many God-Man in the coming age—to produce a large multiplication, His crucifixion and resurrection so God can be express through man.

Reference: *God's New Testament Economy*, ch 2

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Message Three

## Heresies Concerning the Person of Christ and the Principle of Antichrist

**I. Heresies concerning the person of Christ:**

A. Docetism:
   1. Denied Christ's humanity.
   2. Claimed that Jesus appeared human but really was only divine.

B. Ebionism:
   Denied Christ's deity.
   Claimed that Christ was not preexistent and that He had the Spirit only after His baptism.

C. Arianism:
   1. Denied Christ's complete deity.
   2. Claimed that Christ was the first and highest created being.

D. Appollinarianism:
   1. Denied the completeness of Christ's person.
   2. Claimed that the divine Logos took the place of Christ's human spirit.

E. Nestorianism:
   1. Denied the unity of Christ's person.
   2. Claimed that the human nature was swallowed up by the divine nature to create a new third nature.

**II. The principle of Antichrist:**

A. The word in 1 John 2:18 about "many antichrists" implies a principle, the principle of antichrist.

B. The Greek prefix "anti" has main meanings: "against" and "in place of", or "instead of."

C. On the one hand, to be an antichrist is to be against Christ; on the other hand, to be an antichrist is to have something instead of Christ, something that replaces Christ.

D. The principle of antichrist is first to deny something of what Christ is and then to replace Christ with something else.

Source: FTTA 1999.
Reading assignment:

- *Concerning the Person of Christ*, pp. 5-12.
- *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, pp. 224-233, 282-284.

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Message Four

# The Son's Death in His Humanity With His Divinity Through The Spirit

**I. The Son's death so precious and has a great significance :**

A. Whether or not a death is honorable, whether or not a death is dignified, depends on the source of this death.

B. In the New Testament there is a death which is full of significance. It is mysterious, excellent, marvelous, and wonderful because it is the death of a mysterious, excellent, marvelous, and wonderful Person. This is the death of the God-man:

1. This is the death of a Man who had God wrought into His intrinsic nature.
2. A Man mingled with the Triune God.
3. The Triune God, the Father, the Son, and the Spirit, is all wrapped up with this Man, so this Man was a Triune God-man.
4. Such a Man died a wonderful, excellent, mysterious, marvelous, and victorious death.

**II. The Factors Requiring the Son Need to Die :**

A. Because sin — John 1:29; Rom. 5:12.

B. Because out of sin came many sins — 1 Pet. 2:24.

C. Because an enemy—Satan—the source of sin — Heb. 2:14.

D. Because Satan produced a system called the world; when this wonderful Man lived on this earth, He confronted the satanic system, the world — John 12:31.

E. Because the old creation:

1. Whatever God had created became "old"; "old" it denotes corruption.
2. All the items in the universe became deteriorated through the invasion of death, causing everything to become old.
3. The universe was created by God, but it was ruined by Satan and made old by death.
4. We belong to the old creation, when bible talk about this old creation, we included mankind is in old creation — Rom. 6:6.

F. Because the religious regulations:

1. All things in the religious regulations create enmity—Eph. 2:14.
2. The religious ordinances became a separating factor between men—Eph. 2:15.

G. To release the divine life:

1. To release the divine life for the dispensing of this life into His chosen people—John. 12:24; 20:22.
2. If the divine life had never been released, it could never have been dispensed.

**III. The of the Son of God, can fulfill the seven requirements above, He was qualified to die such a death:**

A. In human history there was only one Person who was qualified to die such a death—He was the Son of God, He was a Man, He became flesh.

B. He was the Son of God, qualified to release the divine life:

1. He was God even the embodiment of the Triune God, the aggregate of the Father, of the Son, and of the Spirit — John 1:1, Col. 2:9.
2. He was divine, in Him was life, this life was released through His death.

C. He was human, qualified to shed the blood from a genuine man.

1. Man's redemption needs the genuine blood of a genuine man — Heb. 9:22.
2. Look from the side of God He was the Son of God, having God's life, qualified to do everything, but if He does not have human blood, He not qualified to be a Redeemer for man.
3. He was a Man, a mysterious Man, that excellent and marvelous.

4. Our Savior and Redeemer is a complete God, also a perfect Man. As a complete God, He had the divine life, and as a perfect Man, He had human blood. Therefore He qualified to be our Redeemer.
5. He had a genuine blood of a genuine man, His death takes away our sin and sins, and His blood cleanses us from all sin—John 1:29; 1 Cor. 15:3, 1 John 1:7.

D. He became flesh, qualified to terminate the old creation:
1. When God became a man, He did not become a new man. When the Son of God became a man, man had become old and man had become flesh.
2. God created man, but God did not create the flesh, but rather the man God created was very good; this God-created man fell became the corrupted, fallen flesh through sin—Gen. 1:31; 6:3.
3. John 1:14 says, *The Word became man (flesh)*.
4. In chapter 3 verse 14, Son of Man is typified as a serpent. It only had the form, the likeness, of the serpent, without the poisonous nature.
5. Romans 8:3 says, *… sent His Son in the likeness of the flesh of sin…*
6. The fallen man had sin, but Christ did not have sin; He was in the likeness of the fallen man, but He did not have the fallen nature of the fallen man.
7. His death was the death of the old creation, His death terminate the old creation.

**IV. Things that have been accomplished by the death of the all inclusive Christ:**

The death of Christ on the cross is to redeem us, and the salvation has been fulfilled through redemption. Redemption is objective, salvation is subjective. Christ died on the cross with many status, He destroyed God's enemy—Satan (all evil things, corruption and pollution that brought into the universe). Therefore, His death is all inclusive.

A. Crucified flesh of sin — Gal. 5:24, Rom. 8:3b.
B. Condemned the sin and bears the sins: 1 Pet. 2:24, 2 Cor. 5:21a, Rom. 7:18; 8:3.
C. Chase away Satan that rule over the death and all that related to human flesh — Num. 21:4-9; Rom. 8:3; Gen. 3:15; Heb. 2:14.
D. Condemned the world and put away the ruler of the world — Devil: John 12:31; Gal. 6:14b; 1 John 2:15[2.]
E. Crucified the old man — Rom. 6:6; Gal. 2:20a; 6:14b; 1 Cor. 15:45b.
F. Terminate the old creation — Heb. 2:9; Col. 1:15; Rom. 6:6; Col. 1:20.
G. Abolishing the law of the commandments in ordinances — Eph. 2:15.
H. As a grain of wheat to release the divine life from within to produce many grains. John 12:24; 1 Pet. 1:3; John 19:34b; Acts. 20:28; Heb. 9:22; Eph. 5:29-30; John 3:14-15.

**V. The Death of the Son in His Humanity with His Divinity through the Spirit:**

A. When Christ was dying on the cross, He was not only the Son of Man, but also the Son of God. He was one Person with two natures—the human nature and the divine nature. This was His very being and this is related to His intrinsic nature — 1 Pet. 3:8.
B. He was the Son of God through the conceiving of the Holy Spirit essentially. Jesus was born to be the Son of God essentially because He was conceived of the Spirit of God. Nothing can change His essential nature — Luke 1:35
C. His conception was God's incarnation became flesh; hence, He was God — John 1:14:
1. Jesus was God when He was in the manger as a little babe — Isa. 9:6.
2. When He was put on the cross He was God, nothing can change His essence. He was always with the Father and by the Spirit.

D. God Leaving Him Economically While He was Dying:
1. Jesus was conceived of the Holy Spirit and the divine element of the Holy Spirit became His very essence.
2. When He was thirty, after His baptism, the Holy Spirit descended upon Him as a dove, as His power to fulfill His ministry — Matt. 3:16.
3. This economical Spirit remained with Him for three and a half years until the time He was crucified to die for us. God left Him economically — Matt. 27:45-46.
4. Whether God came economically or whether God left Him economically did not change His intrinsic essence or nature.
5. When Jesus was dying on the cross, God was dying there (see Hymns 296).

6. The Triune God was involved with the conception of Jesus, with the living of Jesus on this earth, and with the death of Jesus on the cross. The Triune God was altogether wrapped up with Jesus.
7. But if He died merely as a man, although His humanity qualifies Him to shed His precious blood, but the effectiveness and the efficacy of His death would not be eternal.
8. The efficacy of His death is eternal. His efficacious death can cover millions of believers.
9. His humanity qualifies Him to die for us, and His divinity secures the eternal efficacy of His death.

E. The blood He shed on the cross was not only the blood of Jesus the Man, but also of the Son of God — 1 John 1:7.
   1. The blood of Jesus the Man qualifies His redemption for us as men.
   2. The efficacy of His redemption has to be secured by His divinity and it has been secured for eternity by Him as the Son of God. Therefore, His redemption is the eternal redemption — Heb. 9:12.

F. Through His death, He release the divine life of God — John 12:24, 31-33.

G. His death was also through the Spirit; He offered Himself to death through the Spirit; this indicates that even in His death as the Son of God, He was with the Father and by the Spirit — Heb. 9:14.

H. His death accomplished an eternal redemption by the blood of the Son of God and through the eternal Spirit — John 9:12, 14; 1 John 1:7.

I. As the redeeming Lamb, He was foreknown before the foundation of the world, and was slain from the foundation of the world — 1 Pet. 1:19-20; Rev. 13:8.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, chapter 3

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Message Five ~ Six

## The Son's Resurrection in His Divinity with His Humanity

Scripture Reading: 1 Pet. 3:18; Rom. 1:4; 1 Cor. 15:44a; John 10:17-18; 1 Thess. 4:14; Rom. 10:9; 8:11; Acts 13:33; Rom. 8:29; 1 Pet. 1:3; Heb. 2:11-12; John 12:24; 1 Cor. 15:45b

**I. The Son's resurrection—in His divinity with His humanity:**

A. The meaning of resurrection:

1. Death is a mystery, resurrection is even more mysterious than death.
2. When a grain of wheat is sown into the earth, it dies; then after the grain, dies it grows up in resurrection — John 12:24.
3. If we sowed a little rock into the earth, that little rock would never die and neither would it grow. The reason for this is that there is no life in the rock:
   a. Anything that does not have life can never die.
   b. Death, however, is followed by resurrection.
4. Christ has resurrected and that we Christians all will be resurrected — 1 Cor. 15:4; 1 Thess. 4:16-17:
   a. The resurrection of Christ was the first fruit. Then at His coming back there will be another resurrection—the resurrection of the believers — 1 Cor. 15:20; 1 Thess. 4:16-17.
   b. After the millennium of a thousand years, the resurrection of the dead and perished ones.

B. Death brings in resurrection and resurrection is the issue of life.

1. Christ was born to live and He lived to die.
2. His goal was to die, The Word (Triune God) became flesh to die and that He was pressed until His death would be accomplished. This shows that He expected to die.
3. His death was not an end but an initiation. His death ushered in resurrection.
4. If the grain of wheat did not have life and if it did not die, it would never resurrect. Because a grain of wheat has life, it dies and this death releases the life in resurrection.
5. Jesus Christ was the Triune God-man. He was the Father, the Son, the Spirit and the Man:
   a. He who was likened to a grain of wheat.
   b. When the Man Jesus was put to death, the Father, the Son, and the Spirit with this Man rose up from death.
   c. The Man Jesus was the shell of the grain and within this Man, this shell, were the Father, the Son, and the Spirit. While He was dying, the Father, the Son, and the Spirit were growing to rise up.

C. How could God die?

1. Actually, God only passed through death.
2. None of us can die. What will die is only our body.
   a. What dies is only our body. Our spirit and our soul never die.
   b. After our body dies, our spirit and our soul go to Paradise to wait the resurrection of our body.
3. When Christ died on the cross, the part of Him that died was His human body:
   a. The divine essence was in His spirit.
   b. His spirit never died.
   c. When Christ was dying on the cross, He was being put to death not in His entire being, but only in His flesh.
   d. His spirit only suffered death and passed through death.

D. When Christ died He was put to death in the flesh, but He was made alive by the Holy Spirit — 1 Pet. 3:18.

1. When Christ died on the cross, the Roman soldiers and the persecutor were putting Jesus to die, the Triune God was making Jesus alive in His spirit!
2. At that time, The Triune God was in His Spirit, the Triune God, the Father, the Son, and the Spirit, was making Him alive, strengthening Him, and empowering Him in His spirit. Christ in His living spirit went to these rebellious angels to proclaim His victory.

3. Death never put the Lord Jesus down; Death only put His body down.
4. Death brought in His physical body into the grave for three days, but death cannot overcame His Spirit.
5. In these three days, in His empowered spirit He went to proclaim His victory to who had formerly disobeyed in the days of Noah — 1 Pet. 3:19-20.

E. While He was being killed, His resurrection began on the cross:
1. When Christ was killed by human being, the resurrection was taking place at the same time.
2. When the Roman soldiers were putting Jesus to death—this is an outwardly matter—but the Father, the Son, and the Spirit was rising up from within Him—this was the beginning of the resurrection.

F. The Son's resurrection is in His divinity to bring the resurrection in His humanity:
1. He resurrected first in His spirit, then He resurrected in His physical body; firstly in His divinity, then in His humanity.
2. Christ has only one physical body, His flesh; has one Spirit; His divine part from divine element; His flesh was His human part with His human essence, and His spirit had the Spirit as His divine part with His divine essence.
3. Before His body was resurrected, while He was dying on the cross, His Spirit was resurrected.
4. In the morning of His resurrection, His body was resurrected; By this time the inward moving of His resurrection by the Triune God was manifested; this mean He was manifested — Rom. 1:4.
5. His resurrection began from His spirit and was accomplished in His body.
6. His resurrection was a process that lasted for about three days, beginning from the time when He was being killed on the cross and fully accomplished at the time of His body's resurrection. When His body was resurrected, He was fully designated and manifested to be the Son of God.

**II. By resurrection became the Spirit for the multiplication:**

A. Christ brought humanity signed as the Son of God:
1. Two natures of Christ—divinity and humanity:
a. The human nature of Christ—His humanity:
b. Christ came out of the seed of David according to the flesh, and was designated the Son of God — Rom. 1:3; John. 3:14.
c. Typified by the bronze serpent — Num. 21:4-9.
d. In the likeness of the serpent (flesh of sin), but did not have the poison — Rom.8:3b.
e. Dealing with the flesh and sin, Satan and world — 2 Cor. 5:21; Heb. 2:14; John 12:31.
b. The divine nature of Christ—His divinity:
b. Who was designated the Son of God in power according to the Spirit of holiness — Rom. 1:4.
c. The Powerful One (lit. in His Power).
d. Came from resurrection—The Triune God was manifested in Christ — John. 11:25.
2. Christ death:
a. Because of sin, the righteous one replacing the unrighteous one, to bring His believer into God's presence.
b. In one side, He put to death in flesh.
c. In the other side, in the spirit He is living. Christ went to the prison to proclaimed to the fallen angels (perhaps, God's victory, accomplished through His incarnation in Christ and Christ's death in the flesh, over Satan their leader) — 1 Pet. 3:18-19.
3. By resurrection He was designated the Son of God with His humanity —Rom. 1:4, footnote 2.
a. Christ humanity—flesh—not divine but human.
b. Through resurrection, His humanity was sanctified, uplifted and changed into His divinity, also into His divine glory — John 12:23; Luke 24:25-26:
1) Through Spirit of Holiness.
2) In His divine power.
3) Came from resurrection—The Triune God was manifested in Christ.

4) To be the Son of God.
5) Meaning, He was begotten by God in resurrection — Acts. 13:33:
   a) Became the Firstborn of God.
   b) Among many brothers; we as the many sons of God — Rom. 8:29.
6) God has regenerated us through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from among the dead. We must realize that when Christ was resurrected we were regenerated. When He was resurrected, we as His redeemed people were resurrected in Him also — 1 Pet. 1:13; Eph. 2:5-6.

4. Two status of His Sonship:
   a. God's only begotten Son — John 1:18.
   b. The Firstborn Son of God — Rom. 8:29.
      1) This One who has both the divine nature and human nature—divinity and humanity.
      2) From His resurrection, through His ascension and His coming back, forever and ever — Acts. 13:33; Matt. 26:64; Acts. 7:55-56; Rev. 1:13; Heb. 1:6; John 1:51 footnote 3.
      3) Among many children of God, among His many brothers, became the Firstborn of God — Rom. 8:29; Heb. 2:10-12.

B. The result of resurrection:
1. Three days after Christ died, overcame the death, came out from the tomb, has been raised from the dead. Base on Acts 13:33, Lord resurrected in His humanity, born to be the Son of God. Therefore, the resurrection of the Lord was a birth; when He resurrected He was being born.
2. Being Born as the Firstborn of God **—** Acts. 13:33; Psalm. 2:7; Rom. 1:4; 8:29; Heb. 1:3-6.
3. For His body regenerate His believer:
   Through the resurrection and the born of Christ, all God's chosen people, was being born together with Christ in Christ resurrection. Because of these, 1 Peter 1:3 said that we have been regenerated through the resurrection of Christ. All the believers, was being born once in universal birth.
4. Becoming a Life-Giving Spirit — 1 Cor. 15:45b.
5. Holy anointing oil in Exodus 30, are the type of the Spirit.

C. Training in resurrection:
1. The living in resurrection:
   a. Accompany the disciples, moving and living with the disciples.
   b. Being one with the disciples.
2. To train the disciples to experience the Lord's invisible presence
   a. Few times He appeared and disappeared to train His disciples to know His invisible presence.
   b. He also trained His disciples in their living to depend on Him and on His nourishment.
   c. This of His invisible presence is inward thing and real one, bring Lord's element into the disciples.

D. By resurrection became the Spirit for the multiplication:
1. Through the breath in resurrection — John 20:22.
2. The second transfiguration of Christ—many sons of God become the corporate manifestation of God.

Reference: *God's New Testament Economy*, chapter 4 ~ 5

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**
**TRUTH CLASS—THE FULL MINISTRY OF CHRIST**

Message Seven

# The Son's Sending of the Spirit

**I. The First Section of God's New Testament Economy—The disciples were with the Son (with the Father and by the Spirit).**

**II. The Second Section of God's New Testament Economy—The disciples began to be with the Spirit (the Spirit as the Son, with the Father):**

A. The Son is the Father, also the Spirit:

1. The Son and The Father are one — John 14:8-11 :
1. When man has seen the Son, he has seen the Father — v. 9.
2. The Son was in the Father and the Father was in Him. He and the Father lived together, worked together, and spoke together. When the Son spoke outwardly, the Father worked inwardly — v. 10.
2. The Son and The Spirit—another Comforter — v. 16-20:
   a. The Son was the first Comforter, with the disciples, but not in the disciples.
   b. The Son going to the Father (v.12), He asked the Father to give the disciples another Comforter, is the Spirit of reality, that would not only be with the disciples but would also be in the disciples.
   c. The Son would not leave the disciples orphans, He was coming to the disciples (v.18) His going was His coming.
3. The Son being the Father and The Spirit — v. 26:
   a. "*But the Comforter, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in My name, He will teach you all things, and remind you of all things which I said to you*." "I" in verse 26 is *The Son*.
   b. The phrase "*in My name*" can be decipherable as the sending Father, also can be decipherable as the Spirit who is sent.
   c. The Father in the Son's name sent the Spirit, this means that the sending Father and the Son are one, its mean that the Father as the Son sent the Spirit to come.
   d. The Spirit was sent in the name of the Son, this denotes that the Spirit and also the Son are one, its mean also that the Father sending the Spirit as the Son to come.
   e. The Father sending the Spirit as the Son to come, this indicates that the Son is the Spirit; The Father as the Son sending the Spirit to come; this indicates that the Son is the Father.
   f. Isaiah 9:6 shows us that the Son is the Father.
   g. The Lord is the Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:17.
   h. So, the Son who asked, the Father who sent, and the Spirit who was sent, are one.

B. The Spirit as the consummation of the Triune God reaching the believers:

1. *But the Comforter, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in My name* — John 14:26.
   a. The Father is the Sender One.
   b. The Spirit as the Son is the Sent One.
2. *But when the Comforter comes, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of reality, who proceeds from the Father* — John 15:26.
1. The Son is the Sender One.
2. The Spirit will come with the Father as the Sent One.
3. The Father and the Son are both the Sender and the Sent One, but The Spirit is only the Sent One, He is the Son with the Father, thus, He is the consummation of the divine Trinity to come to us:
   a. In the first section of God's New Testament economy, we saw the Son with the Father by the Spirit, who was the embodiment of the Triune God. This embodiment of the Triune God was in one Person, Jesus Christ.
   b. In the second section of God's New Testament economy, we see the Spirit. The Spirit is as the Son with the Father to be the consummation of the Triune God in the church — John 14:17.
4. The Spirit including The Son's Accomplishments, Attainments, and Obtainments:
   a. The accomplishments:

1) Became flesh.
2) Human living.
3) The all-inclusive death.
4) An excellent and marvelous resurrection.
5) An exalting ascension**.**

b. The attainments:
1) The sphere: the highest place in the universe — Eph. 4:10.
2) Virtues: Being a mingling of the divine attributes with the human virtues, issuing in a life in the highest standard of morality.
3) Position: His being crowned with glory and honor in ascension — Heb. 2:9.

3. The obtainments:
1) The kingship — Acts. 5:31; Rev. 17:14.
2) The lordship — Acts. 2:36.
3) The headship — Eph. 1:22; Rev. 1:5.
4) All authority — Matt. 28:18.
5) The Spirit coming into us with the Father including:
a) Father's plan — Eph. 1:4.
b) Father's choosing — v.4.
c) The Father's predestination — v.5.
d) Father's glory (John 17:22).

4. The Spirit being all-inclusive:
1) Through the process.
2) Compound.
3) All-inclusive.
4) Life-giving.
5) Dwell in us.
6) Intensified seven fold.
7) The ultimate consummation.

C. Convicting the World — John 16:7-11:
1. Concerning the sin—related to Adam, we fallen human beings were all born of sin.
2. Concerning righteousness—related to Christ, believe in the resurrected Christ, made us justified in Him.
3. Concerning judgment—related to Satan. If we do not repent of the sin and believe, then we will remain in sin and share the judgment of Satan for eternity.

D. The transmission of the Divine Trinity — v. 13-15:
1. The Spirit of reality, comes, He will guide you into all the reality.
2. The processed Triune God is and has is to be our element, our essence, our being, making the processed Triune God the very essence of our being. Thus, we all become God-men.

E. The resurrected Christ breathing Himself into the disciples as the Spirit — John 20:19-22:
1. The breath is one person with the breather—these indicates that Christ the Son in resurrection is the Spirit.
2. Through the secret breathing, the disciples get the essence of the Spirit who dwells in them.
3. All those natural disciples were enlivened, quickened, and filled with the Spirit. They became persons not living by themselves but by the Spirit, persons one with the Triune God intrinsically in their essence.

Reference: *God's New Testament Economy*, chapter 6

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

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Message Eight ~ Nine

## The Son's Ascension and the Baptism in the Spirit

**I. The Triune God through all the process became the all inclusive and the life-giving Spirit, the breath of life, breathed into the disciples:**

A. On the day of His resurrection He came back to the disciples as the pneumatic Christ and He breathed Himself into them as the Spirit of life.

B. He entered into them to be their life, to be the essence of their new being.

C. This breath, which is His indwelling presence, is life to us; it is our essential being. Now we are one with Him in the essential way of life.

**II. The Lord's training to the disciples:**

A. After the resurrection, before the Lord's ascension, He spent forty days with the disciples, to trained them, so they enjoy and be familiar the Lord's invisible presence — Acts. 1:3.

B. The Lord's invisible presence, more practical, more excellent, more precious, more abundant, more real then His visible presence; the invisible presence unlimited by space and time.

**III. The Son's ascension:**

A. His incarnation brought Him into a new stage, a stage for Him to live on this earth for thirty-three and a half years, a stage for Him to be a man living God. His ascension brought Him into a third stage. This stage is that of a resurrected man living in the heavens to execute the things God determined on this earth. This One in the heavens is the Head.

B. The disciples they were filled with the divine life essentially, but they were not qualified to carry out God's economy.

C. The resurrected Christ had to ascend to the heavens to be exalted by God, and to be given by God the kingship, the lordship, and the headship over all things. He also obtained the throne, the glory, and all the authority in the universe.

**IV. The disciples' prayer:**

A. In the forty days of the resurrected Lord's training, the disciples learned the lesson, so, after the Lord ascended to the heavens, they could pray together for ten days in Jerusalem in a threatening environment — Acts. 1:12-15.

B. In this ten days praying among them there was no disputation, no fighting, only oneness. Before the Lord's death, the twelve were still fighting over who was going to be greater — Luke 22:24.

C. They did not care for their safety or their peace. They cared for the Lord's commission, for the Lord's testimony, (Acts 1:8; Luke 24:48), and for the preaching in His name of the gospel (Luke 24:47; Matt. 28:19).

**V. The pouring out the of the Spirit**

A. The Head was sitting on the throne in the heavens executing God's administration, and the Body, represented by the one hundred twenty, was coordinating with the Head for ten days to carry out God's move on the earth.

B. Then on the day of Pentecost, the Holy Spirit was poured out from the Head and by the Head to the disciples and on the disciples — Acts 2:17-18.

C. This means heaven was brought to earth, and God was poured out on man. This pouring out was not essential, but economical. It was not for life, but for power, for administration.

D. They became not only spiritual persons, but heavenly persons. They became the very joint between heaven and earth. They joined the heavens and the earth, and they were cooperating with the heavenly Head to carry out God's eternal administration.

E. This was the pouring out of the fully consummated Spirit by the heavenly Head, the pouring out of the ultimate consummation of the processed Triune God by the resurrected and ascended Christ, to accomplish the baptism of His Body in the Spirit.

**VI. The all-inclusive and consummated spirit has two that is essential and economical:**

A. The Spirit that dwells within the believers and the Spirit that descends upon the believers are not two Spirits, but one Spirit in two aspects.

B. From His incarnation through His resurrection, He became this Spirit of breath, which is for life intrinsically and essentially. Then after His ascension, He became the Spirit of wind, which is for power.

C. The indwelling Spirit is the resurrected Christ, and the outpoured Spirit is the exalted Christ. This Christ in exaltation is the mantle Spirit, which is the Spirit of power and the Spirit of authority.

D. This power from on high was the heavenly uniform to be put on God's chosen and prepared people for their qualification to carry out God's administration.

E. He was breathed into them on the evening of the day of the resurrection as their life essentially, and He was poured out upon them on the day of Pentecost as their authority, as their mantle, as their clothing, as their heavenly uniform economically.

F. "Essential" refers to the existence, to the being, and to the life for existence; "economical" refers to economy, work, and function.

**VII. The authority of the exalted Christ:**

A. In the Son's ascension God exalted Him, and His exaltation includes the highest attainment.

B. In His ascension He obtained the kingship the lordship, the enthronement, the headship, and the glory and honor. All authority has been given to Him in heaven and on earth. All these attainments of Christ are not essential for us and have nothing to do with us intrinsically, but these attainments have everything to do with us economically — Acts 5:31; Rev. 17:14; Acts 2:36; Heb. 12:2; Eph. 1:22, Heb. 2:9; Matt. 28:18; Eph. 1:20-21.

C. Our Christ has ascended and that God has exalted Him. He is the top One in the whole universe sitting on the unique throne in the universe.

D. After His ascension, His exaltation, He poured out Himself as authority on His disciples. This poured out, exalted Christ is the authority of the entire universe, and this poured out, exalted Christ has become our clothing, our uniform.

**VIII. Baptized into the Body of Christ to carry out the divine administration by the authority of the exalted Christ:**

A. The breath breathed into us makes us the members of Christ who are so living and full of life. But all the members of Christ need to be put together to form one Body.

B. The baptism in the Holy Spirit is the outpouring of the Triune God, consummated in the all-inclusive compound Spirit, by the heavenly Head upon His Body on this earth, not for life, but for administration, not as life essentially, but as power economically to carry out God's economy.

C. To be baptized in the all-inclusive consummated Spirit does not only put us, the believers, all together to be the Body of Christ, but also positions us to drink Him to receive the all-bountiful supply of the processed and transmitted Triune God, that we may be nourished to be the strong and active members of the Body of Christ for the carrying out of God's eternal plan — Phil. 1:19.

D. The resurrected Christ's breathing of the Spirit of life germinates us, making us the members of Christ, arid the ascended Christ's baptizing in the Spirit of power, putting us into the Triune God, makes all the members of Christ one Body, brought into God's kingdom by the Spirit of power poured upon them by the ascended Christ in His ascension to execute God's administration, like the one hundred twenty disciples in Acts 1.

E. This baptism in the Spirit is symbolized by the baptism in water, to be baptized is to be baptized into the Triune God, baptism also to be put into Lord Jesus, then in the Epistles, the apostle defines baptism. He said to be baptized is to be baptized in the Spirit, which means to be baptized into the Triune God. This baptism brings us into an organic union with the Triune God — Acts. 9:17-18; 10:44-48; Matt. 28:19; Acts. 8:16; 19:5; 1 Cor. 12:13.

F. The exalted Christ has been given to be the Head over all things, through the baptism in the Spirit, the believers were put together to form the Body of Christ, joined to Him as the Head. Christ is the Head and we are His Body, joined together to be the great universal man, that is the church. He is also the Head over all things "to the church." His government is to the church that it may be carried out through the church. The Head executes His government to the church and through the church to reach every part of the earth — Eph. 1:22.

G. In Revelation, the all-inclusive and consummated Spirit, becomes the seven Spirits, which are the seven lamps of fire burning before the throne of God, to carry out God's administration, such a picture shows us that the exalted Christ on the throne as the Head, carries out His administration by the seven Spirits as the lamps of fire through the churches as the lampstands — Rev. 1:4; 3:1; 4:5; 5:6.

H. Whenever the saints on this earth, representing the Body of Christ, pray about the situation of this earth, the throne in the heavens immediately takes action to perform the things on this earth to carry out God's administration — Rev. 8:3-5.

**IX. Preaching the gospel to carry out God's administration**

A. Preaching the gospel is a part of the carrying out of God's administration to spread the kingdom of God; this can be done by the people full of the breath within, and filled with the wind without.

B. After the ascension and exaltation of the Savior the disciples went out to preach the gospel to the whole creation, the disciples went and discipled the nations not merely by preaching the Word, but even more by exercising the authority of the Head, five kinds of miracles following the preaching of the gospel by the disciples, this brought His believers into the foretaste of the works of power of the coming age — Mark. 16:15.

C. The proper understanding of the casting out of demons and of the speaking of new tongues is to realize that they are related to God's governmental administration. All of the items listed in Mark 16:17-18 are the display of the governmental authority of Christ's administration.

**X. The Need of an appropriate understanding and application**

A. All the things mentioned in Mark 16, is about the Lord poured Himself out as the Spirit of economy upon His believers, a new age began; from the ascension of Christ up until today, here and there, now and then, new tongues were spoken, illnesses were healed, demons were cast out, and dead people were raised up.

B. At the time of Pentecost and in Peter's ministry there were miracles of healing and even of resurrection (Acts 3:6-8; 9:32-42). In the earlier stage of the Apostle Paul's ministry there were also healing miracles. But in the later stage of Paul's ministry he charged his intimate co-worker, Timothy, to use a little wine for the sake of his stomach and frequent weaknesses — 1 Tim. 5:23.

C. Paul and his co-workers were under the exercise of the inner life in this time of suffering rather than under the power of the outward gift. The former is of grace in life; the latter of gift in power—miraculous power.

D. I hope this kind of word rescues us from our natural concepts, in the decline of the church and in suffering for the church, the gift of power is not as much needed as the grace in life. Too much miraculous healing distracts people from the inner life.

**XI. The taste of the work of power of the coming age:**

A. Two kind enjoyment of Christ:
   1. The good Word, is the beginning of the teaching of Christ, the good word refers to Christ in His earthly ministry, including His incarnation, His human living, His crucifixion, and His resurrection — Heb. 6:1.
   2. The teaching of righteousness refers to Christ in His heavenly ministry, including His ascension, His exaltation, and all His attainments and obtainments in His exaltation — Heb. 5:13.

B. The second enjoyment
   1. For God to carry out His New Testament economy, there is also the need of the miraculous works, miracles, such as healing the diseases, casting out the demons, swallowing up the death poison, controlling the Devil, which is signified in the picking

up of the serpents, and speaking in tongues to diminish the differences, the separations, and the divisions of mankind.

2. Today in the church life we can have such a foretaste. Satan and the demons have no ground among us, and the language barrier is no longer a problem. It has been overcome by all speaking the same word of Christ—the word concerning Christ. Also, we are being healed, and the death poison is being removed, the believers, who are genuinely one with the exalted Christ, have been brought into a foretaste of the coming age.

C. Due to our natural understanding and our natural desire, we treasure this kind of taste of the miraculous things more than the marvelous earthly ministry and the excellent heavenly ministry of the all-inclusive Christ for our enjoyment today. So we must enjoy the all inclusive Christ as the blessing of the New Testament.

**XII. The New Testament Blessing:**

A. Regeneration — John 3:3, 6; 1 Pet. 1:23.
B. Divine nature and divine life — 1 John 5:11-12; 2 Pet. 1:4.
C. The indwelling Spirit — Rom. 8:9, 16.
D. Transformation — 2 Cor. 3:18.
E. Be mingled with God and can join to Him as one — 1 Cor. 6:17.
F. Shall be like God and have the same image as God, to enter into God's glory — 1 John 3:2; 2 Cor. 3:18; 1 Pet. 5:10.

**XIII. The content of God's New Testament Economy—A Person:**

A. The content of God's New Testament economy is a Person who is both divine and human, a Person who is both God and man.
B. He has passed through incarnation, human living, crucifixion, resurrection, and ascension and has consummated in the all-inclusive, processed, compound, life-giving, and indwelling Spirit imparted into us in His resurrection as life to us, and poured out upon us in His ascension as power to us that we may live the divine life to express God and move with the divine power, economically, to carry out God's economy.

**XIV. We must be those enjoying the New Testament blessings and, if the Lord wills, we will also enjoy the subsidiary blessings which are the works of power of the age to come, we should focus on the New Testament blessings, which are the main blessings.**

**XV. God's New Testament Economy concerning the Spirit in The Acts**

A. The baptism in the Spirit:
   1. One happened on the day of Pentecost when the one hundred twenty were baptized — Acts. 2:1-4.
   2. And the other was in the house of Cornelius — Acts 10:24, 44-46.
   3. The Head, Christ, accomplished the baptism in the Spirit on His entire Body. All the Jewish believers need to realize that they were baptized in the Spirit on the day of Pentecost with Peter and the one hundred twenty. The Gentile believers must realize that they were all baptized in the house of Cornelius.

B. The outward filling and inward filling
   1. Being filled outwardly (Gk. pletho), being filled inwardly (pleroo), become full (pleres).
   2. Being filled by the Spirit outwardly (Gk. pletho) and receiving the power are for the work. Being filled by the Spirit inwardly (pleroo) is for life. Become full of the Spirit inwardly (pleres) is for life — Luke 24:49; Acts 1:5-8; 13:52; 6:3, 5; 7:55; 11:24.

C. The leading of the Spirit — Acts. 8:29, 39; 13:2; 15:28; 16:6-7; 20:23, 28; 14:23; 21: 4, 11: The apostles and the disciples in Acts were people living, moving, working, laboring, traveling, and doing everything by the leading of the Spirit.

D. These are the members of the Body of Christ, inwardly they were filled with the Spirit of life essentially, outwardly they were filled with the Spirit of power economically, as a result they are belong to the Spirit and become full of Spirit, living and moving on this earth for the testimony of the resurrected and exalted Christ and the fulfillment of God's plan according to His eternal economy.

Reference: *God's New Testament Economy*, Ch. 7 ~ 10

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message One

## The Spirit's Application

**I. The Spirit throughout the Word:**

A. The Spirit of God — Gen. 1:2.
B. The Spirit of Jehovah — Judg. 3:10; Ezek. 11:5.
C. The Holy Spirit — Matt. 1:18, 20; Luke 1:35.
D. The Spirit Being Not Yet — John 7:39.
E. The Compound Spirit — Ex. 30:22-30.
F. The Spirit of Jesus — Acts 16:6-7.
G. The Spirit of Christ — Rom. 8:9.
H. The Spirit of Jesus Christ — Phil. 1:19.
I. The Spirit of the Lord — 2 Cor. 3:17; Act 2:36.
J. The Spirit Identical to the Lord (the pneumatic Christ) — John 14:23, 17.
K. The Life-giving Spirit — 1 Cor. 15:45; 2 Cor. 3:6; John 6:63.
L. The Spirit of Life — Rom. 8:2.
M. The Seven Spirits of God — Rev. 1:4; 4:5; 5:6.
N. The Spirit — Rev. 2:7, 11, 17, 29; 3:6, 13, 22; 14:13; 22:17.

**II. The Function of the Spirit:**

A. The Spirit gives life to the believers — 1 Cor. 15:45; 2 Cor. 3:6.
B. Regenerates them in their spirit — John 3:5-6.
C. Anoints the believers — 2 Cor. 1:21.
D. Seals them — Eph. 1:13; 4:30; 2 Cor. 1:22a.
E. A pledge of God given to them—the guarantee that God is our inheritance, proves that we are God's inheritance — 2 Cor. 1:22b.
F. He is also the bountiful supply to the believers — Phil. 1:19.
G. He sanctifies us, not just positionally but dispositionally and experientially as well — 1 Pet. 1:2; Rom. 15:16.
H. Transforms the believers — 2 Cor. 3:18
I. All believers have been baptized in this one Spirit into one body, on the day of Pentecost and in the house of Cornelius — 1 Cor. 12:13.
J. We have been baptized and have been given to drink this one Spirit — 1 Cor. 12:13.
K. The inward aspect: On that day the resurrected Lord came back to His disciples and breathed Himself into them. This was altogether for life, the inner life — John 20:22.
L. The outward aspect: At Pentecost He poured out the Spirit upon the disciples like a mighty wind—for power (Acts 2:1-2). Freed the believers from the bondage of the letter of the law — 2 Cor. 3:17.
M. To transform the believers to the same image of Christ — 2 Cor. 3:18.

**III. The consummation of the Triune God—the Compound Spirit.**

**IV. Enjoying all the bountiful supply of the Spirit through the Word — John 6:63; Eph. 6:17; Rom. 10:8.**

**V. The human Spirit — Zech. 12:1; Prov. 20:27; Rom 8:16; 2 Tim. 4:22.**

Reference: *Basic Revelation in the Holy Scriptures*, chapter 3.

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Two

## The Meaning of the Word *Spirit* in the Bible and the Basic Revelation Concerning God and Man in the Holy Scriptures

**I. The meaning of the word *Spirit* in the Bible:**

A. The Hebrew equivalent of the word *spirit* is RUACH, denoting:
   1. Spirit — Ezek. 37:1.
   2. Breath — Ezek. 37:5.
   3. Win — Ezek. 37:9.

B. The Greek equivalent of the word *spirit* is PNEUMA, denoting:
   1. Spirit — John 3:5-6.
   2. Breath — Rev. 11:11.
   3. Wind — John 3:8.

**II. The basic revelation concerning God and man in Holy Scriptures:**

A. Concerning God:
   1. "God is Spirit," denoting God's essence, substance — John 4:24.
   2. "The Spirit of God," denoting that the Spirit is God — Gen. 1:2b.
   3. "The name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit," denoting the Divine Trinity and indicating the God is triune — Matt. 28:19b.
      a. The three of the Divine Trinity coexist and coinhere as one God — John 14:10-11, 26; 15:26; 10:30.
      b. They are distinct but not separate — John 8:29, 16b; 16:32; Acts 10:38; Luke 4:1a, 18a.

B. Concerning man:
   1. Created by God as a tripartite man — Gen. 2:7:
      a. With a body formed with the dust of the ground, as man's outer frame.
      b. With a spirit produced of God's breath of God, as man's inmost organ.
      c. With a soul, the issue of God's breath breathed into the nostrils of the body formed of dust, as man's inner being (person).
   2. The spirit of man was created by God, in a particular sense, to complete God's purpose in the creation of the heavens and the earth — Zech. 12:1; Isa. 42:5; Job 32:8.
   3. Man's spirit is distinct from him soul — Heb. 4:12; 1 Thess. 5:23a.

C. God is Spirit for man to contact Him and receive Him into man, and man has a spirit or man to contact God and contain God that God and man may have an organic union — John 4:24; 1 John 4:13; 2 Tim. 4:22a; 1 Cor. 6:17.

Reference: *The Spirit with Our Spirit*, chapter 1

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Three

## The Attributes of The Spirit

**I. The Attributes of The Spirit:**

A. Life — Rom. 8:2; 1:17; 5:10, 17; 6:4, 22-23; 8:6b, 10; 1 Tim. 3:16; 1 John 1:2.
B. Love — Rom. 15:30; Gal. 5:22; Col. 1:8; John 13:34-35.
C. Joy — Rom. 14:17; 1 Thess. 1:6; Gal. 5:22.
D. Comfort — Acts 9:31.
E. Holiness for sanctification — 1 Pet. 1:2, 15-16; Rom. 15:16; 6:19, 22; 1 Thess. 4:8; Heb. 3:7; 1 Cor. 6:11; 2 Thess. 2:13.
F. Reality — John 14:17, 6; 15:26; 16:3, 7; 1 John 5:6.
G. Power — Luke 4:14; Rom. 15:13; Acts 1:4-5; John 20:22.

Reference: *Conclusion of the New Testament*, Msg. 83, pp. 891.

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**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Four

## The Spirit Was Not Yet

Scripture Reading: John 4:10, 14; John 7:37-39

**I. The Spirit in the Old Testament:**

A. The Spirit of God in God's creation of the universe — Gen. 1:1-2; Deut. 32:11.

B. The Spirit of Jehovah in God's reaching of men and in His care for men — Judg. 3:10; 6:34; Gen. 6:3a; Exo. 3:14.

C. The Spirit of holiness in God's making His chosen people holy unto Himself — Psa. 51:11; Isa. 63:10-11.

**II. The Spirit in the Gospels:**

A. The Holy Spirit:

1. In the conception of John the Baptist to introduce God's becoming a man in His incarnation — Luke 1:13-17.
2. In the conception of Jesus in God's incarnation to be a man in the flesh — Luke 1:30-36; Matt. 1:18-20.

B. The Spirit with whom Jesus was anointed for God's move in His earthly ministry — Mark 1:10, 12; Matt. 4:1; Luke 4:1, 18; John 1:32-33.

**III. The Spirit that gives life being not yet before the glorification (resurrection) of Christ:**

A. The Spirit flowing out of the believers' innermost being as rivers of living water — John 4:10, 14; John 7:37-39.

B. The Spirit as the consummation of the processed Triune God reaching the believers:

1. The divine incorporation of the coinhering Triune God coinhering with the believers (four "ins") — John 14:16-20.
2. The Spirit as another Comforter, the transfiguration of the first Comforter — John 14:16.
3. The Spirit of reality being the resurrected Christ, the pneumatic Christ, in us — John 14:17-18, 20; 1 Cor. 15:45b; 2 Cor. 3:17.
4. The Spirit as the Son with the Father in the believers — John 14:26; 15:26.

C. The Spirit being the presence of the Triune God within the believers — Matt. 1:23; 18:20; 28:20; 2 Tim. 4:22.

D. The Son's going for the world-convicting Spirit's coming — John 16:7-11.

E. The Spirit being the organic transmission of the Divine Trinity — John 16:13-15.

F. The Spirit being the pneumatic Christ — John 20:22; Gen. 2:7; Lam. 3:55-57; *Hymns*, #255; 2 Tim. 3:16.

Source: FTTA Outline

Reading assignment:

- *God's New Testament Economy,* pp. 25-26, 32, chapter 6.
- *Divine and Mystical Realm,* pp. 11-12, 37-38.

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**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Five

## The Life-Giving Spirit

**I. The last Adam (Christ in the flesh) becoming a life-giving Spirit being the fulfillment of John 7:39:**

A. Receiving Christ as the life-giving Spirit, the living water, by drinking Him — John 7:37; 4:14a.

B. The living water, the life-giving Spirit, becoming in us a fountain of water springing up into eternal life — John 4:14b.

1. The fountain being the Father as the source of life — John 5:26.
2. The Father in the Son emerging as the spring for the manifestation and expression of life — John 1:4; 1 John 1:2.
3. The Son as the Spirit of life springing up to be a river — Psa. 36:8-9; 46:4; John 7:38.
4. The triune processed God flowing into (*into* meaning to be,or to become) the New Jerusalem, the city of water, the city of life, the totality of the eternal life — Rev. 22:1-2.

C. The life-giving Spirit, as the consummation of the processed and consummated Triune God, flowing out of our innermost being, our spirit, as rivers of living water.

D. Being measured by the Lord for the increase of the flow of life—Ezek. 47:1, 2, 12; Isa. 6:1-8.

**II. The last Adam, Christ in the flesh, becoming a life-giving Spirit in resurrection to carry out God's organic salvation to accomplish His heart's desire to build up the Body of Christ which consummates the New Jerusalem:**

A. Christ being the vivifying Spirit to carry out His desire to give life — John 10:10b; Rom. 8:2, 10, 6, 11.

B. The Lord being the Spirit who gives life — 2 Cor. 3:6, 17.

C. Without His being the life-giving Spirit, we cannot be saved organically — Rom. 5:10

1. Giving life to and indwelling our spirit in regeneration — Ezek. 36:26; 2 Tim. 4:22.
2. Cherishing us in His humanity with love and nourishing us in His divinity with the life-supply as our spiritual food in His organic shepherding — John 14:26; Rom. 8:26-27; 1 Pet. 2:25.
3. Making us holy with His divine nature through Himself as the sanctifying Spirit-Word so that we can be the holy city — Eph. 5:25-27; Rev. 21:2.
4. Renewing us as the renewing Spirit — Titus 3:5; Eph. 4:23.
5. Transforming us as the transforming Spirit for God's building through conformation and glorification — 2 Cor. 3:18; Rom. 8:28-29; Phil. 3:21; John 17:22.

**III. The life-giving Spirit being signified by the water that flowed out of the pierced side of Jesus on the cross — John 19:34; 12:24.**

**IV. Christ Jesus, the Lord, being the Spirit who gives life, the Lord Spirit, to be the essence of the new covenant ministry and the rich supply of the new covenant ministers — 2 Cor. 3:6, 16-18; 4:5; 3:3; Acts 5:20:**

A. The anointing Spirit — 2 Cor. 1:21.

B. The sealing Spirit — 2 Cor. 1:22.

C. The pledging Spirit — 2 Cor. 1:22; 5:5.

D. The inscribing Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:3.

E. The life-giving Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:6; Gen. 2:9, 17.

F. The ministering Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:8.

G. The liberating Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:17.

H. The transforming Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:18.

I. The transmitting Spirit — 2 Cor. 13:14.

**V. Praying ourselves into God to receive the life-giving Spirit as our supply, our spiritual food, to feed ourselves and all those under our care — Luke 11:1-13:**

A. Christ as the life-giving Spirit being our food embodied and realized in the word of life — John 6:57, 63, 68.

B. Being a life-giving "asker," a channel of the life-giving Spirit — 1 John 5:16.

C. "Give them food" (our career to build up the Body of Christ consummating the New Jerusalem) — Matt. 24:45-51:

1. The apostolic ministry in cooperation and incorporated with Christ's heavenly ministry — John 21:15-17.
2. Being "sons of fresh oil" as a channel of supply to the churches — Zech. 4:6, 12-14; Judg. 9:9; Phil. 1:23-25; Rev. 3:18; Matt. 25:9.

**VI. Today's aberrance in relation to the truth and experience of Christ as the life-giving Spirit:**

A. The distorted view of the Spirit in Pentecostalism with its overstressing of outward gift and power, and its missing of the inner experience of life to constitute the new covenant ministers — Num. 22:28-30; 1 Cor. 3:1; 2:14-15; 15:45; 6:17.

B. The missing, negligence of, and opposition to the truth of Christ as the life-giving Spirit in Protestantism — John 5:39-40; 1 Tim. 1:3-4.

C. In meekness correcting those who oppose — 2 Tim. 2:15, 24-26; 2 Pet. 3:16:

1. Answering the twistings of 1 Corinthians 15:45b.
2. Answering the twistings of 2 Corinthians. 3:17.

**VII. The believers considering highly the entry into the divine and mystical realm, realizing that without Christ becoming the life-giving Spirit, there is absolutely no way for the believers to participate in, experience, and enjoy the organic section of God's complete salvation of Christ for the fulfillment of God's eternal economy — 2 Tim. 4:22; Rom. 8:16; John 4:24; 1 Cor. 6:17.**

Source: FTTA Outline
Reading assignment:

- *The Central Line of the Divine Revelation*, pp. 22-24, 26, 28, 203-206, 293-295
- *Life-study of 2 Corinthians*, pp. 23-25; chapter 8; pp. 170-172
- *Life-study of Luke*, pp. 230-234
- *Crystallization of the Gospel of John*, chapter 14
- *The Crucial Revelation of Life in the Scriptures*, pp. 51-57
- *The Secret of God's Organic Salvation "The Spirit Himself with Our Spirit*, pp.10-11
- *The Vital Groups*, chapter 10-1

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Six

## The Material of the Compound Spirit

**I. According to the example in Exodus 30:22-33, one hin of olive oil was compounded with four kinds of spices to produce the holy anointing oil:**

A. One hin of olive oil typifies God. Number one typified God. Olive oil is produced by the pressing of olives. The olive oil signifies the Spirit of God, through the pressure of Christ's death, flowing out. The olive oil is the base of the ointment; it is the basic element com pounded with the spices.

B. Number four typifies man as the created creature of God. Especially, the number four here typifies the incarnation of Christ as a man.

1. Flowing myrrh, smelling sweet but tasting bitter, signifies the precious death of Christ. In the Bible myrrh is used mostly for burial. The aromatic liquid of myrrh not only reduces pain, but also can be used for healing the body when it gives off the wrong kind of secretion.
2. Fragrant Cinnamon typifies the effectiveness of the death of Christ. Cinnamon not only has a distinctive flavor, but it can also be used to stimulate the heart. Cinnamon may be pre scribed to stimulate a weak-heart.
3. Calamus is a reed that grows in a marsh or muddy place, shooting up into the air; so Calamus typifies the resurrection of Christ.
4. Cassia is kind of the outer part of the bark that is used as a repellent for snakes and insects. So Cassia typified power, especially the power of the repelling resurrection of Christ. Christ's resurrection can with stand any kind of environment, and His resurrection certainly is a repellent. It repels all evil "insects" and especially the old serpent, the Devil.

C. Before the crucifixion and the resurrection, the Spirit of God did not have these four elements:

1. Before the crucifixion and the resurrection of the Lord, the Spirit of God was not compounded.
2. Before the resurrection of Christ, the Spirit of God was there, but the Spirit of God was not the compounded Spirit.

D. After the resurrection of Christ these elements were compounded into the Spirit of God and the Spirit of God became the Spirit, the compound Spirit typified by the compound oil:

1. After the resurrection of the Lord, the Spirit was compounded with the humanity, the death, the resurrection of Christ, the effectiveness of the death of Christ, and the effectiveness of His resurrection.
2. All of these were compounded into the anointing which today is the Spirit.

**II. The Measurement of the Compound Spirit**

A. With the compound Spirit in Exodus 30, we also have the number three (typifying the Triune God), shown in the fact that the number of these spices are 3 unit of 500 shekels:

1. Myrrh—500 shekels.
2. Cinnamon—250 shekels.
3. Calamus—250 shekels.
4. Cassia—500 shekels.

B. The second unit from the 500 shekels was divided into 2 parts , each 250 shekels:

1. These two parts typify Christ, as the second of Divine Trinity, who "divided", wounded, on the cross.
2. Here we see not only the Trinity (typified by 3 units of each 500 shekels) but also Christ wounded on the cross (typified by the splitting of the second unit of the 500 shekels into 2 parts with each 250 shekels).

C. With the compound ointment we also see the number five which come in 2 ways:

1. Through adding of one Hin of Olive Oil and four kind of spices
2. And in 500 shekels.

D. In the Bible the number five typify responsibility:
   1. Ten commandments were written on the two tablets of stones with the five commandments on each tablet.
   2. Ten virgins in Matthew 25 was divided into two groups consists of five.
   3. Five consists of four and one with four typify man as God's creature and one typify God.
   4. From this matter we can see that number five typify God added into man to give us the ability to bear a responsibility.
   5. In the compound Spirit we have the ability to bear a responsibility.

Source: FTTA Outline
Reference:

- *The Conclusion of the New Testament*; Msg. 82, pp. 881-882.
- *The Life Study of Exodus*, msg 158
- *The Spirit*, pp. 23- 26.
- *How to Be a Co-worker and Elder*, pp. 26-27.
- *Incarnation, Inclusion, and Intensification*, pp. 8-10, 14-16.

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Seven

## The Function and the Prohibition of the Compound Spirit

Scripture Reading: Exo. 30:26-33; Phil. 1:19-21

**I. Its function for all generations:**

A. To anoint God's dwelling place and His priesthood with all the elements of the compound God, the processed and consummated Triune God — Exo. 30:26-31.

B. The anointing being the moving and working of the indwelling compound Spirit to transfuse, infuse, and add the divine and mystical elements of His all-inclusive person into our inner being so that our inner man may grow in the divine life with these elements — 1 John 2:20, 27:

1. The only God with divinity.
2. The Triune God—the Father, the Son, and the Spirit.
3. Man, the creature of God.
4. The precious death of Christ.
5. The sweetness and effectiveness of Christ's death.
6. The precious resurrection of Christ.
7. The power of Christ's resurrection.
8. The mingling of divinity with humanity.
9. The power for responsibility.
10. The building element.

C. Sanctifying the things of God and the men of God, separating them from anything common and making them most holy for God's service — Exo. 30:29-30; Rom. 1:1; 2 Cor. 2:14-15.

D. The anointing of the bountiful supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ, the operating God, for our practical, daily, moment-by-moment salvation, which is to be sustained and strengthened to live and magnify Christ under any circumstances — Phil. 1:19-21; 2:12-14:

1. For the Body, typified by the tabernacle — Phil. 1:7, 19; Acts 9:6; Psa. 133.
2. For God's service to build up the Body, typified by the priesthood — Rom. 15:16; 2 Cor. 3:8.
3. For our organic salvation — Rom. 5:10; 8:2.
4. Consummating the New Jerusalem — Rev. 22:1.

**II. Prohibitions concerning the use of the compound ointment:**

A. Not to be poured upon the flesh of man—signifying that whenever we live and walk according to the flesh, we are through with the compound Spirit — Exo. 30:32.

B. Not to be put upon a stranger—signifying that when we act and behave according to our flesh, we are in the old creation and are regarded as strangers in the sight of God — Exo. 30:33.

C. Not to make any like it in its proportions—signifying that we should not imitate anything of the compound Spirit, any spiritual virtue, by our own effort — Exo. 30:32.

Source: FTTA Outline
Reading Assignment: *Life-study of Exodus,* Messages 157-158

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**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Eight

## The Seven Spirit of God

**I. The seven Spirits of God being the sevenfold intensified Spirit of God (cf. the sevenfold sunlight — Isa. 30:26) to intensify Christ's organic salvation, to produce the overcomers, and to consummate the New Jerusalem — Rev. 1:4.**

**II. Christ as the sevenfold intensified life-giving Spirit calling for and producing the overcomers in the churches by bringing them back to the enjoyment of Himself for the finalization of God's eternal economy — Rev. 3:1; 4:5; 5:6; 1:12-14:**

A. In His sevenfold intensified heavenly ministry, Christ is walking in the midst of the churches to care for them as the High Priest in His humanity and in His divinity — Heb. 5:5-6; 2:17; 4:15; 7:24-25:

1. Cherishing the churches in His humanity as the Son of Man by His trimming work — Rev. 1:13a; Exo. 30:7; 25:38.
2. Nourishing the churches in His divinity with His divine love, signified by the golden girdle on His breasts, (Rev. 1:13b) with Himself as:
   a. The tree of life — Rev. 2:4-5, 7.
   b. The crown of life — vv. 9-10.
   c. The hidden manna — vv. 13, 17.
   d. The abounding grace to reign in life and the morning star — vv. 26-28; Rom. 5:17.
   e. The living One to be their lived-out subjective righteousness — Rev. 3:1, 5.
   f. The building and writing One — v. 7, 12-13.
   g. The reality of the Triune God, the feast, and the overcoming One — vv. 18, 20-21.
   h. All of the above being His nourishing of us with His unsearchable riches in His full ministry of three stages so that we may grow and mature in His divine life to become the overcomers in His sevenfold intensification.

B. Enabling the overcomers to be intensified as He is, so that they cherish others in His humanity and nourish others in His divinity for the building up of the Body of Christ consummating the New Jerusalem — Matt. 25:45-51; 1 Thes. 2:7; (cf. Isa. 66:13); 1 Cor. 3:2a.

**III. The composition of the overcomers:**

A. The man-child born of the universal woman — Rev. 12:1-5.
B. The one hundred forty-four thousand living overcomers —Rev. 14:1-5.
C. The martyrs in the great tribulation — Rev. 15:2-4; 13:7a.
D. The two witnesses martyred, resurrected, and raptured to the heavens in the cloud at the close of the great tribulation — Rev. 11:3-12.

**IV. The final consummation of the overcomers:**

A. To be manifested as a corporate overcomer after their raptures.
B. To be rewarded at the judgment seat of Christ — 2 Cor. 5:10.
C. To be the bride married to the Lamb — Rev. 19:7-9.
D. To be the army of the Lamb — Rev. 17:14; 19:14.
E. To bring in the kingdom of God and of Christ — Rev. 11:15; 20:4, 6.
F. To inherit the kingdom of God and of Christ in the fuller enjoyment of the eternal life — 2 Pet. 1:11; Rev. 20:4, 6.
G. To be the New Jerusalem as the bride of Christ for one thousand years, in its initial and fresh stage — 2 Pet. 3:8; Rev. 2:7; Matt. 13:43.
H. To consummate and complete the New Jerusalem in full as the wife of Christ in the new heaven and new earth for eternity — Rev. 21:1-3, 9-10.
I. To consummate finally the Triune God's eternal economy in Christ through the consummated Spirit — Rev. 22:17.

J. To participate in the fullest enjoyment of the processed and consummated Triune God:
   1. Enjoying God the Father as the light of life — Rev. 22:5; 21:23.
   2. Enjoying God the Son as the tree of life — Rev. 22:2.
   3. Enjoying God the Spirit as the river of life — Rev. 21:1.
   4. For all the believers to reign in life forever and ever — Rev. 22:4-5.

Source : FTTA Outline
Reading assignment:

- *The Overcomers,* ch. 6
- *How to Be a Co-worker and an Elder and How to Fulfill Their Obligations,* pp. 49-52
- *The Vital Groups,* msg. 11
- *The Divine and Mystical Realm,* p. 16
- *Recovery Version:* Rev. 1:4 (note 5); 4:5 (note 1); 5:6 (note 5); Heb. 5:5 (note 2); 2:17 (note 2)

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE SPIRIT**

Message Nine

## What The Spirit Is To God and To Christ

**I. To God:**

A. The Spirit being the Essence of God's being — John 4:24; Eze. 37:5, 9, 14; John 3:6, 8.

B. The Spirit being God's reaching Man, God's abiding among Man and in Man, and God's indwelling Man — Luke 1:35; Hag. 2:5; 1 John 3:24; 4:13; Rom. 8:11.

C. The Spirit being the means of God for Him to dispense His attributes to man — Rom. 5:5; 8:11; 15:13, 30; Acts. 9:31.

D. The Spirit being the consummation of the Triune God — Matt 28:19; Rev. 22:17a.

**II. To Christ:**

A. The Spirit being the essence of Christ's divine being — Rom. 1:3-4.

B. The Spirit being the realization of Christ — John 14:16-20.

C. The Spirit being the reality of Christ — 1 John. 5:6b; John 14:16-17; 15:26; Col. 3:4.

D. The Spirit being the witness of Christ — John 15:26; 16:13-15; 1 John 5:6-7.

E. The Spirit being Christ as the life-giving Spirit — 1 Cor. 15:45b.

F. The Spirit being Christ as the Lord-the Lord Spirit — 2 Cor. 3:17-18.

G. The Spirit being Christ as life to man — Rom. 8:2; John. 11:25; Col. 3:4.

Reference: *The Spirit*, chapter 11

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE BELIEVERS**

Message One

# The Believers

**I. Descendants of fallen Adam**

We were dead in sin under God's condemnation—God afforded us a change. We heard the gospel and we are saved — Eph. 2:1, 5; Rom. 3:19; 5:12; John. 3:18, 16.

**II. Baptized—Being one with the Triune God.**

A. Baptizing into the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit" that is, they were to baptize people into the very Person of the Triune God. To be baptized into Christ equals to be baptized into the Triune God — Matt. 28:19; Acts. 8:16; 19:5; Gal, 3:27; Rom. 6:3.

B. Baptized into His death — Rom. 6:3.

C. We were all baptized become the Body of Christ, Church — 1 Cor. 12:13.

**III. The aspects and stage of salvation:**

As a Christian, our salvation has two aspects: judicial redemption, and inwardly we have organic salvation, that carries on in three stages, the initial stage, the progressing stage, and the completing stage. Our full salvation completely consists of:

A. Forgiveness of sins.
The first thing we receive, the first bequest according to the divine testament, the divine will, is the forgiveness of our sins — Acts 10:43; Heb. 8:12.

B. Washed.
To be washed takes away the spot, the stain, of our sins — 1 John 1:9; Isa. 1:18.

C. Sanctified positionally.
As part of our initial salvation, we have been positionally sanctified, that is, separated by God from the world unto Himself — Acts 26:18; Heb. 10:10; 1 Cor. 6:11.

D. Justified — Rom. 3:24, 26; Acts. 13:39.

E. Reconciled to God — Rm. 5:10; 2 Cor. 5:19.

F. Regenerated
1. The very Spirit of Christ entered into our spirit and enlivened us. This means the Triune God is now in our spirit — John 3:6; Eph. 2:5; 4:6; 2 Cor. 13:5; Rom. 8:9; 2 Cor. 4:7.
2. Has made us children of God — John 1:12-13; Rom. 8:16.
3. Members of the household of God — Eph. 2:19.
4. Made us members of Christ, members of the Body of Christ — Eph. 5:30; 1 Cor. 12:27.
5. Regeneration took place in our spirit, not in our physical body or in our mind. To enjoy these reality we must call on the name of the Lord Jesus.
6. Although the initial stage already completed, yet we must experience the washing regeneration continuously day by day again and again — Tit. 3:5.

G. The sanctification of our disposition.
Our disposition little by little must be sanctified, in order to be conformed to God’s image that is holy — Rom. 15:16; 6:19, 22; Heb. 2:11; 2 Cor. 7:1; 1 Thess. 5:23.

H. Renewing the mind.
The mind is the leading part of our soul — Psa. 13:2; 139:14; Lam. 3:20. For the transformation of the soul, the mind must be renewed — Rm. 12:2; Tit. 3:5.

I. Being transformed in the soul. Thus we are being transformed metabolically to have His life shape by His life power with His life essence, it is not only outward work — 2 Cor. 3:18.

J. Conformed to Christ.
Not by imitating Christ, but because of the growing of Christ’s life in us (Rom. 8:29-30; Col. 1:28; Eph. 4:13).

K. To be transfigured in our body.
This is the final stage of our salvation, it happen when the Lord returns, our body will be transfigured — Phil. 3:21; Rom. 8:23.

L. Glorified

Finally, we shall be glorified in the divine life and divine nature to bear the glory of God for His expression in the New Jerusalem — Rom. 8:30; 1 Pet. 5:10; 2 Cor. 4:17.

**IV. Work out our own salvation — Phil. 2:12.**

A. Indwelt by the Spirit and drinking the Spirit — Rm. 8:9, 11; 1 Cor. 6:19; John 4:14; 1 Cor. 12:13.

B. Living and walking in the mingled Spirit — Gal. 5:16.

C. Therefore we must obey the inner anointing inside us — 1 John 2:20, 27.

D. Growing in the divine life and being built up. Spirituality comes out of the growth in life; the aim of the growth in life is the building up of the Body of Christ and of the house of God — 1 Cor. 3:6-7; 9-12.

E. We are the branches of Christ as the true vine, to expressing the Triune God by bear much fruit for the growth of Christ — John. 15:1-5, 8, 16.

F. As a God's New Testament Priest offerings the repentant sinners as sacrifices to God — Rom. 15:16; 1 Pet. 2:5, 9.

Reference:

- *Basic Revelation in the Scriptures*, chapter 4.
- *Ministry of the New Testament Priests of the Gospel*, chapter 1, outline 1.

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS—THE BELIEVERS**

Message Two

## The Complete Salvation of God Having Two Aspects— the Judicial Aspect and the Organic Aspect

Scripture Reading: Rom 1:17a; 3:21-26; 9:30-31; Luke 24:47; Heb 1:3; Rom 5:10a; Heb 13:12; Rom 1:17b; Acts 11:18; Rom 5:10b; 17b; 18b; 21b

**I. The judicial aspect of God's salvation:**

A. According to the righteousness of God — Rom 1:17a; 3:21-26; 9:30-31.

B. The procedure of God's salvation.

C. God's fulfilling of all the requirements of His righteous law for sinners according to His righteousness.

D. For sinners to be forgiven before God (Luke 24:47), washed (Heb 1:3), justified (Rom 3:24-25), reconciled to God (Rom 5:10a), and sanctified unto God positionally (1 Cor 1:2; Heb 13:12), thereby entering into the grace of God for the accomplishment of the purpose of God's salvation.

**II. The Organic aspect of God's salvation:**

A. Through the life of God — Rom. 1:17b; Acts 11:18; Rom. 5:10b; 17b; 18b; 21b.

B. The purpose of God's salvation.

C. To accomplish all the purpose that God wants to achieve in the believers in His economy through His divine life.

Reference: *Organic Aspect of God's Salvation*, chapter 1

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**TRUTH CLASS—THE BELIEVERS**

Message Three

## Regeneration and Shepherding

Scripture Reading: John 3:6b; 1 Pet 1:23; John 3:15; Titus 3:5; 2 Cor. 5:17; Gal. 6:15; 1 Pet 2:2; John 21:15-17; Eph. 4:12; 1 Pet. 5:1, 4; John 14:6; 10:9-11, 14-16; 1 Pet. 2:25; 5:4; Heb. 13:20; Rev. 7:16-17

**I. In the propagation and nourishment of the divine life.**

**II. Regeneration:**

A. Regeneration being the center of God's entire salvation and the commencement of God's salvation in its organic aspect:
   1. It being to regenerate and re-create the believers in their spirit through the Spirit of God — John 3:6b.
   2. Through God's word of life — 1 Pet. 1:23.
   3. For the believers to have the spiritual life of God in addition to their natural life — John 3:15.
   4. The spiritual life of God being divine and eternal — John 3:36.
   5. This divine life being the basis and means of the believers' spiritual life and living.

B. Such a regeneration being a wash in God's salvation (Titus 3:5), and this washing being a great renewing of the believers by God's salvation to enable them to get rid of all that is of their natural life and the old creation and become God's new creation — 2 Cor 5:17; Gal 6:15.

**III. Shepherding:**

A. The second step of the Triune God's organic salvation.
B. Shepherding including feeding — 1 Pet. 2:2; John 21:15-17; Eph. 4:11; 1 Pet. 5:1-4.
C. The Lord being the life and the good Shepherd — John 14:6; 10:9-11, 14-16.
D. The Lord being the Chief Shepherd and the great Shepherd — 1 Pet. 2:25; 5:4; Heb. 13:20; Rev. 7:16-17.

Reference: *Organic Aspect of God's Salvation*, chapter 2

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Message Four

## Dispositional Sanctification and Renewing

Scripture Reading : Rom. 15:16; 8:2; 6:19, 22; Eph. 1:4; Rev. 21:2,10; 22:19; Rom. 12:2a

**I. In the dispositional sanctification in the divine nature and in the Spirit's renewing of the believers' mind.**

**II. Dispositional sanctification:**

A. Dispositional sanctification being for the believers to be sanctified in their disposition that they may partake of the holy nature of God and be one with Him in this attribute of His — Rom. 15:16.
   1. Through the sanctifying work in the believers by the Spirit of life — Rom. 8:2.
   2. With the element of the life of God as the material.

B. This aspect of sanctification implying transformation — Rom. 6:19, 22.

C. This being the fulfillment of God's purpose in choosing the believers — Eph. 1:4.

D. Both the positional sanctification in the judicial aspect and the dispositional sanctification in the organic aspect of God's salvation being ultimately manifested in the New Jerusalem for it to become the holy city — Rev. 21:2, 10; 22:19.

**III. Renewing:**

A. The believers are spontaneously renewed in their spiritual life when they are sanctified dispositionally by the Holy Spirit.

B. Requiring the believers not to be fashioned according to this age, but to be transformed by the renewing of their mind — Rom. 12:2a.

C. To be renewed in the mind is to get rid of all the old concepts concerning the things of the human life and be made new again by the teaching of the Holy Scriptures and the enlightening of the Holy Spirit.

D. Such a renewing of the mind issuing in the transformation of the believers in their spiritual life.

Reference: *Organic Aspect of God's Salvation*, chapter 3

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Message Five

## Transformation and Building Up

Scripture Reading : 2 Cor. 3:16, 18; 4:16; Matt. 16:13-18; John 1:51; 2:16-22; 14:23, 2; Rom. 12:3-5; 1 Cor. 1:10-13; 3:9-15; Gal. 6:14-15; Eph. 3:17; 4:4-6, 11-16; Rev. 3:12-13; 4:3a; 21:2, 10-23; 22:1-5

**I. In the metabolism in the divine life and in the joining and knitting in the building up.**

**II. Transformation:**

A. Transformation being not an outward change or correction, but the metabolic function of the life of God in the believers.

B. By the believers turning to the Lord and thereby removing the various kinds of veils of their old concepts — 2 Cor. 3:16.

C. Even more, by the believers, with an unveiled face, beholding the Lord and reflecting face, beholding the Lord and reflecting like a mirror the glory of the Lord — 2 Cor. 3:18.

D. Thus they are being transformed into the same images as the Lord from one level of glory to another level of glory for the Lord's expression.

E. Even as from the Lord Spirit, that is, Christ as the life giving Spirit.

F. His requiring the believers' outer man to be decaying (to be consumed) that their inner man may be renewed day by day — 2 Cor. 4:16.

**III. Building Up:**

A. Building up is the God-men's being joined and knit together with other God-men in the divine life by their growth in the divine life.

B. Brought forth through the joining and knitting by the transforming Spirit — Eph. 4:15-16.

C. The building up of the Body of Christ in the New Testament in this kind of building up by being joined and knit together in the divine life, and its purpose is to consummate the building of the holy city, the New Jerusalem.

Reference: *Organic Aspect of God's Salvation*, chapter 4

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Message Six

## Conformation and Glorification

Scripture Reading: Rom. 8:29; Phil. 3:10; 1:19-21a; 1 John 3:2; Rom. 8:30; Heb. 2:10; 1 Pet. 5:10; 1 Thess. 2:12; Rom. 8:23; Eph. 4:30

**I. In the consummation of the divine economy.**

**II. Conformation — Rom. 8:29:**

A. Conformation being the consummation of the believers' transformation in life.

B. Conformation being to be conformed to the image of God's firstborn Son:

1. God's firstborn Son being Christ as the God-man.
2. To be conformed to the image of God's firstborn Son being that the believes become full-grown in life as God-man:
   a. To be conformed to Christ's death in all things through the power of His resurrection — Phil. 3:10.
   b. To live Christ for magnifying Him through the bountiful supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ (who is the God-man) — Phil. 1:19-21a.
   c. To be the reprints of the God-man, Christ, that the believers may be exactly like Him, the firstborn Son of God — 1 John 3:2.

**III. Glorification — Rom 8:30:**

A. Glorification being the spreading forth of Christ's glory from the believers by their growing to maturity in Christ's life.

B. Being also the believers' entering into the glory of God — Heb. 2:10; 1 Pet. 5:10; 1 Thess. 2:12.

C. Being also the believers' enjoyment of the redemption of their body — Rom. 8:23; Eph. 4:30.Being also the ultimate consummation of God's complete salvation in the believers.

D. The ultimate consummation of God's complete salvation being the New Jerusalem – the crystallization of the union a mingling of God with man, the processed and consummated Triune God with His regenerated, transformed, conformed, and glorified tripartite elect.

**IV. The interrelation of God's judicial redemption and God's organic salvation:**

A. God's judicial redemption qualifies and positions the believers to enjoy God's organic salvation and enter into God's higher grace for the accomplishment of God's eternal economy and the attainment of God's ultimate purpose.

B. Judicially, the church of God, which He redeemed and obtained through His own blood (Acts 20:28), was produced through God's judicial redemption. On the other hand, organically, the church of God is constituted with the God-regenerated people in the divine life. This organic aspect issues in the Body of Christ (Eph. 1:22-23).

C. God's organic salvation needs to be maintained constantly through God's judicial redemption:

1. When the fellowship between the believers and God are hindered because of their sins, this fellowship can be recovered through the blood of Christ's redemption — 1 John 1:6-7.
2. When the believers have a case against them before God because of their sinning, Christ, their redeemer, is responsible for undertaking their case in His status as their Advocate in heaven before God — 1 John 2:1-2.

D. The believers' ultimate transfiguration in their body to enter into God's glory is the redemption of their body (Eph. 4:30; Rom. 8:23), implying the element of redemption, because regardless of how spiritual, renewed, and transformed the believers are, their body still belongs to the old creation and therefore still needs God's judicial redemption that it may

receive God's organic salvation and be transfigured to enter into glory — Phil. 3:21; Rom. 8:30.

E. God's judicial redemption as the procedure is purposeless without God's organic salvation. It would be merely for sinners to be redeemed, have their sins forgiven, and become righteous people justified by God, but the purpose is unclear to the majority of believers who mistakenly consider their going to heaven as the purpose of their being redeemed and are unaware that, according to the revelation of the holy scriptures, God's judicial redemption as the procedure is with God's organic salvation as the purpose, which is to regenerate us, shepherd us, sanctify us dispositionally, renew us, transform us, and build us up into the Body of Christ, which ultimately consummates the New Jerusalem as the ultimate purpose of God's organic salvation to be God's enlargement and expression in eternity.

Reference: *Organic Aspect of God's Salvation*, chapter 5

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**TRUTH CLASS — THE BELIEVERS**

Message Seven

# Being Unable to Do Anything Apart from the Lord

Scripture Reading : John 15:5; Phil. 3:10; 1 Cor. 1:30

John 15:5 : *I am the vine; you are the branches. He who abides in Me and I in him, he bears much fruit; for* ***apart from Me you can do nothing***

## I. Being unable to do anything apart from the Lord.

A. The Lord in John 15:5 said, "*...for apart from Me you can do nothing.*"

1. As far as we are concerned, we are still able to do many things apart from the Lord. It seems that we do not need to rely on the Lord.
2. In the Lord's eyes, everything that we do without fellowshipping with Him or relying on Him—everything that we do by ourselves—does not count.
3. This means that only the things which we do by abiding in the Lord count in God's eyes. Apart from the Lord, everything that we do does not count.

B. The Lord's word in John 15:5 does not necessarily mean that we are apart from the Lord because we are fallen and we have committed sins or trespasses; but in this verse, outwardly we may still pray, go to meetings, and preach the gospel as usual. Apparently, we may not have any problem with the Lord and may appear to be normal Christians, but in fact, we may be apart from the Lord and may have lost our fellowship with the Lord inwardly.

C. For example: A telephone "*abides*" in electricity.

1. Once the electricity is switched on, the telephone begins to "abide" in the electricity, and at the same time the electricity also "abides" in the telephone. The telephone and the electricity are in communication and in union with each other, which produces an effect that enables the telephone to transmit sound automatically. However, whenever the electricity is turned off, although the telephone apparently remains the same and all things seem still good, but anything that the telephone does will be useless.
2. We as believers may be right and proper in appearance, but if we do not "abide in the Lord" inwardly, so everything that we do is worthless because there is no fellowship and union with the Lord.

D. From God's perspective, all spiritual reality is Christ Himself. In all of our spiritual progress and living before God, only that which is Christ counts. Anything that is not Christ is not spiritual and has no spiritual value in God's eyes.

## II. Abiding in the Lord to bear much fruit.

A. For the branches of the vine to bear fruit means that the life within the vine is expressed and seen without. When the branches abide in the vine, they bear fruit, and the life of the vine is expressed through the branches. The fruits that the believers bear are the result of the overflow of the Lord's life—the Lord's life passing through us and flowing out of us.

B. In principle, our Christian living and work should issue from our union with Christ, that is the overflow of Christ's life, Christ's nature, and Christ Himself.

C. The best illustration is when an electric lamp is joined to the electricity, the two are united, so the lamp can produce light, the "fruit bearing" of the lamp, as the expression of the electricity flowing through the lamp. We abide in the Spirit of Christ, and Christ also abides in our spirit. This is fellowship and union, that must produce the divine fruit of the light in our living and work.

## III. The goal of the gospel being for Christ to enter into man.

A. The ultimate goal of the gospel, testimonies, exhortation to people to believe in the Lord, is not for people to "go to heaven." The issue, the goal, the center, and the reality of the gospel are all for Christ to enter into man, that is, for Christ's life to enter into every man that they may be produced as "grapes."

B. May we have a deep sense that gospel preaching gospel is to dispense Christ from within us into others so that they also may have Christ, His life, His nature, and His element in them. In this way they will become "grapes," the fruit we bear as branches of the vine.

**IV. Christ being the center and the reality of all our spiritual activities.**

A. The principle is in the visiting, the building up, and the shepherding of the believers. Christ must be the center and reality of all spiritual activities.

B. We all should preach the gospel in this way—to transmit the Christ from within us into our friends and everyone in our family. We all are branches of the vine.

**V. Ministering Christ to others that they may have more of Christ.**

A. If we have seen that spiritual reality is Christ Himself, when we go out to visit the saints, to shepherd the saints, or to teach the saints, we will hold on firmly to the principle that we are ministering Christ to them.

B. Many times we do not take Christ as our goal in our visiting, shepherding, and teaching. We visit people who are sick, who have economic difficulties, or have family problems, do we minister Christ to them, or do we minister other matters? For this matter, we need a clear vision that apart from the Lord we can do nothing.

**VI. Christ being all and in all.**

A. When Paul wrote the book of Philippians in his old age, he still confessed that he did not have an adequate knowledge of Christ. In Philippians 3:10, he clearly told us that he was still pursuing Christ.

B. Christians do not lack so many different things; what they lack is Christ Himself.

**VII. Always having fellowship with the Lord in everything we do.**

A. At every moment and in every matter we must pay attention to our connection and union with Christ.

B. When we do all spiritual activities, we also need to care about the fellowship and union with Christ, that's just counted before God.

**VIII. Restoring our fellowship with the Lord through dealings.**

A. Whenever we sense that we are disconnected from Christ, we have to deal with it immediately in order to restore the fellowship. We need to confess our sins and take the blood of Christ.

B. Sometimes we may have the experience that right before we are going to speak, our inner fellowship with the Lord is interrupted. At this time, we should go to the Lord immediately to deal with our deeds in order to restore our fellowship with Lord.

**IX. Christ being the unique goal.**

A. Christ is in all things we do. When we read the Bible, we have to contact Christ; when we serve, we have to contact Christ; when we talk, we have to contact Christ. We must always contact Christ inwardly.

B. We have to practice in our daily living.

1. Firstly, to be connected with Christ.
2. Secondly, to do everything in union with Christ.
3. Thirdly, to take Christ as the goal all the time.

C. We may speak thousands of messages or do thousands of things, but in all of them our unique goal must be Christ. In this way our daily living, our work, and our service will be spiritual and will have spiritual reality.

Reference : *The Crucified Christ*, W.L., chapter 13

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**TRUTH CLASS — THE BELIEVERS**

Message Eight

**Different Kinds of Christians**

Scripture Reading : 2 Cor.4:16-18; Heb. 10:38; Gal. 2:20

**I. We will fellowship one thing with brothers and sisters, that is about different kinds of Christians.**

A. Among the people in the world, there are millions of Christians, and among these Christians some are in the Christianity, and some are in the Thyatira. According to the quality of Christians, there are different groups of Christians, with each group being in pairs.

B. The purpose of this fellowship is to show brothers and sisters what kind of Christians we are today. In other words, this will help us know where we are as Christians.

**II. Genuine Christians and false Christians**

A. False Christians

1. Do not think that false Christians are people who specifically come to the church on a pretense. Of course, that is completely fake.
2. There is one kind of Christians, although they are false, they may be "sincerely false Christians" who agree with Christianity and want to help out the church. Some of these even donate houses and possessions. Outwardly, they seem to be genuine, but inwardly, they false because they have never repented, never confessed their sins, never received Jesus as their Savior, never received the life of the Lord Jesus, and never been regenerated to be children of God.

B. Genuine Christians

1. A genuine Christian is one who has repented, confessed his sins, and received the Lord's life to become a real child of God.
2. When we meet such a Christian, regardless of whether he is Chinese or a foreigner, or how highly or poorly educated he is, there is a connection and an echo between us.
3. Immediately, we sense that he is our brother. Although he may belong to a denomination, the fellowship within us is still one. We can stretch forth our hand to him and declare, "We are one."

**III. Genuine Christians who pursue the worldly things and who pursue the Holy Spirit**

A. The genuine Christians who pursue the worldly things

1. They truly are children of God, but they seek material blessings in this age, they only receive God's grace outwardly.
2. They truly are saved and truly are children of God, but they hope for and seek peace and material blessings in this age. Their standard is low, and they lack the true quality of Christians.

B. The genuine Christians who pursue the Holy Spirit

1. A Christian should be one who pursues heavenly things. A Christian is a Hebrew—a river crosser—one who crosses from this age into eternity. We do not regard about today, but about the future, which is eternal.
2. A Christian with a high standard sets earthly things aside. If God provides a path of peace for him, he will follow it, but if God wants him to encounter hardship, he will gladly accept it as well. He seeks the Holy Spirit, not worldly things.

3. Christians in whom earthly things do not have much ground. Instead, they pursue growth in life, they love the Lord, they desire the Lord, and they follow the Lord. This kind of Christian is high in standard.

**IV. High-standard Christians who live by feelings and who live by faith**

A. High-standard Christians who live by feelings

1. Such Christians pursues spiritual things, eternal things, and the Lord Himself according to feelings and excitement.
2. They read the Bible fervently, contact brothers and sisters, and are very excited in the meetings. However, after a period of time, their excitement cools down, their prayers become flat, their Bible reading becomes as tasteless as gnawing wood, and their fellowship with the brothers and sisters no longer energizes them.

B. High-standard Christians who live by faith

1. Romans 1:17 says, "*The righteous shall have life and live by faith.*" We should not follow the Lord by feeling or by sight but by faith.
2. When I was newly saved, the more I read the Bible, the tastier it became. I loved reading the Bible so much that I would read it while washing my face or eating a meal. I would hold chopsticks in one hand and the Bible in my other hand. I also liked praying very much, and the more I prayed, the happier I was. All these feelings were like sugar. Gradually, however, the Lord led me to rely no on feelings but on faith.
3. After going through ups and downs in spirituality and pursuits, we will no longer pray according to feeling, preach the gospel according to feeling, or join the meetings according to feeling. We will no longer have ups and downs like ocean waves, but we will proceed forward smoothly. This is real spiritual progress.

**V. High-standard Christians who live by positive faith and who live by the highest faith**

A. The faith of this kind of Christians concerns positive things. This faith always believes that the Lord is doing positive things for them.

1. Although they may not feel that the Lord is working, they believe that the Lord is working. They believe in the Lord's presence, and they believe in the Lord's blessing. This is very good.
2. They believe in the Lord's presence, blessing, and power, even though they do not feel His presence, blessings, and power.
3. In everything they follow the Lord by faith, but their faith concerns only positive things.

B. This kind of positive faith is not high enough. Those who live a life of faith should have a higher faith. This highest faith is the faith of the Lord Jesus.

1. The Lord not only believed that God would hear His prayer and raise Lazarus from the dead, but His belief in God would not have been affected if Lazarus had not been raised from the dead.
2. When the Lord was being crucified, some said, "*He trusts in God; let Him rescue Him now if He wants Him*" (Matt. 27:43). The Lord believes that God could deliver Him, but He also believed that God did not have to deliver Him.
3. When the Lord was ministering on the earth, He still had faith when Bethsaida and Chorazin rejected Him (Matt. 11:20-21). He said, "*I extol You, Father… For thus it has been well-pleasing in Your sight*" (ay. 25-26). He believed in the God who blesses, but He also believed in the God who does not always bless. He believed in the God who works, but He also believed in the God who does not work.
4. This is the faith that brought Him to the cross. This is truly the highest faith. This faith brought the Lord Jesus into death and terminated all the old creation, bringing in the reality of resurrection.
5. If we want to enter into resurrection life, we must have the faith of the Son of God. In Galatians 2:20 Paul says, "*The life which I now live in the flesh I live in faith, the faith of the Son of God*." The more accurate translation for this verse is : "The life which I now

live in the flesh I live in faith, the faith of the Son of God." The faith of the Son of God should be our faith by which we live on the earth.

Reference : *The Collected Works of Witness Lee*, 1955, Volume 1, "Miscellaneous Messages from Twelve Baskets Full," chapter 2 "Different Kinds of Christians"

**TRUTH CLASS — THE BELIEVERS**

Message Nine

**Live by Faith**

Scripture Reading : Heb. 10:38; Hab. 2:4; Rom. 1:17; Gal. 3:11

Heb. 10:38 *But My righteous one shall live by faith; and if he shrinks back, My soul does not delight in him.*
Hab. 2:4 *See, he who is puffed up, his soul is not upright within him, But the righteous one will live by his faith.*
Rom. 1:17 *For the righteousness of God is revealed in it out of faith to faith, as it is written, 'But the righteous shall have life and live by faith.'*
Gal. 3:11 *And that by law no one is justified before God is evident because, 'The righteous one shall have life and live by faith.'*

**I. Living by faith in Hebrews 10:38, Habakkuk 2:4; Romans 1:17; Galatians 3:11.**

A. Hebrews 10:38 says, "*But My righteous one shall live by faith.*" These words quote the words in Habakkuk 2:4.
B. Romans 1:17 refers to "sinners by faith have life." The focus is on "have life."
C. Galatians 3:11 refers to "people shall have life by faith." The focus is on "faith."
D. In this message, we will discuss a little about how God delivers us from the feeling life and lead us to enter the realm of "living by faith," so that we know what the real of the spiritual experience is.

**II. Many believers often mention various spiritual problems, that is a fluctuating life :**

A. A fluctuating "wave-like" life :
   1. At times they feel spiritually dry and tasteless, while at other times they are happy and excited; sometimes they are as if on the mountaintop and sometimes in the valley.
   2. They wish that their whole life would be full of constant flowing joy and bubbling freedom. If they could do this, they would be able to praise and sing hallelujahs all their life.
   3. According to the fact, it is not altogether right to say that a Christian must have fluctuating and wavy experiences, nor is it altogether right to say that a Christian's experience must always be level and flat.

B. The happy feeling changes easily.
   1. A Christian begins his life from the time he is saved. When you receive Lord Jesus, you know that you have eternal life and that you pass from death to life and never come under condemnation anymore. That is the happiest day of your life.
   2. After a while, they do not know why, the joy is gone, they begin to feel sad. At that time, Satan will come and tell them that they are backslidden and no longer saved. On the other side, they will think that they have committed some sins and have become fallen. Yet in spite of their searching, they cannot find out what sins they have committed. Now, they feel that everything has dried up, and they are far from the lively and happy condition when they were saved.
   3. So the believers begin to conclude that their spiritual life is one of ups and downs. If someone asks them about their spiritual life, they would say that their life is fluctuating.
      a. During the highs, they read the Bible, pray, and testify with interest and joy.
      b. During the lows, they read the Bible, pray, and testify without any interest and in dryness.

c. What they mention about the fluctuating life refers to the condition of the feelings that they feel.

C. Feeling is not the base of the spirituality

1. We have made a basic mistake. The believers have a big misconception concerning spiritual experiences; we think that the joyful times are the peak times of our spiritual life.
2. The dry times are not times of spiritual decline. Suppose I lost a watch. When I find the watch again, I will become very happy. After three to five days, my joy will not be as great as when I first found the watch. Perhaps after a few days, the joy will be completely gone. But this does not mean that I have lost my watch again. What has been lost is merely the joy of finding the watch.
3. When we found the Savior, we were saved and could not help but rejoice. Not only did we rejoice from ourselves, God gave us joy as well. If someone did not have joy when he was saved, it doubts that he has found the Savior yet. But later the joy was lost. We may think that the things that we gained are lost. Actually, only the joy is lost; the things we gained are not lost.
   a. Has the Lord Jesus changed? No.
   b. Has God changed? No.
   c. Has the eternal life that God has given us been taken back? No.
   d. They were ours when we were excited about them. They are still ours when we feel so dry. It does not matter how excited we are or how dry we are. What we gained has not been lost; it is still there.
   e. So, the feeling of the fluctuating life that is mentioned by the Christians, is the condition of feelings. It cannot be used to measure the high and low of their spiritual life. (This does not include the case of those Christians who have sinned, fallen, or backslidden. Those are exceptions. What we are talking about are the normal conditions of Christians.)

**III. It is God's hand that makes the intensity of joy decrease, and the intensity of dryness increase. God's purpose for doing all these things are :**

A. That we would not be for ourselves.

1. During a period of excitement and joy, we have a great interest in reading the Bible and praying. But are we reading the Bible because of our interest or because the Bible is the Word of God? Are we praying at the expense of forsaking our duty, or are we praying for God's sake?
2. If we read the Bible because of our interest, if we pray for ourselves, then our aim is not God's glory.
3. God takes our joy away and puts us in a condition of dryness. How do we feel then? Our prayer, reading of the Word, and witnessing become forced and very hard. Under these conditions, God is teaching us a lesson: He makes us realize that our mountaintop and the most spiritual experiences, are merely of the flesh.
4. God is testing us to see if we will keep praying, reading the Word, and testifying for Him during the times when the joy is gone and the dryness is present. God does not want the dryness to be too harsh for us, so He gives back the joy after a while. But He also does not want us to presume that we have reached the peak of our spirituality, so He takes the joy away again. God does not want us to be discouraged because of the dryness, so that we will not want to be Christians anymore. Therefore, He gives us a little joy again and recovers our heavenly taste to a certain degree.
5. Perhaps some people have to go through these experiences five or six times; perhaps others seven or eight times. Most of the time, the feelings alternate between joy and dryness. This cycle will continue until God arrives at His purpose, that is everything of us are for God and not for ourselves. This is the first reason God deals with us with joy and dryness.

B. Exercising the power of the will

1. When we are living a life full of joy on the mountaintop, we do not exert any effort in reading the Word, in praying, and in testifying. But when we are dry, we feel that all of these are burdensome. At such times it is an exercise of the will for us to read the Word, pray, or testify for doing our duty.
2. When we are excited, we may not have any spiritual experience but only the results from the power of our emotion. When we are dry, we have to exercise our will, and our work is the result of our real person. The reason God gives us the dryness is so that we will learn to exercise our will during these dry times. there is real spiritual progress only when we exercise our will to advance.
3. Suppose we are traveling by a sailboat from one place to another. The journey may take only a few hours. At the beginning of the journey, the wind blows in the right direction, and we hoist the sail. After a while the wind stops, but there are still a few hours to go. Should we take out our oars and row, or should we anchor and wait until a good wind comes before we set sail again? If we want to reach our destination sooner, we have to try our best to row. At such times we are exerting the true strength we have.
4. Brothers and sisters, God sometimes gives us favorable wind, so we do not have to exert any effort to advance. But in another times, God gives us contrary wind stirring us up to exercise the resurrection power given to us. The power of resurrection is more clearly demonstrated in an environment filled with death.

C. Overcoming the environment
1. The feeling of dryness is the most difficult to overcome. If you exercise your will, you can overcome the feeling of dryness. If you can overcome the feeling of dryness, you will overcome your environment.
2. The most easily affected by the environment is your emotions. If you can overcome your feeling, you can also overcome your environment.
3. Those who have not overcome their environment have not overcome their emotion. Those who would overcome their environment must first overcome their own emotions.

D. Living by faith
1. A life of feeling is unreliable. What changes is your feelings, not your motivation. Therefore, do not care about your feelings.
2. Today God has no intention other than having the just live by faith. The just do not live by emotions. Therefore, no matter how we feel in our emotions, they will not bring us anything. Some believers have to go through God's training ten or twenty times until they do not exercise the strength of their emotion. God's training causes the dryness to increase more and the duration to become longer, in order to bring these ones to the point where they will live by faith.
3. If we live by faith, we will not be affected by feelings. This does not mean we are insensitive; we do have feelings of joy and dryness. But these outward feelings will not affect us inwardly. After we can fully control the outward feelings, we can enjoy the joy in the Lord inwardly. This is a deep and unshakable joy.
4. If you live by faith, you will be able to live a joyful life in the driest hour and live the driest life in a joyful way. These words seem to be contradictory, but it is a reality in the spiritual life. God is leading you to live such a life by faith.

E. The truth turns into the real experience
1. Living by faith is the principle of Christian life. God must lead us go out from the feelings, and enter into living by faith. God wants us to acquire His truths, but God does not want us to acquire it in the feeling, we must acquire it in the faith.
2. The order of receiving any truth from God is this :
   a. First, He conveys the truth to you through His servant, through some books, or He may give you the understanding directly through reading the Bible.

b. After you hear and receive it, you may think you have reached the peak and are above the world. But you have to remember that this truth is not yours. You only feel this way. In God's eyes you have not attained yet.
c. Then, God takes you from a mountaintop down to a plain into a dark tunnel, He puts you in difficult environments, so that you must undergo trials. God's goal is to remove your outward feelings and your outward crutches, so that His Word will take hold of you and so that you will be empowered through faith.
d. At that time, you will see that the truth you once held onto has become like a reed; it seems that it has flown away. You feel that your weapons have been confiscated and everything is lost. Thus, you slowly lose your grip on the truth. In the end, you give up altogether, and you do not remember the truth anymore.
e. But in your hour of forgetfulness, the Lord begins to work. Without realizing it, He begins to constitute you with the truth. In this time God will remind you of the truth you once heard, the truth which once gave you an exciting mountaintop experience. God will remind you little by little that this is God's Word, and you will think about it little by little. Now God causes you to believe in a calm way; there is no feeling, no excitement. You believe His Word "coldly."
f. Now you find that you can believe. You have come out of the tunnel and go to the second mountaintop. The truth you acquire this time is really yours. This time God causes you to experience the real victory, not like the previous idealistic victory.
g. After you have gone through the tunnel experience, you will realize what that truth really means. God leads you this way in order to show you that the just live by faith and not by feeling. When you are brought into the tunnel, you realize that the only thing that will bring you through is the Word of God. Only God's Word counts; feelings do not count.

3. In the tunnel, God disarms your self-confidence. He is delivering you from a life of feelings into the realm of living by faith. Actually, God is turning the truth that we have received in our feelings into real experience through the test of the tunnel. In other words, when we are in the tunnel we acquire the truth in a real way.
4. There is a particular danger with the preachers. When they reach the first peak, they think they have acquired something, and they blow their trumpet to tell others about it. Those who hear also think that they have acquired the truth. But when they are brought by God to the plain and into the tunnel, they will think that what they heard was wrong. So, when you are on the first peak, you need not be hasty in telling others anything, for everything will surely go into the tunnel. The length of time in the tunnel is not certain; it can be long or short. Only after you have come out of the tunnel will the truth be yours.

**IV. The truth in us must go through a test.**

A. Our experience of acquiring the truth is similar to the experience of the vase. When the flowers and letters are first painted, we think everything is fine. But we cannot stand any touching and are destroyed by any washing. The truth is not ours; we only understand it in our mind and are excited in our feeling.
B. Every truth must go through a test.
1. The numerous vases that went into the furnace, only about one-third would come out of the fire undamaged, others that could not stand the fire damaged.
2. God wants to put us through the burning of the furnace. Many people go into the furnace and never come out again. But if we go through the fire and come out again, what we have acquired will be firm.
3. The truth which we received before is unusable; but the truth we now have is usable. Before it was a reed, now it is a sharp sword. What we had before was only a nice outward appearance; what we now have within is something solid. Previously, we were in the realm of the mind and the emotion; now we have really acquired something.

C. When we hear a new truth, we go home rejoicing. But what follows are the trials. We must pass through the fire. Here lies the difference between faithful ones and unfaithful ones. It is not enough just to put some nice colors on a vase to make it look nice outwardly. It must go through the fire and come out of the fire before it can be useful. What we receive in our feeling does not count. We have to go through the fire before we will receive something real.

D. God is delivering us from what we think we have and understand according to our feeling, so that we can actually possess and understand these things. Whatever we think we understand, we understand only in our feelings. It is the first mountaintop feeling of joy. We must pass through the experience of the tunnel, and then the second mountaintop joy that is genuine. After this, what we have obtained is real.

E. Why does God always give us a mountaintop feeling of joy at the beginning of our spiritual experience? God has His intention for doing this. If we do not have a taste of the truth, we will not receive it. God allows us to have a taste of the joy of every new truth, so that we cannot forget it and we will not want to lose it even when we are in the tunnel. When we pass the test and come out of the tunnel, we will have a full taste of the joy of that truth. First, we have a foretaste. After the trial we come into the full and unrestricted enjoyment.

F. God's goal is to remove us from a life in the emotions. If our feelings are not removed, we will not trust in God. Faith is the principle because feelings are unreliable. There is only one principle: the just shall live by faith and not by feelings. It is the principle of every spiritual experience.

**V. Only live by faith and do not shrink back.**

A. We are people who live by faith, not live according to the outward feeling. Living by faith enables us to live a joyful life in the driest hour, and enables us to live the driest life in a joyful way. Even though we are in the valley and enter the tunnel, but we still look unto God, wait for God, until we go through the tunnel and reach the second mountaintop. This is living by faith.

B. "*But My righteous one shall live by faith; and if he shrinks back, My soul does not delight in him*" (Heb. 10:38). This is God's word. If you live by faith, you must have one attitude: pursue God's delight with your whole heart, and do not shrink back at all.

1. In reading the Bible, even though you often feel tasteless, you still do not shrink back.
2. In praying, even though some times there is no result, you still do not shrink back.
3. In testifying, even though you often feel there is no strength, you still do not shrink back.
4. Sometimes you feel in the tunnel, that is full of darkness and no light, but you still do not want to shrink back.
5. No matter how your outward feeling is, you still do not want to shrink back.

C. If we live in this way, we will not only have life, we also have God's delight. Brothers and sisters, the righteous one shall live by faith, not live by feeling

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message One

# The Church — Brief Overview

The chuch is God's ultimate goal, God's expression, God's household expressing God the Father and the Body of Christ expressing Christ as the One who is the embodiment of the Triune God (Col. 2:9).

## I. The definition of the church :

A. The church is an *ekklesia* (Matt. 16:18). This Greek word denotes a called-out congregation.

B. The church is the house of God (1 Pet. 2:5), it does not merely mean that the church is God's dwelling place, but also God's family or household. The chuch is organic; it is the living house of God (1 Tim. 3:15) and this house grows (Eph. 2:21).

C. The church is also the Body of Christ, a living organism of Christ the Head. In this Body, there "cannot be Greek and Jew, circumcision and uncircumcision, barbarian, Scythian, slave, freeman, but Christ is alla and in all" (Col. 3:10-11). If we still want to be black or white, we are through with the Body of Christ. The church is an organism. Therefore, we must act in our spirit, totally repudiating our natural life.

D. The church is also the fullness (expression) of the One who fills all in all (Eph. 1:23). The fullness comes out of the riches. Christ fills all in all, and we the church, by enjoying His riches, eventually become His fullness. If He had only a Head, without a Body, He would have no fullness. This fullness is the expression of Christ. We are filled, resulting in an expression of God.

E. The church is the fullness (expression) of God (Eph. 3:19). The entire book of Ephesians deals with the church. It is the house or household of God (2:19), it is the Body of Christ (1:23), and it is the fullness as the expression of Christ and of God (1:23; 3:19). According to chapter three, the church can be such an expression, not only of Christ but also of God, when Christ makes His home in our hearts that we may experience His unsearchable riches.

F. The church is the new man (Eph. 2:15). We need put on the new man (Eph. 4:22-24). This new man lives a life by grace and truth.

G. The church is also the bride of Christ (Eph. 5:25, 29, 32). Christ nourishes and cherishes the church. To nourish is to feed. To cherish is to embrace with loving care. The great mystery mentioned in 5:32 refers to Christ and the church. As the bride, the church satisfies Christ experiences something deeper and higher, that is, love and light. As the new man, the church fulfills God's purpose; as the bride, the church satisfies Christ's desire.

H. In chapter six, the church fights against God's enemy as the warrior (6:10-17).

## II. Two aspects of the church.

The church also has two aspects :

The universal aspect (Matt. 16:18) and the local aspect (Matt. 18:17). The universal aspect is comprising all the believers of all times and in all places; while the local aspect refers to the church in a certain locality. We can see this thing from the written of the epistles that was sent to a locality (the church in Ephesus, the church in Corinth). We must have a local church that we are part of, from which we can get help and to which we may go with our problems. These local churches are lampstands. The substance of the lampstand is gold, signifying God the Father and the divine nature. Then, the lampstand has a shape, signifying Christ as the embodiment of God. The lampstand also has seven lamps, that are seven eyes of the Lamb and the sevens Spirits of God. The

Spirit is the expression, the Son is the shape, the form, and the Father is the substance of the chuch as the wonderful lampstand. The content of the chuch is the *pneumatic* Christ.

**III. The foundation and the ground of the church.**

The church's foundation is Christ, revealed and ministered through the apostles and prophets (Eph. 2:20; 1 Cor. 3:11). This foundation should be laid on a proper ground, that is one local. We cannot lay it on a particular truth.

Reference : *The Basic Revelation in the Holy Scriptures*, Chapter 5

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Two

# The Hidden Mystery in God's Eternal Economy

**I. God's eternal economy (eternal plan, the purpose of the ages)—Eph. 1:11; 3:11; 1:9.**

A. Of God's will—Eph. 1:5, 9, 11.

B. According to God's good pleasure (God's heart pleasure) which God purposed in Himself—Eph. 1:9.

C. Made in Christ—Eph. 3:11; Col. 2:9; Matt. 16:16; John 20:31; Rom. 8:29; John 20:17; Heb. 2:11.

**II. The mystery of Christ—Col. 2:2; Eph. 3:4.**

A. From the ages hidden in God who created all things—Eph. 3:9; 1:10-11; Rev. 4:11.

B. Not made known to men in other generations—Eph. 3:5.

C. Revealed to the apostles and prophets in their spirit by revelation in the new testament age—Eph. 3:3, 5b, 1:17; Rom. 16:25-26.

D. To make the multifarious wisdom of God known to the rulers and the authorities in the heavenlies—Eph. 3:10; Psa. 104:24; 1 Cor. 1:30.

E. Through the church—Eph. 3:10.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, Message 189 ~ 190

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Three

# The Revelation of the Mystery of Christ ( 1 )

**I. By Christ :**

A. In the gospels.

B. To the first group of the apostles.

C. The first time in Matthew 16:15-20.

1. Concerning the universal church—v. 18.
2. Based upon the revelation of Christ, the Son of the living God—v. 16-17; 11:27.
3. Built upon the revelation of Christ as the rock—v. 18a; Eph. 5:32; 2:20; 1 Tim. 1:3.
4. Not prevailed against by the gates of Hades (Satan's power of darkness)—Matt. 16:18; Col. 1:13; Acts 26:18.
   a. Satan's authority of darkness is the authority of evil in heavenlies, in the air—Eph. 6:12.
   b. The authority of evil, of rebellion, in the heavenlies is the kingdom of Satan, the authority of darkness—Matt. 12:26.
   c. Satan is the ruler of this world and the ruler of the power of the air—John 12:31; Eph. 2:2.
   d. Satan has his authority and his angels, who are his subordinates as principalities, powers, and rulers of the darkness of this world—Matt. 25:41; Eph. 6:12.
5. With the kindom of heavens as its reality—Matt. 16:19; Rom. 14:17.
   a. The keys of the kingdom to be given to the apostles—Matt. 18:17-18.
   b. To bind and loose what has been bound and loosed in the heavens.

D. The second time in Matthew 18:15-20.

1. Concerning the local church—v. 17.
2. For the administration of the church in its locality.
   a. Illustrated by the dealing with its members—vv. 15-17.
   b. With the authority given to the church to bind and loose what has been bound and loosed in the heavens—v. 18.
3. Carried out by prayer in one accord—v. 19.
4. In the gathering of two or three with the Lord's presence—v. 20.

Reference : *The Conclusion of the New Testament,* Message 191 ~ 192

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Four

## The Revelation of the Mystery of Christ ( 2 )

**II. By the Holy Spirit—John 14:26; 16:13; 20:22; 1 Cor. 2:10.**

A. In the epistles—Eph. 3:3-4; Col. 1:25-27.

B. To the apostles and prophets—Eph. 3:3a, 5.

C. In their spirit—Eph. 3:5b.

D. Concerning God's wisdom in mystery—1 Cor. 2:6-7.

E. To be the foundation upon which the church is built—Eph. 2:20; 1 Cor. 3:11.

F. Bringing to light the hidden mystery of God's economy—Eph. 3:9.

G. To be known (apprehended) by all the saints—Eph. 1:17-23.

1. By a spirit of wisdom and revelation—v. 17b.
2. By the eyes of their heart being enlightened—v. 18.
   a. An open spirit with a purified conscience—Matt. 5:3; Heb. 9:14; 10:22.
   b. A pure heart—Matt. 5:8.
      (1) A sober mind—2 Tim. 1:7.
      (2) A loving emotion—John. 14:21.
      (3) A submissive will—John. 7:17.
3. By knowing the surpassing greatness of God's power toward them, which God wrought in Christ—Eph. 1:19.
   a. In raising Him from among the dead—v. 20a.
   b. In seating Him at His right hand in heavenlies, far above all—v. 20b-21.
   c. In subjecting all things under His feet—v. 22a.
   d. In giving Him to be Head over all things to the church—v. 22b.
      (1) The Body of Christ— v. 23a.
      (2) The fullness of the One who fills all in all—v. 23b.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, Messages 193 ~ 194

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Five

# The Formation of the Church

Scripture Reading : Matt. 16:18; 1 Cor. 15:45b; John. 20:22; Acts. 2:2; 1 Cor. 12:13

**I. Being universal**

Through the once-for-all baptism in the all-inclusive Spirit, the church, in the eyes of God, was once for all, universally formed to be the fullness of Christ for His universal expression.

**II. On the day of Pentecost and in the house of Cornelius—Acts 2:1; 10:24.**

**III. By Christ the Head—Matt. 16:18; Eph. 1:22-23.**

**IV. Through the outpouring of the Spirit—Acts 2:17-18, 33.**

A. The baptism in the Holy Spirit—Acts 1:5; 1 Cor. 12:13.

B. On the one hundred twenty believers—Acts 1:15; 2:1-4.

C. On the believers in Cornelius's house—Acts 10:24, 44-47a.

**V. With all the believers as the extrinsic form—1 Cor. 12:13.**

A. Represented by the one hundred twenty believers at Jerusalem on the Jewish side—Acts 1:15; 2:1-4.

B. Represented by the believers in Cornelius's house at Caesarea on the Gentile side—Acts 10:24, 44-48a.

**VI. With Christ as the intrinsic constituent—Col. 3:11.**

A. As the embodiment of the processed Triune God, with His unsearchable riches—Col. 2:9; Eph. 3:8.

1. To be the life of the church—Col. 3:4; 1 John 5:12.
2. To be the nature of the church—2 Pet. 1:4.

B. Consummated as the all-inclusive Spirit—Phil. 1:19.

1. To be the church's bountiful supply—Phil. 1:19.
2. In life and power—Rom. 8:2; Acts 1:8a.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, Message 195 ~ 196

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Six

# The Establishment of the Churches

**I. Being local—Acts 1:8.**

**II. Beginning from the day of Pentecost—Acts 2:1.**

**III. Starting from Jerusalem—Acts 2:5.**

A. The first local church—the church in Jerusalem—Acts 8:1; 11:22; 15:4.

B. Composed of:

1. The elders—Acts 11:30; 1 Tim. 3:1.

   An elder is an overseer. The two titles refer to the same person: elder, denoting a person of maturity; overseer, denoting the function of an elder.

2. The serving ones—Acts 6:3-6.
   a. Full of the Spirit and of wisdom—Acts 6:3.

      "Full of the Spirit" is one's condition after being filled with the Spirit inwardly and essentially. This refers to life, not to work. "Wisdom" also indicates that in this verse to be full of the Spirit is for life.

   b. The serving ones may be considered deacons.—Rom. 16:1; Phil. 1:1; 1 Tim. 3:8.
   c. Among the serving ones no leader is appointed. This indicates that no rank or position was regarded. All the serving ones are the servants to the saints.
3. The believers—Acts 2:44; 5:14.

   The believers are :

   a. Those who have believed in Christ as the Son of God according to God's New Testament economy.
   b. Those who have received Christ as their generating life for them to become the children of God. Believing in Christ equals receiving Him—John 1:12-13.
   c. The believers are those who have believed into Christ as the Son of God to have an organic union with Him—John 3:36.

**IV. Spreading to Judea, Samaria, and Galilee—Acts 9:31.**

**V. Reaching Antioch in Syria—Acts 11:26.**

A. The church in Antioch—Acts 13:1; 14:26-27.

B. Including prophets and teachers—Acts 13:1.
   1. Prophets are those who speak for God and speak forth God by God's revelation. They sometimes speak with inspired prediction—11:27-28.
   2. Teachers are those who teach the truths according to the apostles' teaching and the prophets's revelation—2:42.
   3. Both prophets and teachers are universal as well as local—Eph. 4:11.

**VI. Spreading in the provinces of Syria and Cilicia.**

A. Churches established—Acts 15:40-41.

B. Strengthened by the apostles Paul and Silas.

**VII. Turning to Asia Minor.**

A. Churches established in the cities of Lystra, Iconium, and Antioch in province of Galatia—the churches in Galatia—Acts 14:21; Gal. 1:2.

B. Elders appointed in every one of these churches—Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5.
   1. One city should only have one church with one eldership.
   2. The elders in all the churches were appointed respectively by the apostles.

**VIII. Spreading to the province of Asia in Asia Minor—Rev. 1:4, 11.**

A. Churches established in the cities of Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamos, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, and Laodicea—Rev. 1:4, 11.

B. Elders as overseers appointed in these churches by the Spirit—Acts 20:17, 28; 1 Tim. 3:2.

**IX. Reaching Europe—churches rised up in the province of Macedonia—2 Cor. 8:1.**

A. The church in Philippi, comprising the saints, with the overseers and deacons—Phil. 1:1.

B. The church in Thessalonica—1 Thes. 1:1.

> On the one hand, the church in Thessalonica was of the Thessalonians; on the other hand, this church was in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ. The church, therefore, is a group of human beings who have been born of God and who have been brought into the organic union with Christ.

**X. Spreading to the province of Achaia, next to Macedonia—churches raised up in :**

A. Corinth—the church in Corinth—1 Cor. 1:2.

B. Cenchrea—the church in Cenchrea, with a deaconess—Rom. 16:1.

**XI. Spreading to Italy.**

A. The church raised up in Rome—the church in Rome—Rom. 1:7.

B. Meeting in the house of Prisca and Aquila—Rom. 16:3-5a.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, Message 197 ~ 198

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Seven

# The Two Aspects of the Church

**I. The universal aspect.**

A. The universal church.

B. As revealed by the Lord in Matthew 16:18.

1. To be built by Christ, the Son of the living God revealed by the Father—Matt. 16:17; 11:27.
2. On the rock of the revelation concerning Christ, the Son of the living God—16:18.
3. The gates of Hades (Satan's power of darkness) not prevailing against it—16:18.
4. Related to the kindom of heavens—v. 19.

C. As revealed by the apostle in the epistles.

Paul's Epistles may be divided into two groups. The first group, including the Epistles from Romas through Colossians, concerns the Body of Christ and our Christian life. (Romans, 1 Corinthians, Ephesians, and Colossians speak of the Body of Christ. Second Corinthians, Galatians, and Philippians speak only of our experience of Christ in our daily life.) The second group, from 1 Thessalonians through Hebrews, may be regarded as a supplement to what is covered in the first group.

1. The house of the living God, the pillar and base of the truth, for His manifestation in the flesh—1 Tim. 3:15-16; Eph. 2:19, 22.
2. The Body of Christ, the fullness of the One who fills all in all, for His expression—Eph. 1:22-23.
   a. Constituted of all the believers baptized in one Spirit and given to drink one Spirit—1 Cor. 12:12-13.
   b. Constituted with the unsearchable riches of Christ—Eph. 3:8, 10.
3. The wife of Christ—Eph. 5:23-27.
   a. Coming out of Christ—Eph. 5:30; 1 Cor. 6:17.
   b. To be one with Christ—Eph. 5:31-32; 1 Cor. 6:17.
4. The new man—Col. 3:10-11; Eph. 2:15.
   a. Not of the natural man—Col. 3:11.
   b. With Christ as all the members and in all the members—Col. 3:11.

**II. The local aspect.**

A. The local churches—Rev. 1:10-13.

B. As revealed by the Lord in Matthew 18:17.

1. For the church's administration in its locality ◦
2. To bind and to loose with the authority of the heavens—Mat. 18:18..

C. As revealed by the apostles in Acts and the Epistles.

1. Established locally in separate cities—Acts 8:1; 13:1; 14:21, 23; Rom. 16:1; 1 Cor. 1:2; 2 Cor. 8:1; Gal. 1:2, 22; 1 Thes. 2:14; Rom. 16:4; Kis. 15:41; 1 Cor. 4:17; Acts 14:23; 1 Cor. 11:16; Rom. 16:16; 1 Cor. 14:33; 7:17; Rev. 1:4a, 11.
2. Taking a city as the boudary and ground of each local church—Rev. 1:11; Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5.
3. Each being not greater nor smaller than its city.

4. As lampstand to bear the testimony of Jesus Christ in separate cities—Rev. 1:20b, 9b; 4:5.
5. All the local churches being the one unique Body of Christ in the universe—Eph. 4:4; 1 Cor. 12:27; Eph. 2:22.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, Message 199 ~ 200

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Eight

# The Offices in The Church & The Relationship Between The Four Gifts and The Church

## I. The offices in the church.

A. In the universal church.

1. Only one office—the apostleship—Rom. 1:5.
2. Only the apostles having the position and right to appoint elders in the local churches—Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5.

B. In the local church.

1. Elders—Acts 11:30; 15:2, 4, 6, 22; 16:4; 21:18; 20:17.
   a. Being overseers in the local church.
      (1) "To oversee" means that taking the oversight, looking diligently to be aware of the situation and the need for the purpose of taking care of the church with all the saints—Acts 20:28; Phil. 1:1; 1 Tim. 3:1.
      (2) The elders should never rule anyone, because the Lord Jesus is the only Lord and Master and we all are brothers—Matt. 23:8, 10.
      (3) "To oversee" is not to replace or annul the functions of the saints, rather, to promote all the functions of each member of the Body.
      (4) "To oversee" does not mean to rule; it does not mean to be a king. Rather, the elders should oversee not by way of compulsion, but willingly, according to God, to take care of others, to look after them, to protect them—1 Pet. 5:2.
   b. Taking the lead in the local church—1 Tim. 5:17a.
   c. Teaching in the local church—1 Tim. 3:2; 5:17.
   d. Shepherding the local church—Acts 20:28; 1 Pet. 5:2.

      The church is called the church of Christ, the church of God, and the church of the saints. But the church is not the church of the apostles or the church of the elders—Luke 12:32; Rom. 16:16; 1 Cor. 1:2; 14:34.

   e. Not lording it over the church but being patterns of the flock—1 Pet. 5:3; Matt. 20:25-27; 23:10-22.

      The elders in the church can only take the leadership (not the lordship), which all the believers should honor and follow—1 Thes. 5:12-13; Heb. 13:7.

   f. Taking care of the finance in the local church—Acts 11:29-30; 1 Tim. 3:3.
2. Deacons and deaconesses—Phil. 1:1; 1 Tim. 3:8; Rom. 16:1; 12:7.
   a. Serving the local church—1 Tim. 3:13.
   b. Doing the business affairs in the local church—Acts. 6:1, 3*:*

## II. The relationship between the four special gifts and the church—Eph. 4:11.

A. The apostles.

1. In their ministry to produce the churches, the apostles are a gift to the universal church—all the churches—1 Cor. 9:1; 1 Thes. 1:1; 2:6; Acts 13:1.
2. In their ministry to appoint the elders, they have an office over all the local churches—Acts 14:23; 1 Tim. 5:19-20.

3. The first placed by God in the church—1 Cor. 12:28a.

B. The prophets.
   1. A gift mainly for the local church—Acts 13:1; 1 Cor. 14:23-24.
   2. Also for all the local churches—Acts. 11:27-28; 21:8-11; 15:22, 30, 32.
   3. Speaking for God and speaking forth God spiritually and predicting for God miraculously—Rom. 12:6; 1 Cor. 14:1; Acts 11:28; 21:10-11.
   4. The second placed by God in the church—1 Cor. 12:28.

C. The evangelists.
   1. For all the local churches—Acts 8:40.
   2. Doing the particular work of preaching the gospel—Acts 8:5, 12; Mark 1:14-15; Luke 4:43; Acts 8:26, 40.

D. The shepherd-teachers—Eph. 4:11.
   1. A gift for the local church—Acts 13:1; 11:26.
   2. Teaching in the local church meetings—1 Cor. 14:26; Acts 2:42.
   3. The third placed by God in the church—1 Cor. 12:28.

E. All the four special gifts not building the Body of Christ directly but perfecting the saints that they may build the Body of Christ directly—Eph. 4:11-16.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament*, Message 201 ~ 202

# TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH

Message Nine

## The Fellowship Among the Churches

Scripture Reading : Acts 2:42; 1 John 1:3

**I. The fellowship of the Body of Christ—1 Cor 10:16-17.**

A. The fellowship of the apostles—Acts 2:42; 1 John 1:3; Rev. 22:1; 2 Cor. 13:14; Phil. 2:1.

B. The fellowship with the Triune God—1 John 1:3b; 2 Cor. 13:14; Rev. 22:1; 1 John. 2:12-27; 2:28–5:3; 5:4-21.

C. Expressed and practiced in partaking of Christ's blood and body at the Lord's table—1 Cor. 10:16, 21**.**

**II. All the churches being the one universal Body of Christ—Eph. 4:4.**

A. Among them there being no organization but the fellowship of the Body of Christ.

B. All the churches being on the same level, none being the head church, nor any ruling over another, as indicated by the seven churches in Revelation chapters one through three.

C. All the churches being the same in :

1. Receiving the teachings—1 Cor. 4:17b; 7:17; 16:1; Acts 2:42; Rom. 16:17; 1 Tim. 1:3.
2. Practicing the church life—1 Cor. 11:16; 14:34; 11:5; Acts. 2:17-18; 21:9; 1 Tim. 2:12.
3. Acting together—2 Cor. 8:18-19.

D. All the churches being identical, like the seven golden lampstands as the symbol of the seven churches— Rev. 1:12b, 20b; 4:5.

E. Only in their degradation the seven churches bearing their different characteristics respectively—Rev.2:20.

**III. The contribution among the churches—Rom. 15:25-27, 31b.**

A. Caring for one another by grace of God given to them—2 Cor. 8:1-6; 9:1-2; 1 Cor. 15:45.

B. To have equality in material riches among the churches—2 Cor. 8:13-15; Ex. 16:18.

Reference: *The Conclusion of the New Testament,* Message 203 ~ 204

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Ten

**The Oneness of the Church & the Fellowship of the Church**

**I. The oneness of the church.**

A. The essence of the oneness.
   1. Being the Spirit Himself—Eph. 4:3.
   2. Being oneness, not unity.

B. The reality of the oneness—Eph. 4:3, 4-6.
   1. One Body, one Spirit, one Lord, and one God—Eph. 4:4-6.
   2. One hope, one faith, and one baptism—Eph. 4:4-6.

C. The indivisibility of the oneness—Acts 3:6-8.
   1. Dividing on the basis of spiritual giants—1 Cor. 1:12-15; 4:6; 3:22.
   2. Dividing on the basis of the person who is the instrumentality of our salvation—1 Cor. 3:4-8; 21-23.
   3. Dividing because "I am of Christ"—1 Cor. 1:12-13.
   4. Dividing because of differences in doctrinal views:
      a. Doctrinal views not to be considered as the basic faith.
      b. To practice differently based on doctrine and to be divided from others being a fleshly act—Gal. 5:19-20.
      c. The Scriptures requiring us to receive those who eat only vegetables and those who observe days—Rom. 14:1-6.
      d. The Scriptures allowing us to have doctrinal differences but not permitting us to be sectarian, divisive, because of such differences—1 Cor. 1:10-13; Titus 3:10.
   5. Dividing because of racial differences—1 Cor. 12:13.
   6. Dividing because of differences in nationality—1 Cor. 12:13.
   7. Dividing because of differences in social rank—1 Cor. 12:13.
   8. Dividing because of spiritual weakness or mistakes—Rev. 2 dan 3.

**II. The fellowship of the church.**

A. According to the reality of oneness—Eph. 4:3-6; John 17:21-23.

B. Being a fellowhip of oneness, not a fellowship of being divided yet united nor a fellowship of being independent yet in mutual contact—Acts 2:42; Phil. 2:21.

C. Being the fellowship of the body, not the fellowship of a "locality"—1 Cor. 10:16-17.

D. Being of life—1 John 1:2-3.

E. Being the Holy Spirit—2 Cor. 13:13; Phil. 2:1.

F. Condition for being removed from the fellowship.
   1. Having the sin spoken of in 1 Corinthians 5—1 Kor. 5:9-13.
   2. Going beyond the teaching of Christ—2 John 7-11.
   3. Any other failure, weakness, mistake, or wrong doctrinal view not being sufficient to constitute a condition for being removed—1 Cor. 1:11-12; 3:1-4; 6:1-8; 15:12.

Reference : *The Testimony and the Ground of the Church*, Section 2, Chapter 1 ~ 2

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Eleven

## The Ground of the Church & the Matter of Sects

**I. The ground of the church.**

A. Based upon the fellowship in oneness.
   1. To lose the oneness, the fellowship, of the church being to lose the ground of the church.
   2. Any ground outside of the fellowship in oneness not being the ground of the church.

B. The fellowship of oneness being universal, but expressed in localities.
   1. In every locality there being only one fellowship, one ground—Acts 8:1; 13:1; 1 Cor. 1:2; Rev. 1:11; Acts. 21:17-21; 18:8-10; 2:46.
   2. The fellowship in each locality needing also to be universal.

**II. The matter of sects.**

A. God's desire—1 Pet. 2:5.

B. The division of the church—Acts 8:1; 1 Cor. 1:2.

C. The responsibility of division.

D. The need for discernment.

E. The constitution of a sect :
   1. Having a special name—Rom. 10:13; Acts 19:5; Matt. 28:19; 1 Cor. 1:13; Matt. 18:20; John 17:11b.
   2. Having special articles of belief—Eph. 4:5; 2 Pet. 1:1.
   3. Having a special fellowship—Rom 14:1; 3; 15:7.
   4. Having a fellowship that is isolated and not universal.
   5. Having a separate administration in the same locality—Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5.
   6. Having a background of belonging to an organization.

Reference: *The Testimony and the Ground of the Church*, Section 2, Chapter 3 ~ 4

# TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH

Message Twelve

## The Speciality of the Church Life

Scipture Reading : Eph. 4:13-16; Gal. 1:23; 2 Tim. 4:7; 1 Tim. 6:12; Jude 3, 24; Acts 6:7; 13:8; 14:22; Gal. 3:25; 6:10; 1 Tim. 1:19; 3:9; 4:1, 6; 5:8; 6:10, 21; 2 Tim. 3:8; Titus 1:13; Rev. 14:12.

*I. The faith—Rom. 5:1; Eph. 2:8; Heb. 11:1; Titus 1:4; Rev. 14:12; 2 Tim. 4:7; 1 Tim. 6:12.*

A. Concerning the Bible—2 Pet. 1:21; 2 Tim. 3:16.

B. Concerning God—Matt. 3:16-17; 28:19; 2 Cor. 13:14; Eph. 2:18; 3:14-15; Why. 1:4-5; Deut. 4:35; 39; Psa. 86:10; 1 Cor. 8:4; 1 Tim. 2:5.

C. Concerning Christ—John 1:1, 14; 20:28, Rom. 9:5; John 19:5; 1 Tim 2:5; Matt. 3:16; John 1:32-33; Luke 4:18-19; Matt. 16:16; John 20:31; Col. 1:15; Heb. 1:3; Phil. 2:6; John 5:18; Col. 2:9; John 6:46, 5:43; 1:1-2; 14:10a; 11a; 17:21; 16:32; 10:30; 10:25; 14:10b; 6:38; 5:30; 3:34a; 14:24; 7:18; 14:7-9; Heb. 1:10; John 1:3; Col. 1:16; 1 John 4:2; Heb. 2:14; Col. 1:15b; John 15:26; 16:7; 3:34b; 14:26; 1 Cor 15:45b; John 14:16-20; 16:14-15; 20:22; 2 Cor. 3:17; John 14:17, 23; Rom. 8:9-11; John 4:24; 1 Cor. 6:17; Rom 8:16; 2 Tim. 4:22; Rev. 1:4; 4:5; 5:6; Luke 2:11; John 4:42; Matt. 1:21; John 1:29; 1 Pet. 2:24; Heb. 9:26, 28; 1 Pet. 1:18-19; Acts 2:36; 10:36; Col. 1:18; Eph. 1:22; Rev. 19:16; Col. 3:4; Gal. 2:20; 1 Cor. 1:24, 30; Col. 3:11.

D. Concerning the work of Christ—John 1:14; 1 Pet. 2:24; Rev. 5:9; 1 Pet. 1:3; Acts 2:33, 36; 10:36; John 3:29; Rev. 19:7, 16.

E. Concerning our salvation—Acts 2:38, 26:20; John 3:16; Acts 16:31; 10:43; Rom. 3:24; Acts 13:39; John 3:6, 36; 1:12; 1 Cor. 12:27; Eph. 2:4-9.

F. Concerning the church—Eph. 1:22-23; Col. 1:24; Eph. 4:4; Rev. 1:11.

II. The speciality of the church life—John 17:21-23; Eph. 4:3; Rom. 15:5-6; 1 Cor. 1:10-13; 11:19; Gal. 5:20; Titus 3:10.

A. We all have been infected, influenced, damaged, distracted, and even divided by all kinds of doctrines. Therefore, we need to grow, as as we grow, we will arrive at the oneness of the faith—Eph. 4:13.

B. The church's degradation and the Lord's recovery.
1. From the last part of the first century, the church gradually began to lose the right things.
2. At the beginning of the sixteenth century, the Lord rised up Martin Luther (actually, throughout the previous fourteen centuries, there were some faithful saints raised up by the Lord to recover the lost truths).
3. The Moravian Brethren.
4. The British Brethren.
5. The Inner Life.
6. Evangelism.
7. The Pentecostal movement.
8. The proper church life.
9. The teachings and the pentecostal and charismatic things.

C. A personal testimony.

D. The attitude of the writers of the New Testament toward the gifts—Acts 14:9-10; 19:11-12; 1 Tim. 5:23; 1 Cor 14:6-11, 18-19.

### *E. The way of life.*

Reference: *The Speciality, Generality, and Practicality of the Church Life*, Chapter 1 ~ 2.

## TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH

Message Thirteen

### The Generality of the Church Life

Scripture Reading : Rom. 14:1-7, 12-21; 15:3-5; 1 Cor. 8:4-13; 10:25-29; 9:20-22; 7:7-8, 25-26; 1 Tim. 5:14; Matt. 18:17; Rom. 16:17; 2 Thes. 3:6,14; 1 Cor. 5:9-13; Titus 3:10; 2 John 9, 10, 11, 7.

**X. The generality practiced by Paul.**

A. We need balance.

B. As long as we have the solid foundation of the faith, the speciality, laid, we can be very, very general. The Apostle Paul was such a person.

C. Eating things sacrificed to idols.

D. The marriage problem in 1 Corinthians 7.

E. The matter of keeping days in Romans 14.

F. Practicing the generality in the church life.

G. Practicing the generality toward other local churches.

At the present time we feel that to exercise the spirit and to take care of the inner life by pray-reading and feeding on the Lord Jesus is the most profitable way for us to have the proper church life. But we also should be open, and we should be general.

F. The better things for building up a local church.

1. We have seen that a good number of people were raised up by the gifts and edified by the teachings, but there is something better—the exercise of the spirit, the growth in life, the pray-reading, and the feeding on the Lord.
2. We should never try to adjust or correct other churches.
3. Never be bothered by something different from your concept. If you get into a meeting that is noisy, just be noisy with them; if you come to a meeting that is quiet, be quiet with them.
4. We should be open, we should be be general, and we should be learning all the time. This attitude will keep the oneness of the Body of Christ.

**XI. The balance to the generality.**

A. To keep the oneness of the Body, the speciality needs the generality of the church life to balance it, the generality also needs something to balance it.

B. The church does not have to practice the generality to the degree that it has to take all kinds of persons. According to the versed above, there are certain persons with whom we cannot be general, nor with whom we should be general.

1. One who neglects to hear the church—Matt. 18:17.
2. Those who cause divisions—Rom. 16:17.
3. One who is sinful—1 Cor. 5:9-13.
4. One who is sectarian—Titus 3:10.
5. One who goes beyond the doctrine of Christ—2 John 9.

C. Caring for the standing of the church, not the condition.

Reference: *The Speciality, Generality, and Practicality of the Church Life*, Chapter 3 ~ 4

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — THE CHURCH**

Message Fourteen

# The Practicality of the Church Life

Scripture Reading : John 10:10b; 6:57, 63; 21:15; 1 Cor. 3:2, 6; 15:45b; 6:17; Eph. 4:13-15; 2:21; 1 Pet. 2:2-3, 5; 2 Cor. 3:17; 2 Tim. 4:22; 1:7; 2:22; 3:16a; 4:3; 1:13; Eph. 6:17-18; Rom. 10:12; 1 Cor. 12:3, 13b; 14:31, 32; John. 15:12; Matt. 20:25-27; 23:8-11; 1 Pet. 5:1-3, 5; Rom. 12:4-5; Rev. 1:5b-6a; 5:9b-10a; John 15:5, 8, 16; 21:15b, 16b, 17b; Acts 8:1; 11:19-22.

**I. Today the best thing, the primary thing, the first thing, that we have to take care of in the practicality of the church life is the matter of life—Rev. 3:1-2; John. 14:6; 10:10b.**

**II. The most significant thing with life is growth.**

A. Life and growth in life in First Corinthians:

1. The primary practice in the local church is the feeding, the planting, the watering, and the growing with the realization that today Christ is not only a giver of gifts, but a life-giving Spirit—1 Cor. 3:2, 6; 15:45b; 6:17.
2. The normal, proper thing is that we need all the teachings and also the gifts, but we need them for the growth in life.

B. Life and growth in life for our practice:

1. The teachings and gifts are at best the means for ministering the nourishing element to people, but they are not the nourishing element itself. The nourishing elements are Christ, the Spirit, and the living Word—Eph. 4:15.
2. If we practice this, we all will grow until we arrive at maturity, at a full-grown man, and no one among us will still be a babe—Eph. 4:13-14.
3. We will all grow into a temple, into a real building—Eph. 2:21.

C. Life and growth in life in 1 Peter:

1. As newborn babes we all have to desire the milk of the Word that we may grow—1 Pet. 2:2.
2. We will grow by the milk of the Word and then we will become living stones being built up a spiritual house—1 Pet. 2:5.

**III. For life and growth in life we need the eating of the Lord.**

A. Jesus is the bread of life (John. 6:35, 57). The way we eat something depends on the element, the essence, of the food.

1. What is Jesus—the substance of Jesus—2 Cor. 3:17.
2. Where Jesus is—the life-giving Spirit within our spirit—1 Cor. 6:17.
3. Our human spirit is a strong spirit—2 Tim. 1:7.
4. What shall we do—pursuing with those who call on the Lord—2 Tim. 2:22.
5. This Spirit as the breath—pray-reading the Word—2 Tim. 3:16.

B. Calling and pray-reading as the best practicality (Rom. 10:12; 1 Cor. 12:13; Rat. 3:55-56; Acts 9:14; Eph. 6:17-18). These are the healthy teachings the Lord has given us for the practice of the church life (2 Tim. 4:3; 1:13).

C. Prophesying in the meetings is also a part of the practicality of the church life—1 Cor. 14:31.

**IV. These points are not parts of our Christian faith. However, they are the practicality, even the best practicality, the most profitable practicality, of the church life.**

**V. Eight additional points that are very practical and strategic for the church life:**

A. Brotherly love—John 15:12, 17; Rev. 3:7.

B. Not exercising lordship—Matt. 20:25-28; 23:8-11; 1 Pet. 5:1-3, 5.

C. Exercising obedience—1 Pet. 5:5; Eph. 5:21.

D. Exercising to function—Rom. 12:4-5; 1 Cor. 14:24-26, 31-32.

E. The universal priesthood—Rev. 1:6; 5:10.

F. Endeavoring to bear fruit—John 15:16; Matt. 28:19; Mark 16:15; Luke 24:47; Acts 11:21.

G. Feeding the lambs—John 21:15-17; Eph. 1:4.

H. Spreading by migration—Acts 8:1; 11:19, 22; 13:2-3.

Reference: *The Speciality, Generality, and Practicality of the Church Life*, Chapter 5 ~ 7

# TRUTH CLASS — THE KINGDOM

Message One

## The Kingdom (1) & The Chart

Scripture Reading : Matt. 3:1-2; 4:17; 10:1; 7; Luke 10:1, 9, 11; 4:43; Matt. 24:14; Luke 17:20-21; John 3:3, 5; Mark 4:26-29; Acts 1:3; 8:12; 19:8; 20:25; 28:23, 30-31; Rom. 14:17; 1 Cor. 4:17, 20; 6:9-10; Gal. 5:21; Eph. 5:5; 2 Pet. 1:3, 11; Rev. 1:9

**I. The church and the kingdom—Matt. 16:18-19; Acts 2:38-42; 10:34-48.**

**II. A chart of the kingdom:**

A. The church—overcoming and defeated believers—1 Cor. 5:1-5.

B. Four categories of people—the worldly people, the nominal Christians, the real Christians, and the overcoming Christians.

C. Overcoming—going along with God's transforming work—Phil. 3:21.

D. Our daily life—Rom. 12:2.

E. Reality, appearance, and manifestation—Matt. 13:24-43.

**III. The government of God—Acts 26:18; Col. 1:13; Matt. 6:13b, 10.**

**IV. Man to rule for God—Gen. 1:26-28.**

**V. The kingdom and Israel—Exo. 19:6.**

**VI. The first thing preached in the New Testament—Matt. 3:1-2; 4:17; Luke. 9:1-2; 10:1, 9, 11; 9:60.**

**VII. Preached as the gospel—Luke 4:43; Acts 8:12, Matt. 24:14; Luke 18:29; Mark 10:29.**

**VIII. Inheriting eternal life—Mark 10:17, 23.**

**IX. An entrance into the kingdom—2 Pet. 1:3, 5-11.**

**X. Related to the inner life and the church life—John 3:3, 5; Matt. 16:18-19; Rom. 14:17.**

**XI. The seed sown in the gospels—Matt. 13:3; Mark 4:26-29; Luke 17:20-21; Matt. 16:28-17:2.**

**XII. The kingdom in the Acts—Acts 8:12; 19:8; 20:25; 28:23, 31.**

**XIII. The kingdom in the epistles—Col. 1:13; Heb. 12:28; Rom. 14:17; 1 Cor. 4:17, 20; Col. 4:11; 1 Cor. 6:9-10; 15:50; Gal. 5:21; Eph. 5:5; James 2:5; 1 Thes. 2:12; 2 Pet. 1:11.**

**XIV. The kingdom in Revelation—Rev. 1:9; 12:10; 11:15.**

Reference : *The Basic Revelation in the Holy Scripture*, Chapter 6

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — THE KINGDOM**

Message Two

**The Kingdom (2) & The Chart**

## I. The difference between the kingdom of God and the kingdom of the heavens.

A. ***The kingdom of God.***

The kingdom of God is the divine ruling from eternity to eternity. It includes Adam in Eden (Gen. 2:8), the Patriarchs (from Adam to Jacob), the nations of Israel (Exo. 19:6), the church (Matt. 16:18-19), the restored nation of Israel (Acts 1:6; 15:16), the millennium (Rev. 20:4, 6), and the new heaven and new earth (Rev. 21:1-2).

B. ***The kingdom of the heavens.***

The kingdom of the heavens is the heavenly ruling from the beginning of the church to the end of the millennium.

C. ***A transitional period.***

Between the close of the Old Testament age and the beginning of the kingdom of the heavens was a transitional period. This was the time in which John lived—Matt. 11:11.

D. ***Beginning at Pentecost.***

1. The Lord Jesus told Peter that He would build His church and that He would give Peter the keys of the kingdom of the heavens—Matt. 16:18-19.
2. The descent of the Holy Spirit on the day of Pentecost marks the beginning of the kingdom of the heavens (Acts 2:1-4) and the beginning of the fulfillment of the parable of the wheat and the tares.

## II. The reality of the kingdom of the heavens.

The reality of the kingdom of the heavens, as the reality of the church life (Rom. 14:!7), is revealed in Matthew 5 through 7.

## III. The appearance of the kingdom of the heavens.

The appearance of the kingdom of the heavens is revealed in the parables of the tares, of the mustard seed, and of the leaven—Matt. 13:24-42.

A. The tares are the nominal, false believers.

B. Leaven signifies evil things (1 Cor. 5:6, 8) and evil doctrines (Matt. 16:6, 11-12)

## IV. The manifestation of the kingdom of the heavens.

The manifestation of the kingdom of the heavens and the kingdom of the Father (Matt. 13:43) is the heavenly part of the millenium, in which the overcoming saints will reign with Christ as co-kings.

## V. Christ's dispensational reward.

While salvation is eternal, the reward is dispensational. Regeneration (John 3:5) is the entrance into the kingdom of God (God's eternal salvation) to all believers. The surpassing righteousness and the doing of God's will (Matt. 5:20; 7:21) is the entrance into the kingdom of the heavens (the dispensational reward that will be given to the faithful followers of Christ).

A. Reward or punishment.

Christians will either receive a reward or suffer discipline. The reward is the kingship to be exercised by Christ with His faithful followers in the one thousand years. The punishment is God's discipline to the loose and unfaithful Christians—Matt.24:50-51.

B. The need for repentance and confession.

God's forgiving and Christ's cleansing of the believers when they sin is based upon their confession—1 John 1:9.

C. Overcomers.

The overcomers, who live in the reality of the kingdom of the heavens in the present church age, will be rewarded with the enjoyment of eternal life in the millenium (Matt. 19:28-29; 24:45-47; 25:19-23), they will also be co-kings with Christ in the millenium (Why. 20:4, 6; 2 Tim. 2:12).

**VI. The Millenium.**

The millenium has an earthly part and a heavenly part. In the millenium, there will be three kinds of people: the overcoming saints as kings in the heavenly part, the restored Jews as the priests in the earthly part (Zech. 8:20-23; Isa. 2:2-3), and the sheep, the nations, as the people (Matt. 25:32-34).

**VII. The kingdom of God in its fullest extent.**

The fullest extent of the kingdom of God will begin in the new heaven and the new earth (1 Cor. 15:24; Rev. 21:1-2). In this eternal kingdom, all the redeemed saints through all the ages will enjoy the eternal blessings of eternal life in the New Jerusalem as the sons of God and kings with Christ over the nations forever (Rev. 21:6-7; 22:3b-5, 14, 17).

Reference : *The Basic Revelation in the Holy Scripture*, Chapter 7

# TRUTH CLASS — THE KINGDOM

Message Three

## The Reality of the Kingdom

Scripture Reading : Matt. 5:3-12, 13-16, 20-45a, 48; 6:1-34; John 1:4; 1 Pet. 1:4; Matt. 22:11-14; Rev. 19:8; Matt. 22:11-12; 7:1-27; 12:36; 19:23-26

**I. The character of the children of the kingdom—Matt. 5:1-12.**

A. Poor in spirit.
B. Mourning.
C. Meek.
D. Hungry and thirsty after righteousness.
E. Merciful.
F. Pure in heart.
G. Making peace.
H. Persecuted for righteousness.
I. Persecuted for Christ.

**II. The influence of the children of the kingdom upon the world—Matt. 5:13-16.**

**III. The law of the children of the kingdom—Matt. 5:17-48.**

A. Surpassing righteousness.
B. Inward pureness.
C. Not swearing—Matt. 5: 33-37; Lev. 19:12; Num. 30:2.
D. Not resisting an evil person—Matt. 5:39; Exo. 21:24; Lev. 24:20; Deut. 19:21.
E. Loving your enemy—Lev. 19:18; Matt. 5:44.

**IV. The purity of the children of the kingdom—Matt. 6:10, 3, 17-18.**

**V. The attitude of the children of the kingdom toward riches.**

A. Not laying up riches—Matt. 6:19-23; 2 Cor. 12:14.
B. Not serving riches—Matt. 6:24.
C. Trusting our Father for our living—Matt. 6:25-33.

**VI. The principle of the children of the kingdom toward people.**

A. Christ being the kingdom—Gen. 1: 26-28.
B. Not judging others—Matt. 7:1-12.
C. Idle words—Matt. 12:36; 7:3.
D. Having discernment—Matt. 7:6.
E. Prayer—Matt. 7:7-8, 12.
F. By His life.

**VII. The grounds of the children of the kongdom—Matt. 7:13-29.**

A. A narrow gate and a constricted way—Matt. 7:13-14; 19:24; 7:24-27; 1 Cor. 3:15.

B. Fruit of a good tree—Matt. 7:15-20; Gen. 3:18.
C. The will of God—Matt. 7:21-23; Rom. 12:2.
D. The word of Christ—Col. 3:16.

Reference: *The Kingdom*, Chapter 32 ~ 34

# TRUTH CLASS — THE KINGDOM

Message Four

## The Appearance of the Kingdom

Scripture Reading : Matt. 5:3, 8, 10-11, 20; 7:21; 18:3; 13:24-33; 16:6; Mark 8:15.

**I. Three aspeck of the kingdom:**

A. The reality of the kingdom (Matt. 5-7).

B. The appearance of the kingdom (Matt. 13).

C. The manifestation of the kingdom (Matt. 24-25).

**II. The appearance of the kingdom—Gen. 1:11-12; Ezek. 1:22.**

A. Tares—Matt. 13:24-30; 2 Cor. 5:21.

B. The mustard seed—Matt. 13:31-32, 13:19.

C. Leaven—Matt.13:33; Rev. 17:3; Isa. 53:2; Matt. 16:6; Mark. 8:15.

Reference: *The Kingdom*, Chapter 35

**TRUTH CLASS — THE KINGDOM**

Message Five

## The Manifestation of the Kingdom

Scripture Reading : Matt. 25:1, 6, 10-12, 14-30; Luke 19:11-27; Matt. 24:44-51; Luke 12:42-48; Matt. 19:28; 20:21-23; 2 Tim. 2:12a; Rev. 2:26-27; 3:21; 12:5; 20:4-6; John 3:16; Matt. 25:18-30; Col. 3:11; Luke 19:22; 2 Cor. 12:9-10; Matt. 16:27; 2 Cor. 5:9-10; 1 Cor. 4:5; 3:12-15; 9:24-27; 2 Tim. 4:6-8; 1 Pet. 5:4; Rev. 22:12; Eph. 2:8-9.

**I. The ten virgins—Matt. 25:13; 1 Cor. 3:12-15.**

**II. The talents—Matt. 25:14-30; 2 Cor. 12:10.**

**III. Calvinism and Arminianism.**

**IV. The reward—Matt. 16:27; 2 Cor. 5:9-10; Luke 12:46-47; Zech. 12:10-14; 1 Cor. 4:5.**

**V. Tried by fire—1 Cor. 3:12-15.**

**VI. Receiving the prize—1 Cor. 9:24-27.**

**VII. A crown of righteousness—2 Tim. 4:6-8.**

**VIII. A crown of glory—1 Pet. 5:4; Rev. 22:12.**

Reference : *The Kingdom*, Chapter 36 ~ 38.

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM**

Message One

**The Ultimate Consummation (1 – 2)**

**( 1 )**

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:1-3, 9-14, 16-23, 22:1-2, 5, 14, 17.

**I. Creation and building—Rom. 4:17; Matt. 16:18; 21: 33-43; Acts. 4:12.**

**II. Regeneration man, God's building material—Gen. 2:7; Proverb 20:27; John 3:5; 1:12-13; Col. 3:4; 1 John 5:12; 2 Pet. 1:4; Rom. 8:16; 1 John 3:1.**

**III. A golden mountain—Rev. 21:18, 16.**

**IV. Gold, precious stones, and pearls—Rev. 21:18-20; 2 Cor. 3:18; Rev. 21:21.**

**V. The divine building with transformed humanity—1 Cor. 3:10-12; Gen. 3:19; John 1:42; 1 Pet. 2:4-5.**

**VI. The two ends of the Bible reflecting each other—Gen. 2:9-12, 21-23.**

**VII. God's building in Exodus—Exo. 28:15-21, 30.**

**VIII. God's building in the New Testament—1 Cor. 3:10-12; 1 Pet. 2:2-5; John 1:14; 3:5.**

**IX. The tabernacle of God—John 1:14.**

**X. The aggregate of all the lampstands—Rev. 21:21; 22:2; 21:16-17; 22:1; 21:23; 22:5.**

A. The city and its street—Rev. 21:18b, 21b.

B. Twelve foundations and twelve gates—Rev. 21:14, 19-20, 12-13, 21a.

C. Precious stones—Rev. 21:19-20, 18a, 11b.

D. The length, breadth, and height of the city—1 Kings 6:20; Exo. 26:2-8; Rev. 21:16.

E. No temple—Rev. 21:22; 1 Sam. 3:3; Rev. 22:3.

F. The glory of God as the light and the Lamb as the lamp—Rev. 21:23; 22:5.

G. The throne of God and of the Lamb—Rev. 22:1-2; John 15:1; Rev. 2:7; John 6:57; 14:6; Gen. 2:9.

**XI. The bride, the wife of the Lamb—Rev. 21:2, 9; John 3:26-29; Rev. 22:17; Acts. 2:27; Eph. 4:9; Heb. 13:8.**

**(2)**

Scripture Reading : Rev. 1:1; 21:1-3, 10-21.

**I. The key to understanding John's writings—Rev. 1:1; 2:1, John 11:47; 1:14; 10:7.**

**II. The main signs in Revelation.**

A. The lampstands—Rev. 1:20; 4:5.

B. The seven stars—Rev. 1:20; Dan. 12:3; Matt. 13:43.

C. Jasper—the appearance of God—Rev. 4:2-3; 21:11, 18; 2 Cor. 3:18, Gen. 1:26.

D. The lion of the tribe of Judah—Rev. 5:5.

E. The Lamb—Rev. 5:6.

F. The universal woman and the Man-Child—Rev. 12:1, 17.

G. The great red dragon and the beast—Rev. 12:3-4; 13:1-2.

H. The harvest and the firstfruit—Rev. 14:15.

I. Babylon the great—Rev. 17:1, 5.

J. The wife of the Lamb—Rev. 19:7, 20:4-6; 2 Pet. 3:8.

K. The New Jerusalem.

**III. A review of the signs.**

A. Seven lampstands, signifying the churches.

B. Seven shining stars, signifying the messengers of all the churches.

C. A jasper stone, signifying God's appearance.

D. A lion and a lamb, both signifying Christ.

E. A universal woman with twelve stars on her head, the sun clothing her, and the moon under her feet.

F. A read dragon ready to swallow her child.

G. A man-child brought forth by her and raptured to the throne of God.

H. A beast coming up from the Mediterranean.

I. A harvest on this earth, and out of the harvest a firstfruit.

J. A great prostitute, the great Babylon.

K. A beautiful wife, the bride. Isteri, mempelai perempuan yang cantik.

L. The New Jerusalem, which is a tabernacle to God and a wife to God's Son, Jesus Christ.

**IV. Understanding Revelation.**

**V. Interpreting the New Jerusalem.**

A. The key to Revelation—"by signs"—Rev. 1:1; 1 Pet. 2:5.

B. Consistent with the whole Bible—Psalm 90:1.

1. In the New Testament times God's dwelling on this earth was firstly a single Person, Jesus Christ—John 14:23; 15:4; 1 John 3:24; 4:15; Rev. 21:22; 21:16.
2. Then, the church as a corporate person became the temple of God, God's dwelling—Eph. 2:21-22; 1 Cor. 3:16.
3. After the New Testament age, this corporate person will be enlarged, intensified and built up together as God's dwelling place.

C. Not a literal city.

D. God's dwelling place for eternity—John 1:14; 1 Cor 3:16; Rev. 21:9-10; 21:12, 14; John 3:5; Rev. 21:18b, 21b.

E. The last and greatest sign—Matt. 22:30; Rev. 21:16; Matt. 16:18; 1 Pet. 2:5; 1 Cor. 3:10-12.

Reference : *The Basic Revelation in the Holy Scripture*, Chapter 8 ~ 9

**TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM**

Message Two

**The Ultimate Consummation (3 – 4)**

**( 3 )**

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:2-3; 10-23; 22:1-2a, 14, 17, 19.

**I. Two main schools of interpretation—a physical city and the heavenly mansion.**

**II. A revelation of God's dwelling place—Gen. 1:1; 1:26-27.**

A. Bethel—the House of God—Gen. 28:11-19.

B. The tabernacle—God's House—1 Sam. 3:3; Exo. 40:34.

C. The tabernacle—Jesus Christ, the God-man—John 1:1, 14; Rev. 21:3.

D. The tabernacle and the temple—2 Sam. 7:2; 5-13, 2 Chron. 5:1, 5; John 1:14; 2:19-21; Eph. 2:6; 1 Cor.3:16.

E. The church—composed of the living members of Christ—1 Pet. 2:5.

F. The church—humanity and divinity—1 John 5:11, 2 Pet. 1:4.

G. The consummation of the temple—Rev. 21:7, 9.

**III. The intrinsic elements of God's building.**

A. The divine trinity—the basic structure.

1. The Father's nature, signified by gold—Rev. 21:18b, 21b.
2. The Son's redemption through death and resurrection is signified by the pearl—Rev. 21:21a.
3. The Spirit's transformation is signified by the precious stones—Rev. 21:19a.

B. The divine life—the inner supply and nourishment.

1. The water of life flowing out of the divine throne to saturate the entire city—Rev. 22:1, 17.
2. In the water grows the tree of life, which bears twelve kinds of fruit every month, twelve months yearly, to feed the entire city—Rev. 22:2a, 14,19.

C. The divine light—inward light and outward glory.

1. God in the Lamb is the lamp as the inward light—Rev. 21:23.
2. The glory of God is God Himself, shining out of the city through the transparent wall of jasper—Rev. 21:11, 18.

D. A mingling of the Triune God with the tripartite man.

1. This mingling is the eternal dwelling of God, signified by the number twelve. Twelve is three (the Triune God) multiplied by four (man).
2. The city is square with four sides. On each side are three gates—Rev. 21:13.
3. Twelve foundations of twelve precious stones bear the names of the twelve apostles—Rev. 21:14, 19-20.
4. Twelve gates of twelve pearls with twelve angels bear the names of the twelve tribes—Rev. 21:12, 21a.
5. The city's measurement is twleve thousand stadia in three dimensions—Rev. 21:16.

6. The height of the wall is one hundred forty-four cubits—Rev. 21:17a.
7. The tree of life produces twelve fruits in each of the twelve months yearly—Rev. 22:2.

E. A building in resurrection—man's being like an angle indicates the principle of resurrection—Rev. 21:17b; Matt. 22:30.

F. A full expression of the Triune God—Rev. 21:18; 4:3; Gen. 1:26; Rev. 1:2, 12.

**(4)**

Scripture Reading: Rev. 21:3-4, 6-7, 24, 26; 22:2-5, 14,17.

**I. The Old Testament—Bethel, God's house—Gen. 28:11-19.**

**II. The New Testament:**

A. The incarnated God "tabernacled among us"—John 1:14.

B. The fullness of the Godhead dwells in Christ bodily, in Christ with a human, physical body—Col. 2:9.

C. The Lord Jesus's physical body was a temple of God—Yoh. 2:21.

D. When Christ was raised, we were resurrected together with Him. Through that all- inclusive resurrection we have all been regenerated. We have been born of God and are His sons. This implies that the very temple the Lord Jesus built up in three days, that is, in His resurrection, is not an individual thing but a corporate thing—John 2:19; Eph. 2:6; 1 Pet. 1:3.

E. The saints are the temple of God—1 Cor. 3:16.

F. The New Jerusalem as the conclusion of the Bible is called the tabernacle—Rev. 21:3.

G. There is not an temple in the holy city, "for its temple is the Lord God the Almighty and the Lamb"—Rev. 21:22.

H. The measurement of the New Testament is the same in length, breadth, and height. The principle revealed in the Bible is that a building with three dimensions the same indicates the Holy of Holies. According to the measurement of the New Jerusalem, this holy city must be the Holy of Holies—Rev. 21:16.

**III. Four dispensations for God's building:**

A. The dispensation of the Patriarchs, from Adam to Moses, was the dispensation before law.

B. The dispensation of law, from Moses to Christ's first coming.

C. The dispensation of grace, lasting from Christ's first coming to His second coming.

D. With His second coming the fourth dispensation will begin, that is, the thousand-year reign of Christ.

**IV. God's work—a work of building—Matt. 16:18; Acts 4:10-11; 1 Pet. 2:4-5; 1 Cor. 3:10-12; John 1:41-42, 51; 2:19, 21-22; Rev. 3:12.**

A. After helping His disciples to realize that He was the Christ, the Son of the living God, He immediately revealed that He would build His church—Matt. 16:18.

B. The Jewish leaders were the builders who had rejected Christ, the living stone, yet God had raised Him up and made Him the cornerstone of His building—Acts 4:10-11.

C. The Lord is the living stone, and we all as living stones come to the Lord and are being built up a spiritual house—1 Pet. 2:4-5.

D. Paul has laid the unique foundation, and no ane can lay another. The problem, however, is how we build upon it. We can build either with gold, silver, and precious stones or with wood, grass, and stubble—1 Cor. 3:10-12.

E. The Lord changed Simon's name to Cephas, a stone—John 1:41-42.

F. The Lord was referring Nathanael to the dream of his forefather Jacob, indicating that a building work of Bethel, the house of God, was beginning—John 1:51.

G. The Lord built up His body in resurrection as God's corporate temple—John 2:19, 21-22.

H. The overcomers will be built in God's temple as pillars—Rev. 3:12.

**V. The aggregate of the divine sonship—Rom. 8:23; John 1:18, 3:16; Rom. 8:29; John 20:17; Heb. 2:11.**

A. Leading many sons into glory—Heb. 2:10; Rom. 8:18-23; Phil. 3:21.

1. The Triune God is still working today to bring His many sons into glory—Heb. 2:10.
2. The entire fallen creation, now under the slavery of corruption eagerly expects to see us in glory. That glory will be the freedom of the glory of the children of God, which is our full redemption—Rom. 8:18-23.
3. Our body has not yet been redeemed, but one day it will be transfigured into a glorious body—Phil. 3:21.

B. Sons, brothers, and members.

To God we are the many sons, to Christ we are the many brothers, and to His Body we are the members.

C. Total sonship.

The total sonship will be completed through the coming rapture and resurrection. This sonship is for the corporate expression of the great God who is triune—the Father, the Son, and the Spirit.

**VI. Predestinated unto sonship—Eph. 1:4-5; John 1:12, 14; 2:19, 21-22.**

**VII. Sonship in Romans 8—Rom. 8:14-16, 19, 29.**

**VIII. A corporate expression of God—Rev. 4:3; 21:18; Gen. 1:26.**

**IX. Two categories—Rev. 1:6; 21:3, 7, 24, 6; John 1:12-13; 1 Pet. 1:3-4, 23; James 1:18; 1 Cor. 3:9-12a; Eph. 2:20-22; 1 Pet. 2:4-6; 2 Cor. 3:18; Rom. 12:2; Eph. 4:23-24; Rom. 8:29-30; Heb. 2:10; Rev. 21:11.**

A. The sons of God:

1. The sons of God are the people who are reborn, transformed, glorified, and conformed, that will be the components of New Jerusalem
2. They would be both the house of God and the wife of Christ—Rev. 21:3, 9.
3. Their basic enjoyments in the New Jerusalem for eternity will eat the tree of life and drink the water of life—Rev. 22:14, 17.
4. They will serve God and the Lamb as His slaves for eternity—Rev. 22:3.
5. They will all the kings over the nations—the people—for eternity—Rev. 22:5.
6. The angels will be serving them—Heb. 1:13-14.

B. The peoples of God—Matt. 25:31-46; Rev. 20:11; 14:6-7; Matt. 25:34-36; Rev. 20:4, 6; Acts 3:21; Rev. 20:7-9; 21:24, 3; 22:5; 21:4; 22:3a, 2.

**X. A final view:**

A. The saints throughout all the dispensations who have been redeemed will be the reborn ones, God's sons, belonging to the royal family. They will be kings in eternity.

B. The restored remnant of the unbelievers will be the peoples, the nations, walking in the light of the city and ruled by the saints.

C. The perished unbelievers will be in the lake of fire—Rev. 21:8.

Reference : *The Basic Revelation in the Holy Scripture*, Chapter 10 ~ 11

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Three

## The Ultimate Consummation

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:1-2, 9-11.

**I. The traditional teachings versus the ultímate consummation.**

A. According to the the traditional teachings, the New Jerusalem is a wonderful heavenly mansion that was prepared by the Lord for us. After preparing this mansion, He would come back.

B. The New Jerusalem is altogether a spiritual, heavenly, and divine sign, not a physical city and not something physical. The New Jerusalem is first a sign and eventually a consummation. The New Jerusalem is the consummation of every positive thing, that is the ultimate consummation of God, of God's salvation, of Christ's redemption, of the Spirit's transformation, and of every positive thing in the Bible. The New Jerusalem has nothing to do with the negative things such as Satan, the fallen angels, the demons, death, sin, darkness, the grave, Hades, or the lake of fire (Hymns, #971, 972, 975, 976, 978-980).

**II. The ultimate consummation:**

A. Of the entire divine revelation in the Holy Scriptures.

B. Of the eternal purpose of God.

C. Of the God's purpose in man.

D. Of the mingling of the Triune God with man.

E. Of the positive types, figures, and signs of the Scriptures.

F. Of the lampstands in the Scriptures—Exo. 25:31-37; 1 Kings 7:49; Zech. 4::2; Rev. 1:12-13, 20; 21:18; 21:23; 22:5.

G. Of all the buildings in the Scriptures:

1. The building of the tabernacle—Exo. 25:8-9.
2. The building of the temple—1 Kings 6:1-2.
3. The building of Jerusalem—Psa. 122:3.
4. The rebuilding of the temple—Ezra 3:8-9.
5. The rebuilding of Jerusalem—Neh. 2:17.
6. In the New Testament the building of the church.
7. We are all living stones for God's building—1 Pet. 2:5.
8. Paul was a wise master builder who had laid the foundation of Christ, and all of us need to build on this foundation of Christ, and all of us need to build on this foundation with gold, silver, and the precious stone—1 Cor. 3:9-12.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 26

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Four

## Its Designations (1)

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:2-3a; 2 Cor. 5:17; Col. 3:10–11; Heb. 11:10, 1 Cor. 3:12; Rev. 21:19, 20; Heb. 11:11-16; 12:22; John 1 :14a; Exo. 26:15, 29a.

**IV. The New Jerusalem:**

*A.* ***New—Ezek. 36:26; Eph. 4:23;***

1. **Possessing the divine nature and the divine life—Rev. 21:18b; 21b.**
2. **The new creation—2 Cor. 5:17.**
3. **The new man—Col. 3:10-11; 1 Cor. 12:12.**

*B.* ***Jerusalem—the foundation of peace—Phil. 4:9; 1 Thes. 5:23; Eph 2:14; John 14:27; 16:33.***

**II. The holy city:**

**A.** ***Holy—separated unto God and saturated with God—Rev. 21:2a; Rom. 6:19, 22; 1 Thes. 5:23; 1 Cor. 3:16.***

**B.** ***A city to which we have come—Heb. 11:14-16; 12:22; 3:1; 6:4; Col. 3:1-2.***

***1. Designed and built by God—Heb. 11:10; Eph. 2:10; 3:10.***

***2. Built with the divine materials—1 Cor. 3:12.***

***3. Built with solid foundations—Heb. 11:10; Rev. 21:19-20.***

***4. A heavenly and better country—Heb. 11:14-16; 12:22.***

**III. The tabernacle of God:**

**A.** ***As a person, not as a material building—Rev. 21:3a; 1 Cor. 3:16.***

**B.** ***Built with humanity and divinity—Exo. 26:15, 29; Lev. 2:4.***

**C.** ***A dwelling for both God and His serving ones—Rev. 21:22.***

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 27

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Five

## Its Designations ( 2 )

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:2, 9-14; 12:1-6, 13-17; 19:7-9; John 3:3, 5-6, 14, 29-30; Gal. 4:22-28, 31.

**I. The wife of the Lamb:**

***A. Composed of the Old and New Testaments saints—Rev. 21:9-14.***

***B. The children of Israel—the wife of Jehovah—Ezek. 23:1-4.***

***C. The believers—the wife of their Redeemer—2 Cor. 11:2.***

***D. One with her Redeemer—Gen. 2:21-24; Eph. 5:25-27, 29-32.***

***E. The universal and heavenly woman—Rev. 12:1-6, 13-17; Luke 1:78; Gen. 37:9; Rev. 12:11, 17, 6.***

***F. The consummation of the wife as the church—Eph. 5:25-27, 29-32.***

**1. His increase (Enlargement)—John 3:26, 30.**

**2. The millennium and eternity—Rev. 19:7-9; 2 Pet. 3:8.**

**II. The mother of the believers, the new covenant of grace—Gal. 4:24-28, 31.**

***A. The Triune God as the center, substance, element, and essence—Rev. 22:1; 1 Pet. 3:19-20.***

***B. The new covenant, the heavenly Jerusalem, and the church—Heb. 8:7-13; 12:22-23.***

Reference : G*od's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 28

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM**

Message Six

**The Basic Element of Its Structure ( 1 – 2 )**

**( 1 )**

Reading Scripture : Rev. 21:11, 18-21; Gen. 2:11-12; 1 Cor. 3:12a; 1 Pet. 2:4-5; Matt. 13:45-46, 2 Pet. 1:4; 2 Cor. 3:18.

**I. Gold, pearls, and precious stones—Rev. 21:11, 18-21.**

**II. Genesis 1–2.**

In Genesis 1 and 2 we see then significant items—God, creation, man, the tree of life, the river that flows, gold, bdellium, onyx stone, a wife, and a couple who became one flesh.

**III. Revelation 21–22.**

In Revelation 21 and 22, we see a city built with gold, pearls, and precious stone. In the New Jerusalem the gold is for the base, pearls are for the gates, and the precious stones are for the wall.

**IV. Gold, silver, and precious stones—1 Cor. 3:12.**

A. The gold referring to God with His divine nature—Rev. 21:18b, 21b.

B. Silver referring to the Redemeer with His redemption—Exo. 30:11-16; 38:25-28.

C. The precious stones signifying the produce of the Spirit in His transforming work—John 1:41-42; Rev. 21:14; 1 Pet. 2:4-5; Eph. 2:22.

**V. Bdellium, silver, and pearls.**

A. ***"Bdellium" in Genesis is something of the plant life. The plant life signifies the producing, multiplying and propagating life. In Genesis 2, sin had not come in yet, therefore at this time there was no need of redemption.***

B. ***After Genesis 3 when sin came in, there is the need of redemption. Therefore, in the process of the actual building in 1 Corinthians 3 there is silver which signifies redemption.***

C. ***In Revelation 21, there is pearl, which is out of oyster, the animal life. "Pearls", signifying the produce of Christ in His redemptive work with His secreting life for the entry into God's building—Rev. 21:21a.***

**VI. The Triune God as the building material—Isa. 53:4, 6, 10.**

**VII. Living stones and partakers of the divine nature—2 Pet. 1:4.**

**VIII. The base of God's building—gold signifies the divine nature of God—Rev. 21:18b, 21b.**

**(2)**

Scripture Reading : Rom. 1:20; Col. 2:9; Gen. 1:26a, 27; John 1:13; 1 John 3:9; 1 Pet. 1:3; 2 Pet. 1:4; John 4:24; 1 John 4:8, 16; 1:5; John 1:4; Rom. 8:2.

**I. The definition of the divine nature—2 Pet. 1:4.**

**II. Divinity—Rom. 1:20.**

"Divinity" denotes the characteristics of the divine nature. According to Romans 1:20 the creation only shows the characteristics, the expressions, of God's divine nature. In the creation you cannot see God's divine nature itself.

**III. Godhead—God's Person—Col. 2:9.**

**IV. The characteristics of God shown in creation—Rom. 1:20.**

***A. Brightness.***

B. ***Beauty.***

C. ***Orderliness, in the bountiful and inexhaustible supply of His divine life—Mark 6:39-40; John 6:12; Mark 6:43.***

D. Love—Mat. 5:45; Rom. 1:20.

**V. Man in God's creation.**

*A.* ***In God's creation, man was made only in the image of God, without the divine nature—Gen. 1:26a, 27.***

*B.* ***The ten commandments were a descriptions of God, that God is love, that God is light, that God is holy, and that God is righteous. God created man in such a morality of love, of light, of righteousness, and of holiness; but there was no divine nature—Exo. 16:34; 25:16, 21.***

*C.* ***When we believed in the Lord Jesus, we received a Person as our content and reality, that is the gift of the Holy Spirit as the realization of Christ—Acts 2:38.***

**VI. The divine nature—received through the divine birth—John 1:13; 1 John 3:9; 1 Pet. 1:3; 2 Pet. 1:4.**

**VII. The divine nature—what God is:**

*A.* ***Spirit, love, and light—John 4:24; 1 John 4:7-8, 16; 1:5; 3:9; 2 Pet. 1:3.***

*B.* ***Love and light related to God as life—John 1:4; Rom. 8:2; 1 John 1:3-7; 2:5, 27-28; 3:6, 24.***

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 29 ~ 30

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM**

Message Seven

**The Basic Element of Its Structure ( 3 – 4 )**

**( 3 )**

Scripture Reading : John 1:13; 1 John 3:9; 1:2-3; 4:8, 16; 1:5-7; 2 Pet. 1:3a, 4-7.

**I. The partaking and enjoying of the divine nature:**

A. In John's line.

1. In 1 John, we see that we have the divine fellowship of the divine life, so we may touch God as light and as love—1 John 1:1-3, 5; 4: 9-16.
2. In John's Gospel, Christ came with grace and truth, so we may have the divine life, and we may become His children—John 1:17; 3:14-16; 1:12-13.

B. In Peter's line.

1. By God's divine power, we have been allotted like precious **faith** and all things related to life and godliness—2 Pet. 1:1, 3a.
2. God has granted to us precious and exceedingly great promises, therefore we can be partakers of the divine nature—2 Pet. 1:4-7; Matt. 28:20; John 6:57; 7:38-39; 10:28-29; 14:19-20; 23; 15:5; 16:13-15.
3. In the fellowship with the Lord, we let the divine seed of the allotted **faith** and the **divine nature** within us **develop** to its consummation—**the divine nobler love**——1 John 3:9; 4:8,16; Matt. 5:45; Eph. 5:25.

**( 4 )**

Scripture Reading : 1 Pet. 1:15–16, 22; 2 Pet. 1:7; 3:11; 1 John 1:5–9; 2:29; 3:7.

**I. The issue of partaking of and enjoying the divine nature:**

A. In Peter's line:

1. Holiness with love.
   a. Holiness is not an element but a condition, a manner. The real meaning of the word "holiness" is separation and distinction. Gold, which typifies God in His divine nature, is the material thing that is distinct and uncommon in the universe. God is holy, because God is distinct and separate from all the material things in the universe, and the New Jerusalem is a golden mountain, a distinct entity in the entire universe—1 Pet. 1:15-16; Heb. 12:10.
   b. The genuine holiness, the consummation of the Christian holiness, is the issue of the enjoyment of God as love. This love makes you holy, makes you different, makes you distinct, makes you separated from being common—1 Pet. 1:22.
2. Love in holiness—2 Pet. 1:7; 3:10-11; 1 Cor. 13:4-8.

When we enjoy God as love we even become love and this issues in holiness, because the divine love sanctifies us, separates us, and makes us different. Therefore, love is the essence of the divine life and holiness is the manner of this life.

B. In John's line:

1. Righteousness with light.

If we remain in the divine fellowship, we will enjoy God as light. This light issues in righteousness. When we are in the light, we do everything right. Sin is the opposite of righteousness. To confess our sins is to cleanse us from all unrighteousness, that is to make us right—1 John 1:2-3, 5-7; 1:8-2:1.

2. Light in righteousness—1 John 2:29; 3:7.

Light always regulates us and keeps us in order. Light is the nature of the divine expression; righteousness is the expression of the life that enjoys God. If we are in the light and are enjoying God as light, we will have an expression that we are right in everything and with everyone.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 31~32

**FULL-TIME TRAINING INDONESIA**

**TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM**

Message Eight

**The Basic Element of Its Structure ( 5 – 6 )**

**( 5 )**

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:11, 18-21; John 19:34; Matt. 13:45-46; John 3:5, Gen. 2:12b; 1 Cor. 3:12a

**I. The greatest allegory in the Bible—Rev. 21:10.**

**II. The divine Trinity—Gen. 1:1, 26.**

A. The divine Trinity is the greatest and the basic attribute of God.

B. The divine Trinity is for the divine dispensing, and this dispensing consummates in the New Jerusalem.

C. The number three is so prevalent in the New Jerusalem because this number represents the divine Trinity, for example: in the New Jerusalem there are three gates on four sides and the New Jerusalem is constructed with three basic elements—gold, pearls, and precious stones.

**III. The significance of the pearls—Rev. 21:21.**

A. Pearls are produced by oyster in the waters of death. When the oyster is wounded by a particle of sand, a little rock, it secretes its life-juice around the sand and makes it a precious pearl.

B. The oyster depicts Christ as the living One coming into the death waters, being wounded by us, and secreting His life over us to make us precious pearls for the building of God's eternal habitation and expression.

C. The pearls signify the produce of Christ in His redemptive work with His secreting life for the entry into God's building.

D. The twelve gates of the holy city are the twelve pearls signifies that regeneration through the death-overcoming and life-secreting Christ is the entrance into the city.

**IV. Remaining in the death of Christ—Phil. 3:10.**

A. After the little rock wounds the oyster, it stays in the wound, and the oyster will not let it go. It grasps the rock in the very wound it made, so the wound becomes its residence, its home, its dwelling place.

B. The wound signifies the death of Christ in which we sinners who wounded Christ are captured, kept, and imprisoned. The very death which Christ accomplished on the cross, becomes our rest, our residence, our home, and our unique place of protection.

C. We have to stay in the death of Christ. As long as we are staying in His wound, His life reacts, and this reaction is a secretion of His resurrection life.

D. We should be one with Him all the time in His death and resurrection. Our oneness with Him is in the Spirit.

E. The secretion of His resurrection is in the Spirit—the reality of His resurrection.

**V. Blood and water—John 19:34; *Hymns* #1058 stanza 1.**

Hymns #1058 stanza 1: *Rock of Ages, cleft for me, let me hide myself in Thee; Let the water and the blood, from Thy riven side which flowed, be of sin the double cure, save me from its guilt and power*

A. His redemption gives us a double cure.

B. First, His blood saves us from the guilt of sin, He washes away our sins and filthiness.

C. Second, His life saves us from the power of sin, He regenerates us and He keeps away our death.

**VI. The divine element being added to our human element.**

A. To produce pearls needs two elements mingled together. The wounding rock is one element and the oyster's secretion brings the element of the oyster life to this rock.

B. Our human life, our human being, with our natural element is the rock. After we wounded Christ, He captured us and He is now keeping us in His death to secrete Himself around us, which is the adding of His divine element to our human element.

C. The secretion is the operation of His life-giving Spirit. The way to enjoy His Spirit is to stay in in His death. The more we stay in His death, the more we have His Spirit moving in us. This moving of His life-giving Spirit is the secreting of His divine life.

**VII. A collective pearl.**

**VIII. The entry into God's building—Matt. 13:45-46; John 3:5.**

The more we are made pearls, the more we are in the New Jerusalem, and the more we are in the kingdom.

**( 6 )**

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:11, 18a, 19–20; 2 Cor. 3:18; Phil. 1:19; Gen. 2:12b; 1 Cor. 3:12a; 1 Pet. 2:4-5; Rev. 4:3a.

**I. Gold, pearls, and precious stones.**

A. Gold refers to the divine nature of God the Father.

B. Pearls refer to the produce of Christ in His overcoming death and life-secreting resurrection.

C. Precious stones signify the produce of the Spirit in His transforming work with His divine element for the building up of God's building—Rev. 21:11, 18a, 19-20; Gen. 2:12b; 1 Cor. 3:12a, 1 Pet. 2:4-5; 2 Cor. 3:18.

**II. The lesson on Gamaliel — Kis. 5:34; 22:3; 5:38-39.**

Gamaliel was a godly man who feared God, he was content with the knowledge of God that he had received according to their traditional teaching, yet he did not know anything concerning God's New Testament economy. Gamaliel did not know anything about Jesus Christ moving as the very embodiment of the Triune God to dispense the divine Trinity into God's chosen people and how this dispensing produces a corporate vessel which is the church, the Body of Christ, the fullness of the One who fills all in all, to express God in a corporate way consumming in the New Jerusalem.

**III. The divine nature and its development — Rev. 21:21.**

The New Jerusalem is a golden mountain. When we were regenerated, we received the nature of God and a part of this golden mountain entered into our being. This nature is developing. Now we need to let this divine nature have the best cooperation and the best environment that it may grow and develop within us.

**IV. The Son's secreting work.**

The redemptive work of God the Son is all-inclusive. If we stay in His death, He might secrete His resurrection life over us, so we can enjoy the secreting of the divine life in resurrection. This is the life-secreting work of Christ.

**V. The Spirit's transforming work.**

A. Christ secretes His resurrection life over us, the Spirit then uses this secreting life to transform us.

B. The secreting work is only an addition to add more of the divine life to our natural life, but the transforming work is to change our being metabolically, so that our entire being will be gradually transformed not only in form but also in essence.

C. The more we look at the Lord with an unveiled face, the more He secretes the resurrected life over our being, and we are being transformed into the same image from glory to glory—2 Cor. 3:17-18.

**VI. Transformation for God's building.**

A. The transforming work of the Spirit produces the precious stones for God's building, for the building of the wall—Phil. 1:19; Gen. 2:12b; 1 Cor. 3:12a; 1 Pet. 2:4-5.

B. The main material in the building of the holy city is jasper. Since jasper signifies God expressed in His communicable glory, the main function of the holy city is to express God in bearing His glory—Rev. 4:3; 21:11, 18-19.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 33 ~ 34

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Nine

## Its Triune Entrance

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:12-13, 21a; Eph. 2:18; Luke 15:4, 8, 20; Matt. 8:11; Gal. 3:24; Rev. 5:9; Luke 15:7; Heb. 1:14.

**I. The Son's outer seeking, the Spirit's inner searching, and the Father's receiving—Luke 15.**

A. The shepherd refers to the Son who came to seek the fallen sinners—Luke 15:4.

B. The woman refers to the Holy Spirit who is searching the sinners within themselves—Luke 15:8.

C. The Father receives the repenting and returned sinner as a certain man receives his prodigal son—Luke 15:20.

**II. Through the Son, in the Spirit, unto the Father—Eph. 2:18.**

The Son came to be our channel and through this channel we get into the Spirit, and the Spirit brings us unto the Father.

**III. The Father's choosing, the Spirit's sanctifying, and the sprinkling of the Son's blood—1 Pet. 1:2.**

**IV. Toward all the inhabited earth—Rev. 21:13; Matt. 8:11; Rev. 5:9.**

The twelve gates as the intrance of the New Jerusalem are on four sides of the earth, signifying that the entrance of the New Jerusalem is torward all the inhabited earth. It is available to all the peoples on the earth.

**V. The triune entry:**

A. When we heard the preaching of the gospel the Spirit worked within us. We then believed in Jesus Christ and were touched by the Spirit to call on the name of the Lord Jesus, the Son of God who became incarnated to be our Redeemer. Eventually we reached the Father and were brought into the Father. This is the triune entry.

B. We enter into God through the triune entrance. The Son is the channel, the Spirit is the sphere, and the Father is the very destination.

**VI. Twelve gates:**

A. There are three gates on each of the four sides of the holy city. Three multiplied by four is twelve; therefore, there are a total of twelve gates on four sides. "Four" refers to God's creatures, and "three" refers to the Triune God—Rev. 4:6.

B. The number "twelve" in the New Jerusalem is not arrived at by an addition but by multiplication. Multiplication is a blending or a mingling. The number "twelve" is mingled or blended by three times four. This means that the entire New Jerusalem is a blending, a mingling, of the Triune God with us human beings. God is mingled with His creature man in His eternal administration in the New Jerusalem.

C. The gates are for communication, coming in and going out. "Twelve" is the number of absolute perfection and eternal completion in God's administration. "Twelve gates" indicate that the communication in the New Jerusalem is absolutely perfect and eternally complete for God's administration.

**VII. Twelve pearls—Rev. 21:21a.**

The twelve gates are twelve pearls, signifying that the entrance is the produce of Christ in His

redemptive and secreting work.

**VIII. The names of the twelve tribes—Rev. 21:12.**

A. The twelve gates are inscribed with the names of the twelve tribes of Israel who were the representatives of the law of the Old Testament, signifying the requirement of the law at the entrance into the kingdom of God.

B. The names of the twelve tribes inscribed on the twelve gates indicate that the law is watching over the twelve gates. The law is the gate watcher or the guard at the gate to insure that we have fulfilled its requirement.

C. As long as we are in Jesus Christ, every part of the requirement of the law is fulfilled, and we can now get into the holy city.

D. When we came to the triune entrance we had a "free ticket" because Christ paid the price for us, and the guard at the gate (the law) honors Christ.

**IX. The law—a child-conductor—Gal. 3:24.**

A. The law is not only at the gate, but the law also brings all God's chosen people to the gate.

B. The law is the conductor to bring us to the gate, and the law is also the guard to "okay" our entry.

**X. Twelve angels—Rev. 21:12; Luke 15:7, 10; Heb. 1:14.**

Twelve angels at the twelve gates, signifying that the angels watch over the entry into the New Jerusalem. Each gate not only bears one of the names of the twelve tribes, but also has an angel. The law requires and the angel watches. The angels are spectators.

Reference: *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 35

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Ten

## Its Wall, Its Foundation, and Its Street

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:12a, 14, 17-20, 21b; 22:1-2; 4:3a; Matt. 22:30

**I. Its wall :**

The wall was built with jasper, signifying the appearance of God for His expression. The wall is great and high for separation unto God and for protected of God's interest—Rev. 21:18a; 4:3a; 21:12.

A. Seven implication:

1. Transformation:
   a. The foundations of the wall bear the names of the twelve apostles. Each apostle is signified by a precious stone—Rev. 21:14.
   b. The wall is not built with natural materials merely created by God, but the wall is built with transformed items.
   c. The church life is not a life of a good, natural life, but the church life must be a transformed life, a life under transformation.
2. Building—All of our sharp corners need to be cut off in order to get along with others.
3. The image of God—The appearance of the city is the same as the One sitting on the throne.
4. The expression of God—The expression of the divine image through transformation and building.
5. The testimony of Jesus—The New Jerusalem will be His enlargement, His increase, and His expansion to express His as God's embodiment, and this is the testimony of Jesus—Rev. 1:9; 12:17; 19:10; 20:4.
6. Separation—The surrounding wall separates what is in it from all other things, it is the absolute sanctification. "The holy city" means the separated city, a city that is separated from anything other than God.
7. Protection—The wall is to protect God's interest, which is the kingdom of God. The church should be a separated and protected entity. There should be nothing in the church but God's desire.

B. In resurrection—Rev. 21:17; Matt. 22:30.

The wall is also measured in "a measure of a man, that is, of an angel", signifies that the wall of the city is not natural but in resurrection. In resurrection we could be transformed to be like angels.

**II. Its foundation:**

A. Built with twelve kinds of precious stones—Rev. 21:14a.

1. The twelve precious stones of the foundation indicate the unsearchable riches of the all-inclusive Christ. Every foundation expresses a certain amount of Christ's riches.
2. The colors of the twelve layers of the foundation give the appearance of a rainbow, signifying that the city is built upon and secured by God's faithfulness in keeping His covenant. The entire city is built upon the eternal faithfulness of the faithful God—Rev. 21:19-20; Gen. 9:8-17.

B. Built upon the grace of God.

1. The twelve foundations bearing the twelve names of the apostles, who are the representatives of the grace of the New Testament, signify that the New Jerusalem is built upon the grace of God according to the New Testament—Rev. 21:14.
2. The law (signified by the twelve names of the twelve tribes) is for the entry, and the grace (signified by the names of the twelve apostles) is for the foundation.
3. We enter into the New Jerusalem according to the requirement of the law, and we are in the New Jerusalem according to and based on the grace of the New Tastament.

**III. Its street:**

A. God's nature—Rev. 21:21b.
   1. The street of the city is gold, signifying God's nature.
   2. The street being gold means that God's nature is the way in the city and the way in the church life.
   3. If we take God's nature as our unique way we will be pure, without mixture, and transparent, without opaqueness.

B. With the river of water of life and the tree of life—Rev. 22:1-2.
   1. In the middle of this street is the river of water of life, which indicates that when we take the way according to God's nature, the of God flows within us.
   2. The one tree of life growing on the two sides of the river, signifies that the tree of life is a vine, spreading and proceeding along the flow of the water of life for God's people to receive and enjoy. The fruits of the tree of life will be continually fresh, produced every month, twelve fruits yearly. This means that when we walk and move in the divine nature of God, we not only sense the flow of life within us but also sense the supply of life, the nourishment of life, the spiritual food.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 36

**TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM**

Message Eleven

# Its Dimensions, Its Temple, and Its Light

Scripture Reading : Rev. 21:15-16, 22-24a; 22:5; Deut. 33:27; Psa. 90:1

## I. Its dimensions—Rev. 21:15-16.

A. The number twelve:

The length, breadth, and height of the New Jerusalem are twelve thousand stadia, that is one thousand times twelve. One thousand is the ultimate completion in God's figuration. Since twelve signifies absolute perfection and eternal completion in God's administration, twelve thousand signifies a thousand times this.

B. The Holy of Holies.

1. The entire of New Jerusalem will be the Holy of Holies, because the dimensions of the Holy of Holies, both in the tabernacle and the temple, are equal in length, breadth, and height—Exo. 26:2-8; 1 Kings. 6:20.
2. The New Jerusalem is a cube. This means that the entire New Jerusalem is straight, perfect, and complete, without any defect, bias, obliqueness, or shortage.

C. Measured with a golden reed:

1. The reed is for measuring, and measuring signifies to take possession—Ezek. 40:5; Zech. 2:1-2; Rev. 11:1.
2. Since gold signifies the divine nature of God, the golden reed signifies that the measuring of the city, its gates and its wall, is according to God's divine nature, so the whole city, with its gates and wall is fitting for God's possession.

D. A square city.

The city lying foursquare, signifies that the New Jerusalem is perfect and complete in every way, absolutely straight, without any obliqueness. Here there is no politics, no crookedness, and here is God's frankness, faithfulness, and openness.

## II. Its temple:

A. The redeeming Triune God—Rev. 21:22.

The temple is a Person, and this Person is the Triune God, the Lord God the Almighty and the Lamb. Our God today is the very Redeemer as well as the Triune God, so the redeeming Triune God is our temple.

B. A mutual dwelling place.

1. The New Jerusalem will be a mutual dwelling place. To God it is a tabernacle and to us it is a temple in which we dwell and in which we serve God.
2. In our human spirit He dwells in us who are His tabernacle, and in the divine Spirit we dwell in Him who is our temple.

C. The building material of the temple.

Its temple built with the Lord, with God, with the Almighty, with the Lamb, and with all His attributes and accomplishments.

D. God Himself as the Spirit reaching us.

The temple which is the Triune God, is our dwelling place in eternity, in which we serve Him. Actually, we serve God in God Himself as the Spirit reaching us—Deut. 33:27; Psa. 90:1.

**III. Its light:**

A. The glory of God, the Lord God Himself:

1. In the New Jerusalem there is no need of the sun nor of the moon, indicates that in the New Jerusalem there is no natural light, and the fact that there is no need of the light of a lamp means that there is no man-made light—Rev. 21:23a; 22:5a.
2. God Himself, the very divine Person, is the light. The glory of God, the Lord God Himself, illumines the city—Rev. 21:23b; 22:5b.
3. God is the inner light and the outer expression of the light, the glory.

B. The Lamb being the lamp—Rev. 21:23c.

1. The divine light shines through our Redeemer. This light has become so lovable and touchable and we even walk in this light. Without the Lamb's redemption, God's shining over us could only kill us—1 John 1:7; Rev. 21:24a.
2. God as the light, though, has a holder, and this holder is the Redeemer, the Lamb. The Lamb as the lamp expresses the light in a very approachable and lovable way.

**IV. Our present experience:**

A. Our Triune God is our lamp, our light, and our temple in whom we serve.

1. We dwell in Him and He shines within us.
2. We are His tabernacle in whom He dwells, and He is our temple in whom we dwell.
3. He is also our lamp and our light who shines from within us through the lamp.
4. He is in us and we are in Him.

B. In our human spirit He dwells in us, the tabernacle, and we dwell in Him, the divine Spirit reaching us, the temple.

C. We take Him as our temple, our abode, and then He as the divine light shines from within us.

D. This is the mingling of divinity with humanity, which is our present experience and which will be the coming New Jerusalem.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 37

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Twelve

## Its Throne

Scripture Reading : Rev. 22:1-3, 5c; 2:7; 22:14, 17; John 7:38-39

**I. The throne of God and of the Lamb—Rev. 22:1-2.**

A. The throne of God and of the Lamb denotes that this throne is to carry out God's plan through Christ's redemption.

B. The throne is the very source from which the river of water of life flows, and it flows with the tree of life growing in it. The throne for the accomplisment of God's eternal purpose is to flow out God Himself that by this flow of life His purpose could be accomplished.

**II. "A little New Jerusalem."**

A. Every proper and normal Christian is "a little New Jerusalem."

B. With and in each one of us are the three gates of the divine Trinity, and also the throne of God and of the Lamb. We must enthrone Him in our heart and in our spirit.

**III. The center of our Christian life:**

A. In our Christian life the center is the throne of God and of the Lamb. We enthrone Him in our being and in our Christian life.

B. We are not here living for ourselves. We are living and existing for the accomplishment of God's purpose, to carry out what Christ has accomplished.

C. We experience the One on the throne in His headship and lordship, and we submit ourselves to such an authority.

**IV. The flow of the divine Trinity—Rev. 22:1; John 7:38-39.**

The water of life refers to the Spirit. God flows in the water of life, the Lamb flows in the water of life, and the Spirit flows as the water of life. Thus, this is the Triune flow, the flow of the divine Trinity as the very life supply.

**V. The source of life within us.**

When we believed, we believed into the Triune God. We were baptized into the Person of the Father, the Son, and the Spirit, so after being baptized we are in the Triune God. We are in Him and He is in us. This very God who is in us is the source of life.

**VI. Our daily life—a life of the New Jerusalem—Rev. 22:17b.**

We are experiencing the throne of God for our enjoyment. The water of life, the flow of the Spirit of life, is the divine life in resurrection for the drink of God's redeemed. This river of water of life proceeding out or the throne is bright as crystal with no dimness or opaqueness, purifying God's redeemed and making them transparent.

**VII. Eating and drinking God.**

A. Not only do we serve Him but also we see His face. His face is in the water of life and in the fruit of the tree of life—Rev. 22:3-4.

B. We serve Him by drinking and eating Him. When we drink the water of life, we see His face. When we eat the fruit of the tree of life, we receive His face.

**VIII. Serving Him, seeing Him, and reigning with Him.**

A. When He is enthroned in our being, the water flows and the tree grows, and our service will be an enjoyment. When we enjoy Him we serve Him, we see Him, and we reign with Him to be kings with Him—Rev. 22:5.

B. We need to go with the authority of the heavenly King who is now enthroned in our being—Matt. 28:18-19.

**IX. The throne, the water of life, and the tree of life.**

A. As long as we have the throne as the center of our daily life, we are okay because we will have the water of life to drink and the tree of life to eat. Then we are "a small New Jerusalem."

B. The flow of the divine Trinity saturates and nourishes the entire New Jerusalem. This indicates that the carrying out of God's administration for the fulfillment of His purpose, His desire, is by the flow of Himself as life and life supply, not by any work.

Reference : *God's New Testament Economy*, Chapter 38

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Thirteenth

## The New Jerusalem's Application To The Believers - Triune Entry

Scripture Reading: John 3:36a; Matt. 28:19; John 15:4a; 14:17, 23; Col. 2:7a; Eph. 3:16-19

**I. The application of the New Jerusalem**

A. The first application is the triune entry.

1. We are using "entry" in the denotation of entering in, not in the denotation of an entrance or a door.

2. The entering into the New Jerusalem is triune because it is an entry through the divine Trinity, through the Son, with the Father, and by the Spirit.

B. After we enter into the Triune God, we experience Him as the triune constitution, the second application.

1. We are now being constituted with the Father's divine nature, the gold; with the Son's produce in His redemptive work, the pearl; and with the Spirit's produce in His transforming work, the precious stones.

2. The New Jerusalem is built with these three basic materials, which are the three basic elements for our spiritual constitution.

C. Through the entering in we have the constitution, and in the constitution we have the triune existence.

1. Our spiritual existence is totally dependent upon the Triune God – 2 Cor. 13:14

2. We are existing by the grace of Christ, by the love of God, and by the fellowship, the flow, of the Spirit.

3. He is grace and love to us, and this grace with love is carried on within us in the fellowship of the Holy Spirit. We exist spiritually by and with the very Triune God

D. The way that we exist is the way that we live, so the fourth aspect of the application is the Triune God as our living.

1. We are living by, with, and in the Triune God; we are living by the Son, with the Father, through the Spirit.

2. We do not live by ourselves, with ourselves, and in ourselves – Gal. 2:20; John 6:57; Phil. 1:21a.

3. Since Christ is the very embodiment of the Father and realized in the Spirit, when we live by Christ, we live by the Triune God, and when we live Christ, we live the Triune God.

E. The fifth application is the triune enjoyment.

1. The word triune is a good adjective to describe our spiritual condition, situation, existence, living, and enjoyment.

2. We enjoy the Son's grace, the Father's love, and the Spirit's fellowship; Christ is grace, God is love, and the Holy Spirit is fellowship.

3. We enjoy a triune blessing—the blessing of the Son as grace, the blessing of the Father as love, and the blessing of the Spirit as the fellowship; this is our threefold enjoyment; our enjoyment is triune.

F. The New Jerusalem expresses the Triune God so its expression is triune.

1. People should be able to see God's golden nature in us and that we are the pearls.

a. The rock wounded the oyster, stayed in this wound, and the oyster secreted its life-juice around the rock making it a pearl. Thus, we were changed from being rocky, and we became pearly.

b. We must be found by others in Christ (Phil. 3:9).

1) Paul was pursuing Christ to be found in Christ. He did not want others to find him as Saul of Tarsus, a natural "rocky" man, but he wanted others to find him in Christ.

2) Paul desired to be wrapped up with the secretion of Christ's resurrection life in order that others could see him as a pearl, full of Christ's life.

2. Also, we express the sevenfold Spirit.

a. The lampstand has seven lamps which are the seven Spirits of God shining to express all that the Triune God is.

b. We must be persons who are expressing God by shining with the sevenfold intensified Spirit.

## II. Experiencing the enterable God

A. According to the divine revelation in the sixty-six books of the Bible our God is enterable.

1. God is indeed righteous, holy, merciful, and faithful, but we also need to realize, that the righteous, holy, merciful, faithful God is enterable.

2. Noah's ark is a type of our God being enterable. The ark typifies Christ, the embodiment of God, and that ark was enterable.

3. The other type which shows that our God is enterable is the tabernacle. The tabernacle is also a type of Christ – John 1:14.

B. The way to enter into God

1. When we believed in Christ, we entered into Him – John 3:36

2. We have been baptized **into** Christ Jesus – Rom. 6:3; Matt. 28:19.

a. When we were baptized into the Triune God, we were baptized into the very Spirit, who is the ultimate consummation of the Triune God.

b. When we baptize people, it should not just be a ceremony or a religious form to accept people into Christianity.

c. When we baptize them, we must tell them to exercise their faith to be immersed into the sum total of the divine Being, equivalent to His Person.

C. Being in God

1. The three parables in Luke 15 with the Son as the shepherd, the Spirit as the seeking woman, and the Father as the loving father, show us that the Triune God is receiving sinners, not only back to His home but also back into Himself.

2. This one realization of being in God will preserve you from many evil things.

D. Abiding in the Son

1. We need to abide in the Son that the Father, the Son, and the Spirit may abide in us (John 15:4a; 14:17, 23). Our abiding becomes a term or condition for His abiding in us.
2. When we abide in the Lord, the Spirit of reality abides in us and the Father comes with the Son to make an abode with us – John. 14:17, 23

E. Rooted in Christ

1. Colossians 2:7a indicates that we have been rooted in Christ, this indicates that we believers are like plants and Christ is likened to the soil.
2. Quite often, we Christians do not pay attention to our roots or to our being rooted in Christ. We only talk about our growing, but we have to realize that our growing depends upon our rooting.
3. To be rooted in Christ simply means to enter into Him. When the tree is rooted into the soil, it enters into the soil. When we are rooted in Christ we will enjoy a further entry into the Triune God.

F. Christ making His home in our hearts

1. In Ephesians 3 the apostle prays that God the Father would grant the believers to be strengthened through God the Spirit into their inner man, that Christ, God the Son, may make His home in their hearts, that is, to occupy their entire being, that they might be filled unto all the fullness of God (vv. 14-19).
2. God the Father is exercising His authority through God the Spirit to strengthen us into the inner man that God the Son may make His home deep down in our hearts.
3. Our heart is like a house that has four rooms and these rooms are the mind, the emotion, the will, and the conscience. Christ has the desire to occupy every room of our heart and every corner of every room. As He makes His home downward in our heart we become strong to apprehend with all the saints the breadth, length, height, and depth of Christ (Eph. 3:18).

Reference Book: *God's New Testament Economy, chapter 39*

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Fourteen

## The New Jerusalem's Application To The Believers – The Triune Living

Scripture Reading: John 1:13; Eph. 4:18; 1 John 4:8, 16; 1:5, 2-3; Col. 2:9; 3:4; Rev. 2:7; Phil. 1:20; John 14:17a; 15:26; 16:13-15; Rom. 8:2; Rev. 22:17b; Phil. 1:19

**I. The picture of the New Jerusalem**

A. The holy city is a golden mountain and around this mountain is a wall built with jasper. The city itself lies "foursquare" (Rev. 21:16) with its length, breadth, and height equal.

B. At the bottom of the wall are twelve layers of precious stone as the wall's foundation. On each of the four sides of the wall are three pearl gates.

C. On the top of the city is a throne and this throne is the throne of God and of the Lamb. The Lamb is the lamp of the city and God is within the Lamb, as the light.

D. Out of the throne proceeds the river of water of life and this river is in the middle of a golden street which, goes down the mountain in a spiral fashion. On the two sides of the river grows the tree of life, which is a vine spreading and proceeding along the flow of the water of life, producing new fruit each month, for God's people to receive and enjoy.

II. The living of the New Jerusalem

A. Living with the Father

1. We should be those living with the Father as the source of life (John 1:13; Eph. 4:18; John 5:26) on the throne.

a. The first striking point of the New Jerusalem is that God is sitting on the throne. This God is the Lamb-God, the redeeming God, God the Redeemer. In Genesis 1:1 He was the creating God, but in Revelation 22:1 we see the redeeming God.

b. The throne is the throne of God and the Lamb. God and the Lamb are co-inhering. The Father is in the Son and the Son is in the Father (John 14:10-11).

2. The redeeming God is sitting on the throne with His sovereign authority as the very source of life.

a. We must take the Godhead as our very source and as our very authority.

b. We must take the throne and be under the throne in order to have the enjoyment of the flowing life.

c. What is the source of our daily living, of our marriage life, of our home life, and of our church life? We should be able to tell ourselves, "Amen, Lord. The source of my family life, marriage life, business life, and church life is God the Father with His redeeming element and with the element of His divine authority."

3. We must remain and keep ourselves in the fellowship of the divine life – 1 John 1:2-3.

B. Living with the Son

1. We also need to be those living with the Son as the embodiment of God (Col. 2:9).

2. We live with the Father as the fountain and we live with the Son as life and as the life supply, the tree of life (Rev. 22:2; 2:7).
3. The Lord Jesus is our daily life supply and every day we must call upon His name to enjoy this supply (Rom. 10:12).
4. We all have to learn how to take our Lord individually and extensively as our enjoyment for His magnification (Phil. 1:20). When we enjoy the Lord in such a way, we magnify Him.
5. Paul enjoyed Christ even in prison because he was enjoying the bountiful supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ for his daily salvation (Phil. 1:19).

C. Living with the Spirit

1. We also need to be those living with the Spirit as the realization of Christ the Son (John 14:17a; 15:26; 16:13-15). When you enjoy the Lord, immediately the Lord within you is the Spirit. The Lord is realized as the Spirit.
2. This Spirit is also the Spirit of life (Rom. 8:2). When we live with the Spirit, we enjoy the flow of life, and this life becomes our real supply. The Spirit of life is also the water of life (Rev. 22:17b), and we live with the Spirit as the water of life for the bountiful supply of the Triune God (Phil. 1:19).

Reference Book: *God's New Testament Economy, chapter 42*

# TRUTH CLASS — NEW JERUSALEM

Message Fifteen

## The New Jerusalem's Application To The Believers – The Triune Enjoyment

Scripture Reading: Rev. 21:23; 22:5; John 1:4; 8:12; 1 John 1:5; Rev. 21:11; 22:2, 14; Gen. 2:9; Rev. 22:1, 14, 17

**I. In the divine light**

A. Light refers to God the Father – 1 John 1:5.

1. While love is the nature of God's intrinsic essence, light is the nature of God's outward expression.

2. In the New Jerusalem light refers to God Himself to illuminate the entire city for His expression – Rev. 21:23.

B. In the New Jerusalem, however, there will be no need of the sun or of the moon. The light in the city will be God Himself as the light of life (John 1:4; 8:12).

1. God as the divine light, the light of life, is contained in the Lamb as the lamp (Rev. 21:23b).

2. First Timothy 6:16 tells us that God dwells in unapproachable light. In Christ, though, God becomes approachable. Outside of Christ, God's shining is a kind of killing, but inside of Christ God's shining is a kind of illumination.

C. Because we actually have God Himself within Christ as our light, we do not need philosophy, the human-made light, and we do not need ethical teachings such as that of Confucius.

1. If we would care for the new creation and the inner anointing all the time, there would be no need of teaching.

2. According to the principle of the new creation, we have God in us as light. In Him there is no darkness at all (1 John 1:5). When you are fellowshipping with God, you do not need any other light. As long as you have Him He is the very light to you and you do not need any teaching or doctrine.

D. Revelation 21:11 indicates that God as the light shines through the New Jerusalem.

1. The entire wall of the New Jerusalem is built with jasper (Rev. 21:18), and the light of the New Jerusalem is like jasper stone, bearing the appearance of God (Rev. 4:3) to express God by her shining.

2. God in the redeeming Lamb is the light, and the entire city is a luminary, a great light-bearer. This means that God as the divine light shines within and through the redeeming Christ, and this shining enlightens the entire city.

3. Revelation 21:11 also tells us that the holy city has the glory of God. Glory is God expressed. In the New Jerusalem God is light, and His shining is His glory.

E. Today we have God in the redeeming Christ shining within us, and we are being transformed to be transparent. In our old creation we are opaque, but in our new creation we are transparent. Second Corinthians 3:18 says we are being transformed into His

image from one degree of glory to another degree of glory. Eventually we will have the appearance of jasper and will fully express the "jasper God" (Rev. 4:3).

**II. In the divine river**

A. The second aspect of the triune enjoyment is the river of water of life (Rev. 22:1); this river refers to the Spirit as the consummation of the Triune God – John 7:38-39.

B. The river is the flowing of the Triune God and the consummate coming out of God. When God flows out, He becomes the river of water of life. When the Triune God reaches you, He is the living water.

1. Today God reaches us by being the life-giving Spirit (1 Cor. 15:45b).

2. In Revelation 22 God in the Lamb flows as the living water to reach His redeemed people.

3. Revelation 22:1 says the river flows out of the throne, and it flows in the middle of the street. Revelation 21:21 tells us that the street of the city is pure gold. Without the street, the river cannot flow. If there is no street, there is no river.

a. The street being gold indicates that the way in the New Jerusalem is God's divine nature.

b. According to our experience, if we do not behave and live according to God's divine nature, we feel dried up within and we do not sense the flow of life within us.

c. This Spirit can only flow in the middle of the divine nature.

C. This river flows in the divine street, and the street spirals down the golden mountain until it reaches all twelve gates. This means that the river saturates the New Jerusalem, carrying the tree of life with its fruit to nourish the city (Rev. 22:2a, 14).

**III. In the divine tree**

A. Where the divine river goes, the tree of life grows (Rev. 22:2); the tree of life signifies God Himself in Christ as the life supply to us (Gen. 2:9; John 1:4; 14:6).

B. Christ is the tree of life, and in this tree of life is the full enjoyment of all the riches of life – Rev. 22:2.

C. The fruits of the tree of life, as our life supply, will be the food of God's redeemed for eternity; they will be continually fresh, produced every month, twelve fruits yearly.

D. The tree of life was closed to the fallen man by God's glory, righteousness, and holiness until Christ's death fulfilled all the divine requirements. Through Christ's death, the tree of life is open again and available to all the sinners who would believe in Him and take Him as their Savior and life.

Reference Book: *God's New Testament Economy, chapter 43*